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THE EQUITY SHARES OF THE COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON MAIN BOARD PLATFORM OF BSE LIMITED IN COMPLIANCE WITH CHAPTER II OF THE SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE BOARD OF INDIA (ISSUE OF CAPITAL AND DISCLOSURE REQUIREMENTS) REGULATIONS, 2018, AS AMENDED ("SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS")



(Please scan the QR code to view the Red Herring Prospectus and the Abridged Prospectus read with the addendum to the Red Herring Prospectus.)



NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED (To be listed on the main board of BSE)

Our Company was incorporated as 'National Stock Exchange of India Limited' as a public limited company under the Companies Act, 1956, pursuant to a certificate of incorporation dated November 27, 1992 issued by the Assistant Registrar of Companies, Maharashtra at Bombay and commenced its operations pursuant to a certificate of commencement of business dated March 2, 1993 issued by the Additional Registrar of Companies, Maharashtra at Bombay. For further details, see "History and Certain Corporate Matters" beginning on page 249 of the red herring prospectus dated September 10, 2026 (the "RHP" or the "Red Herring Prospectus").

Registered Office and Corporate Office: Exchange Plaza, C-1, Block G, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai 400 051, Maharashtra, India; Telephone: +91 22 2659 8100; Website: www.nseindia.com; Contact person: Smt. Prajakta Powle (Company Secretary and Compliance Officer); E-mail: nse_ipo@nse.co.in; Corporate Identity Number: U67120MH1992PLC069769

OUR COMPANY DOES NOT HAVE AN IDENTIFIABLE PROMOTER

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFERING OF UP TO 126,436,650 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED ("OUR COMPANY" OR "THE COMPANY") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹[•] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A SHARE PREMIUM OF ₹[•] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("OFFER PRICE") AGGREGATING TO ₹[•] MILLION (THE "OFFER") THROUGH AN OFFER FOR SALE OF UP TO 126,436,650 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING TO ₹[•] MILLION BY THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS AS PROVIDED IN ANNEXURE A OF THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS (SUCH EQUITY SHARES SO OFFERED, THE "OFFERED SHARES", AND SUCH OFFER, THE "OFFER FOR SALE").

THE OFFER INCLUDES A RESERVATION OF [•] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹700.00 MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [•]% OF THE POST OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY) FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES (THE "EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION"). THE OFFER LESS THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION IS HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "NET OFFER". THE OFFER AND THE NET OFFER SHALL CONSTITUTE [•]% AND [•] %, RESPECTIVELY, OF THE POST-OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY.

DETAILS OF THE OFFER FOR SALE BY THE TOP 10 SELLING SHAREHOLDERS			
NAMES OF THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS**	TYPE	MAXIMUM NUMBER OF EQUITY SHARES OFFERED/ AMOUNT (IN ₹ MILLION)	WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION PER EQUITY SHARE (IN ₹)*
State Bank of India	Corporate Selling Shareholder	Up to 15,969,410 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating to ₹[•] million	0.80
Canada Pension Plan Investment Board	Corporate Selling Shareholder	Up to 11,874,060 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating to ₹[•] million	324.13
Aranda Investments (Mauritius) Pte Ltd	Corporate Selling Shareholder	Up to 11,246,336 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating to ₹[•] million	62.38
MS Strategic (Mauritius) Limited	Corporate Selling Shareholder	Up to 11,000,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating to ₹[•] million	66.54
The New India Assurance Company Ltd.	Corporate Selling Shareholder	Up to 10,500,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating to ₹[•] million	0.32
SBI Capital Markets Limited (SS) [†]	Corporate Selling Shareholder	Up to 8,780,590 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating to ₹[•] million	0.38
Bank of Baroda	Corporate Selling Shareholder	Up to 7,690,375 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating to ₹[•] million	0.54
Stock Holding Corporation of India Limited	Corporate Selling Shareholder	Up to 6,187,500 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating to ₹[•] million	0.46
General Insurance Corporation of India	Corporate Selling Shareholder	Up to 6,187,500 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating to ₹[•] million	5.26
United India Insurance Company Limited	Corporate Selling Shareholder	Up to 6,000,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating to ₹[•] million	0.50

*As certified by Manian & Rao, Chartered Accountants (FRN: 001983S), by way of their certificate dated September 10, 2026.

**For a complete list of the Selling Shareholders and details of their weighted average cost of acquisition per Equity Share, see "Annexure A" of the Red Herring Prospectus on page 623 and 624.

[†]SBI Capital Markets Limited is also participating as a Selling Shareholder in the Offer. On account of the restrictions under Regulation 21A of the SEBI Merchant Bankers Regulations, SBI Capital Markets Limited, in its capacity as a book running lead manager to the Offer, will be involved only in the marketing of the Offer.

PRICE BAND: ₹1,700 TO ₹1,785 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH.
THE FLOOR PRICE IS 1,700 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES AND THE CAP PRICE IS 1,785 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES.
BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 8 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 8 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH THEREAFTER.
THE PRICE TO EARNINGS RATIO ("P/E") BASED ON DILUTED EPS FOR FINANCIAL YEAR ENDED 2026 FOR OUR COMPANY AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 42.89 TIMES
AND AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 40.85 TIMES AS COMPARED TO THE AVERAGE INDUSTRY PEER P/E RATIO OF 54.28 TIMES FOR FISCAL 2026.
A DISCOUNT OF ₹170 PER EQUITY SHARE IS BEING OFFERED TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION.
WEIGHTED AVERAGE RETURN ON NETWORTH FOR LAST THREE FISCAL YEARS IS 37.92%.

The details of the Offer for Sale and the post Offer market capitalization of the Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

OFFER SIZE AND MARKET CAPITALIZATION				
Particulars	At Floor Price of ₹1,700 per Equity Share		At Cap Price of ₹1,785 per Equity Share	
	Up to No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each	Up to Amount (₹ in million)	Up to No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each	Up to Amount (₹ in million)
Offer For Sale	126,436,650	214,864.53*	126,436,650	225,615.74*
Post Offer Market Capitalisation	2,475,000,000	4,207,500.00	2,475,000,000	4,417,875.00

*Offer size has been calculated considering the employee discount of ₹170 per Equity Share at Floor price and Cap price.

BID/OFFER PROGRAMME	BID/OFFER OPEN
	BID/OFFER CLOSES ON MONDAY, SEPTEMBER 21, 2026 ⁽ⁱ⁾

⁽ⁱ⁾ The UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 7.00 p.m. on the Bid/Offer Closing Date.

We operate a vertically integrated, multi-asset class stock exchange offering a simple integrated platform for trading, clearing and listing, and other services such as data feed, data terminal and licensing services, across cash market, futures, options, mutual funds platform, commodity derivatives, exchange-traded currency derivatives, wholesale debt market and interest rate futures, among others.

THE OFFER IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS.
THE EQUITY SHARES OF THE COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE LIMITED. BSE LIMITED SHALL BE THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.
QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE NET OFFER • NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE NET OFFER
RETAIL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE NET OFFER • EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION: [•] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE ₹1 AGGREGATING UP TO ₹700.00 MILLION

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST RELY ONLY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS READ WITH THE ADDENDUM TO THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS AND PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT DATED SEPTEMBER 14, 2026 ("ADDENDUM") AND THE TERMS OF THE OFFER, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE OFFER AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THE PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT FOR THE OFFER AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER IN RELATION TO THE VALUATION OF THE COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE OFFER ("BRLMs").

In accordance with the recommendation of a committee of Independent Directors of our Company, pursuant to their resolution dated September 10, 2026, the above provided Price Band is justified based on quantitative factors/ key performance indicators ("KPIs") disclosed in the "Basis for Offer Price" section on page 130 of the RHP vis-a-vis the weighted average cost of acquisition ("WACA") of primary and secondary transactions, as applicable, as disclosed in the "Basis for Offer Price" section beginning on the page 130 of the RHP and provided below in this advertisement.

Risk to Investors For details, refer to section titled "Risk Factors" on page 26 of the RHP.

1. **Trading Volume Risk:** We earn revenue based on trades executed on our stock exchange, listing fees from Listed Entities, and fees from ancillary services such as data feed & terminal services, data centre related services, and licensing services, and any significant decrease in the volume and value of such transactions could significantly reduce demand for our products, constrain our growth and have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition, results of operations, cash flows and prospects.

(₹ in million, unless otherwise specified)

Revenue from operations from:	Three months period ended June 30,				Fiscal				
	2026	% of Revenue from operations	2025	% of Revenue from operations	2026	% of Revenue from operations	2025	% of Revenue from operations	2024
Transaction charges	36,226.64	79.44%	31,536.00	78.20%	130,570.12	78.65%	136,357.64	79.55%	121,296.37
Listing services	783.59	1.72%	776.42	1.93%	3,524.36	2.12%	3,138.21	1.83%	2,226.18
Data Centre - Rack charges	593.88	1.30%	458.17	1.14%	2,051.75	1.24%	1,544.02	0.90%	1,338.14
Data Connectivity charges	2,582.94	5.66%	2,881.31	7.15%	11,287.91	6.80%	11,044.81	6.44%	8,246.97
Data Feed & Terminal services	1,495.57	3.28%	1,063.80	2.64%	4,700.74	2.83%	4,071.32	2.38%	3,392.64
Licensing services	441.29	0.97%	378.01	0.94%	1,518.45	0.91%	1,204.98	0.70%	975.36
Clearing & Settlement Services	823.58	1.81%	492.87	1.22%	2,514.51	1.51%	3,213.42	1.87%	1,348.12
Others	317.40	0.69%	327.10	0.81%	1,428.34	0.87%	1,260.01	0.75%	855.71
Total	43,264.89	94.87%	37,913.68	94.03%	157,596.18	94.93%	161,834.41	94.42%	139,679.49
Other operating revenues ⁽ⁱ⁾	2,339.21	5.13%	2,408.70	5.97%	8,416.91	5.07%	9,572.37	5.58%	8,120.62
Total	45,604.10	100.00%	40,322.38	100.00%	166,013.09	100.00%	171,406.78	100.00%	147,800.11

Notes:

⁽ⁱ⁾ Comprises income generated from investment of funds related to operating activities.

2. **Risk relating to concentration of revenue from Transaction Charges:** Our business significantly depends on revenue from trading activities and in turn we earn the majority of our trading revenue from our options and futures businesses. The table below provides our revenue from the transaction charges for the period/Fiscal indicated:

(₹ in million unless otherwise specified)

Particulars	Three months period ended June 30,		Fiscal		
	2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
Revenue from operations (A)	45,604.10	40,322.38	166,013.09	171,406.78	147,800.11
Revenue from operations from transaction charges (B)	36,226.64	31,536.00	130,570.12	136,357.64	121,296.37
As % of revenue from operations (B)/(A)	79.44%	78.20%	78.65%	79.55%	82.07%
Transaction charges from options business (C)	27,439.47	23,726.85	99,975.68	101,940.30	95,501.89
As % of revenue from operations (C)/(A)	60.17%	58.84%	60.22%	59.47%	64.62%
Transaction charges from futures business (D)	3,674.81	3,820.46	14,800.97	17,272.58	12,489.75
As % of revenue from operations (D)/(A)	8.06%	9.47%	8.92%	10.08%	8.45%
ADTV in the options (premium value)	643,517.81	555,136.09	576,617.54	624,486.60	617,788.39
ADTV in the futures	1,530,788.97	1,684,296.36	1,594,432.13	1,859,014.41	1,340,003.40

3. **Trading Member Concentration Risk:** A substantial share of our revenue from operations is generated from trading activity and services provided to a relatively concentrated group of key trading members. Any disruption in the services of these trading members or our inability to onboard new trading members could have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.

(₹ in million, unless otherwise specified)

Particulars	Three months period ended June 30,		Fiscals		
	2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
Aggregate absolute value of the revenue from the top ten trading members	21,431.89	18,385.84	77,655.80	76,238.40	66,894.18
Percentage of revenue from operations (%)	47.00%	45.60%	46.78%	44.48%	45.26%

4. **Regulatory Oversight and Inspection Risk:** We operate in a highly regulated industry, primarily overseen by SEBI. We are also subject to periodic inspections by SEBI and IFSCA and pursuant to such inspections, have received observations, show cause notices, and administrative warnings, deficiency and advisory letters in relation to certain regulatory matters, and after issuance of show cause notices, enforcement actions including adjudication proceedings under Section 15-I and/or directions or penalties under Section 11B of the SEBI Act may be initiated by SEBI; any failure to comply could have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations. There can be no assurance that further such communications will not be issued in the future.

5. **Enforcement and Adjudication Risk:** We have been, and continue to be, subject to enforcement actions, monetary penalties, adjudication proceedings, which may or may not get settled with SEBI in respect of alleged violations and regulatory matters with applicable SEBI regulations. The outcome of current and potential future proceedings is uncertain and could have a material adverse impact on our business, reputation, financial condition and results of operations.

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6. **IT Infrastructure Reliability Risk:** Disruptions, failures or inadequacies in our IT infrastructure, systems or software, including those provided by third-party vendors, could adversely affect our business, reputation and results of operations, and may subject us to regulatory action or the imposition of financial disincentives by SEBI.
7. **New Listings and Capital Formation Dependence Risk:** Our ability to attract new listings, issuances and capital formation activities on our platforms is critical to our business, and any decline may adversely affect our operations. The table below provides revenue from our listing services for the period/Fiscal indicated:

(₹ in million unless otherwise specified)

Particulars	Three months period ended June 30,		Fiscal		
	2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
Revenue from listing services (A)	783.59	776.42	3,524.36	3,138.21	2,226.18
Revenue from operations (B)	45,604.10	40,322.38	166,013.09	171,406.78	147,800.11
As a % of revenue from operations (A/B)	1.72%	1.93%	2.12%	1.83%	1.51%
Listed Entities on Exchange*	3,005	2,757	2,978	2,719	2,438

*Listed Entities on Exchange represents the total number of Listed Entities on Mainboard, SME, SME ITP, as well as AMCs which have their funds listed on NSE as at the last day of the relevant period/year.

8. **Cybersecurity Risk:** We are subject to cybersecurity risks, including a distributed denial of service attack we experienced in May 2025, and any successful cyberattack could disrupt our operations and adversely affect our business, financial condition, results of operations, and prospects.
9. **Risk Management Systems Risk:** Our risk management systems may not always be adequate, which could result in financial losses, regulatory action and reputational harm.
10. **Clearing and Settlement Risk:** Our clearing corporation operations expose us to financial, operational, counterparty and systemic risks arising from our relationships with, and dependencies on, clearing members, depositories and other market infrastructure participants; any failure could have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.
11. **Offer related risk:** We will not receive any proceeds from the Offer for Sale portion and the same will be received by the Selling Shareholders.
12. Price/Earnings (P/E) ratio based on diluted EPS for Financial Year 2026 is 40.85 and 42.89 times at the lower and upper end of the Price Band.
13. Weighted Average Return on Net Worth for Financial Year ended 2026, 2025 and 2024 is 37.92%.
14. **The weighted average cost of acquisition per Equity Share by the Selling Shareholders as on the date of the Red Herring Prospectus is as follows and upper end of the Price Band is ₹1,785 per Equity Share:**

Name	Number of Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each held^	Weighted average cost of acquisition ("WACA") of Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each* (in ₹ per Equity Share)
Corporate Selling Shareholders		
State Bank of India	79,847,050	0.80
Canada Pension Plan Investment Board	39,580,200	324.13
Aranda Investments (Mauritius) Pte Ltd	112,463,356	62.38
MS Strategic (Mauritius) Limited	29,760,000	66.54
The New India Assurance Company Ltd.	35,200,000	0.32
SBI Capital Markets Limited (SS)	107,250,000	0.38
Bank of Baroda	21,972,500	0.54
Stock Holding Corporation of India Limited	110,000,000	0.46
General Insurance Corporation of India	40,700,000	5.26
United India Insurance Company Limited	19,390,000	0.50
Crown Capital Limited	51,355,465	274.14
2726247 Ontario Inc.	27,006,430	302.98
The Oriental Insurance Company Limited	35,200,000	0.32
National Insurance Company Limited	35,200,000	0.32
Mahagony Limited	92,295,000	564.84
ICICI Lombard General Insurance Company Limited	23,500,000	169.49
TA Asia Pacific Acquisitions Limited	34,266,085	238.42
Soach Global Strategic Holdings Ltd.	8,250,000	71.82
Indian Bank	8,375,000	18.06
Be-In Eight s.r.l.	525,000	1,030.00
Individual Selling Shareholders		
Rajiv Bolla	25,000	660.02
Shaik Samdani Basha	5,000	640.00
Mahesh Gupta	1,000	1,826.85

*As certified by Manian & Rao, Chartered Accountants (FRN No. 001983S), by way of their certificate dated September 10, 2026.

^ Based on beneficiary position statement dated September 8, 2026.

15. **Weighted average cost of acquisition of all Equity Shares transacted by the Selling Shareholders in the three years, 18 months and one year immediately preceding the Red Herring Prospectus is as follows:**

Period	Weighted Average Cost of Acquisition of Equity Shares (in ₹)	Cap Price is 'X' times the Weighted Average Cost of Acquisition	Range of acquisition price: Lowest Price – Highest Price (in ₹)
Last one year	1,954.51	0.91	1,860.00 to 2,015.00
Last 18 months	1,795.70	0.99	1,485.00 to 2,260.00
Last three years	1,247.92^	1.43	564.84^ to 2,260.00^

As certified by Manian & Rao, Chartered Accountants (FRN No. 001983S), by way of their certificate dated September 10, 2026.

^Pursuant to resolution passed by our Governing Board on November 4, 2024, our Company undertook a bonus issue of Equity Shares in the ratio of 4:1 (i.e., four Equity Shares for every one Equity Share held in our Company) as of the record date of November 2, 2024 (**"Bonus Issue"**). The Bonus Issue has been excluded from the calculation in the table above. However, the Weighted Average Cost of Acquisition of Equity Shares and range of acquisition price of equity shares transacted prior to the Bonus Issue has been adjusted.

16. **Details of price at which specified securities were acquired by the Selling Shareholders in the last three years preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus**

Sr. No.	Name	Date of acquisition	Number equity shares acquired	Acquisition price per equity share (in ₹)
1.	State Bank of India	November 4, 2024	63,877,640	N.A.*
2.	Canada Pension Plan Investment Board	November 4, 2024	39,580,200	N.A.*
3.	Aranda Investments (Mauritius) Pte Ltd	November 4, 2024	99,000,000	N.A.*
4.	MS Strategic (Mauritius) Limited	November 4, 2024	31,260,000	N.A.*
5.	The New India Assurance Company Ltd.	November 4, 2024	28,160,000	N.A.*
6.	SBI Capital Markets Limited (SS)	November 4, 2024	85,800,000	N.A.*
7.	Bank of Baroda	November 4, 2024	17,578,000	N.A.*
8.	Stock Holding Corporation of India Limited	November 4, 2024	88,000,000	N.A.*
9.	General Insurance Corporation of India	November 4, 2024	32,560,000	N.A.*
10.	United India Insurance Company Limited	November 4, 2024	15,512,000	N.A.*
11.	Crown Capital Limited	November 4, 2024	45,484,372	N.A.*
12.	2726247 Ontario Inc.	November 4, 2024	21,605,144	N.A.*
13.	The Oriental Insurance Company Limited	November 4, 2024	28,160,000	N.A.*
14.	National Insurance Company Limited	November 4, 2024	28,160,000	N.A.*
15.	Mahagony Limited	April 26, 2024 November 4, 2024	19,459,000 77,836,000	2,824.21 N.A.*
16.	ICICI Lombard General Insurance Company Limited	November 4, 2024	18,800,000	N.A.*
17.	TA Asia Pacific Acquisitions Limited	November 4, 2024	30,048,868	N.A.*
18.	Soach Global Strategic Holdings Ltd.	November 4, 2024	6,600,000	N.A.*
19.	Indian Bank	November 4, 2024	6,700,000	N.A.*
20.	Be-In Eight s.r.l.	June 28, 2024 November 4, 2024	105,000 420,000	5,150.00 N.A.*
21.	Rajiv Bolla	November 4, 2024	20,000	N.A.*
22.	Shaik Samdani Basha	November 4, 2024	4,000	N.A.*
23.	Mahesh Gupta	March 28, 2025 May 31, 2025	1,000 300	1,700.00 2,249.67

As certified by Manian & Rao, Chartered Accountants (FRN No. 001983S), by way of their certificate dated September 10, 2026.

*Pursuant to resolution passed by our Board on November 4, 2024, our Company undertook a bonus issue of Equity Shares in the ratio of 4:1 (i.e., four equity shares for every one equity share held in our Company) as of the record date of November 2, 2024. Acquisition price of Equity Shares acquired pursuant to such bonus issue is N.A.

17. **The 19 BRLMs and 1 M-BRLM associated with the Offer have handled 171 public issues^ in the past three years, out of which 47 issues have closed below the issue price on the listing date**

Name	Total Public Issues^	Issue closed below issue price on listing date
BRLMs		
Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited*	-	-
JM Financial Limited*	-	-
Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited**	-	-
Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited*	-	-
HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited*	-	-
J.P. Morgan India Private Limited*	-	-
Anand Rathi Advisors Limited*	1	-
Aventus Capital Private Limited*	-	-
Axis Capital Limited*	1	-
DAM Capital Advisors Limited*	3	-
Equirus Capital Limited (formerly known as Equirus Capital Private Limited)*	1	-
HDFC Bank Limited*	-	-
ICICI Securities Limited**	-	-
IDBI Capital Markets & Securities Limited*	-	-
IIFL Capital Services Limited (formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)*	1	-
Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited*	3	2
Nuvama Wealth Management Limited*	1	-
Pantomath Capital Advisors Private Limited*	10	3
360 ONE WAM Limited*	-	-
M-BRLM		
SBI Capital Markets Limited* ⁵	-	-
Common Issues handled by the BRLMs and M-BRLM	150	42
Total	171	47

*Issues handled where there were no common BRLMs and M-BRLM.

^Total public issues handled by the BRLMs and M-BRLM till the date of price band advertisement dated September 10, 2026.

*Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited and ICICI Securities Limited are associates of MS Strategic (Mauritius) Limited and ICICI Lombard General Insurance Company Limited, Selling Shareholders in the Offer, respectively, in terms of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Merchant Bankers) Regulations, 1992, as amended ("SEBI Merchant Bankers Regulations"). Accordingly, in terms of Regulation 21A of the SEBI Merchant Bankers Regulations and Regulation 23(3) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited and ICICI Securities Limited would be involved only in the marketing of the Offer. Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited and ICICI Securities Limited have signed the due diligence certificate and have been disclosed as BRLMs.

⁵SBI Capital Markets Limited is participating as a Selling Shareholder in the Offer and is an associate of State Bank of India, a Selling Shareholder in the Offer, in terms of the SEBI Merchant Bankers Regulations. On account of the restrictions under Regulation 21A of the SEBI Merchant Bankers Regulations and Regulation 23(3) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, as applicable, SBI Capital Markets Limited, in its capacity as a book running lead manager to the Offer, will be involved only in the marketing of the Offer.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION FOR INVESTORS:

1. The Company has not undertaken a pre-IPO placement from the DRHP till date.
2. Our Company does not have an identifiable promoter in terms of SEBI ICDR Regulations and the Companies Act 2013. Consequently, there are no members forming part of the 'promoter group' in terms of the SEBI ICDR Regulations.
3. For the pre-Offer shareholding and post-Offer shareholding of the top 10 public Shareholders, refer to the section titled "Capital Structure" on page 112 of the RHP and our price band advertisement.

BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE

The "Basis for Offer Price" on page 130 of the RHP has been updated as above. Please refer to the websites of the BRLMs: <https://investmentbank.kotak.com>; www.jmfl.com; www.morganstanley.com/india; <https://www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india>; www.business.hsbc.co.in; www.jpmpil.com; www.anandrathiib.com; www.ventus.com; www.axiscapital.co.in; www.damcapital.in; www.equirus.com; www.hdfc.bank.in; www.icicisecurities.com; www.idbicapital.com; www.iiflcapital.com; www.motilaloswal.com; www.nuvama.com; www.pantomathcapital.com and www.360.one, respectively for the "Basis for Offer Price" updated for the above. You may scan the QR code for accessing the website of Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited.

AN INDICATIVE TIMETABLE IN RESPECT OF THE OFFER IS SET OUT BELOW:

Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors):		Bid/Offer Programme	
Bid/Offer Period (except the Bid/Offer Closing Date)		Event	Indicative Date
Submission and Revision in Bids	Only between 9.00 a.m. and 7.00 p.m. IST	Anchor Investor Bid/Offer Date	Wednesday, September 16, 2026
Bid/Offer Closing Date		Bid/Offer Opens On	Thursday, September 17, 2026
Submission of electronic applications (online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) for RIBs and Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion	Only between 9.00 a.m. and up to 7.00 p.m. IST	Bid/ Offer Closing Date	Monday, September 21, 2026
Submission of electronic application (bank ASBA through online channels like internet banking, mobile banking and syndicate ASBA applications through UPI as a payment mechanism where Bid Amount is above ₹0.20 million)	Only between 9.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST	Finalisation of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange	On or about Tuesday, September 22, 2026
Submission of electronic applications (syndicate non-retail, non-individual applications)	Only between 9.00 a.m. and up to 3.00 p.m. IST	Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors)/unblocking of funds from ASBA Account*	On or about Wednesday, September 23, 2026
Submission of Physical Applications (Bank ASBA)	Only between 9.00 a.m. and up to 1.00 p.m. IST	Credit of Equity Shares to demat accounts of Allottees	On or about Wednesday, September 23, 2026
Submission of physical applications (syndicate non-retail, non-individual applications where Bid Amount is more than ₹0.50 million)	Only between 9.00 a.m. and up to 12.00 p.m. IST	Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on BSE	On or about Thursday, September 24, 2026
Modification/Revision/cancelled of Bids		*In case of (i) any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBAAccounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date for cancelled/ withdrawn/ deleted ASBA Forms, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date on which the request for cancellation/ withdrawal/ deletion is placed in the Stock Exchange bidding platform until the date on which the amounts are unblocked (ii) any blocking of multiple amounts for the same ASBAForm (for amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism), the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the total cumulative blocked amount except the original application amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such multiple amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iii) any blocking of amounts more than the Bid Amount, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the difference in amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such excess amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iv) any delay in unblocking of non-allotted/ partially allotted Bids, exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher for the entire duration of delay exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date by the SCSB responsible for causing such delay in unblocking. The BRLMs and M-BRLM shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking. The Bidders shall be compensated in the manner specified in the SEBI ICDR Master Circular, which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the deemed agreement of our Company with the SCSBs, to the extent applicable, issued by SEBI, and any other applicable law in case of delays in resolving investor grievances in relation to blocking/unblocking of funds. The processing fees for applications made by the UPI Bidders using the UPI Mechanism may be released to the remitter banks (SCSBs) only after such banks provide a written confirmation on compliance with SEBI ICDR Master Circular, which has also prescribed that all individual investors applying in initial public offerings opening on or after May 1, 2022, where the application amount is up to ₹0.50 million, shall use UPI, RIBs, Eligible Employees Bidding under Employee Reservation Portion for up to ₹0.50 million (net of the Employee Discount) and individual investors Bidding under the Non-Institutional Portion Bidding for more than ₹0.20 million and up to ₹0.50 million, using the UPI Mechanism, shall provide their UPI ID in the Bid-cum-Application Form for Bidding through Syndicate, sub-syndicate members, Registered Brokers, RTAs or CDPs, or online using the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account (3 in 1 type accounts), provided by certain brokers.	
Upward Revision of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders categories ¹	Only between 9.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST on Bid/Offer Closing Date		
Upward or downward Revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RIBs and Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion	Only between 9.00 a.m. and up to 7.00 p.m. IST		
* UPI mandate end time shall be 7:00 p.m. on the Bid/Offer Closing Date.			
¹ QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders can neither revise their bids downwards nor cancel/withdraw their bids.			
On the Bid/ Offer Closing Date, the Bids shall be uploaded until:			
(i) 4:00 p.m. IST in case of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders, and			
(ii) until 7:00 p.m. IST or such extended time as permitted by the Stock Exchange, in case of Bids by RIBs and Eligible Employees Bidding under the Employee Reservation Portion.			

Continued on next page...

THE DEBATE OVER A.I.



King Charles III addresses a gathering of AI sector heads, government officials and thought leaders at Dumfries House in Cumnock, Scotland, on Thursday. AP

King Charles warns AI leaders of risks if tech falls into wrong hands

Reuters
Cumnock, September 17

BRITAIN’S KING Charles warned AI leaders Thursday of the “existential dangers” posed by the technology falling into the wrong hands, with potentially catastrophic consequences, saying safeguards were needed before it becomes “too late.”

Charles was hosting the co-founders of Nvidia and Google DeepMind, along with leaders from OpenAI and Anthropic, in Scotland as concern grows that AI safety efforts are lagging behind the development of increasingly powerful systems.

In recent weeks, the debate has centred on whether the industry can and should regulate itself, drawing interventions

“There seems urgency in adequately considering the existential dangers of such technologies falling into the wrong hands, and being used in potentially catastrophic ways”

KING CHARLES

from global figures including Pope Leo XIV, Charles and US President Donald Trump.

Charles said AI had the potential to improve and save lives, particularly in life sciences and medicine. But its

creators were increasingly warning it could develop darker capacities, “perhaps even to take life”, he said.

“There seems urgency in adequately considering the existential dangers of such technologies falling into the wrong hands, and being used in potentially catastrophic ways,” he told leaders gathered at his Dumfries House estate.

“Surely, we need sufficient means of control before it is all too late?”

Attendees included Nvidia founder and chief executive Jensen Huang, Google DeepMind founder and chairman Demis Hassabis, OpenAI Chief Financial Officer Sarah Friar and Britain’s Minister for Artificial Intelligence Kanishka Narayan.

HOUTHİ LEADER CALLS FOR END OF SAUDI ‘BLOCKADE, OCCUPATION AND AGGRESSION’

Saudis, Houthis exchange strikes; Yemenis flee on boats as war rages

More than 100,000 displaced by war: Migration agency

Reuters

Dubai, September 17

SAUDI ARABIA and Yemen’s Iran-backed Houthis exchanged fresh strikes across their border on Thursday and Yemenis took to boats in the Red Sea to escape fighting, as the spreading West Asia war created new threats to global oil supplies.

Houthi-controlled television reported fresh air strikes on Thursday in Hajjah province close to Saudi border near the Red Sea coast, and the vicinity of Taiz further inland to the south.

Saudi Arabia’s civil defence said a Yemeni living in Saudi Arabia had been killed by debris from a drone intercepted over the western city of Taif, the first death Riyadh has announced in repeated Houthi attacks since fighting escalated last week. It has previously said over 80 people were injured.

In Djibouti on the African shore of the Red Sea, Wahida Omer, 50, reached land after fleeing on a small boat across the Bab el-Mandeb Strait from Yemen when her home village of Dhubab came under attack as



Houthis stand next to a captured vehicle following an attack on Saudi-backed forces in al Jawf governorate, Yemen, Wednesday. REUTERS

the Houthis swept into the area. “The sea was frightening, difficult,” she said in an interview filmed by International Organization for Migration.

The IOM says more than 100,000 Yemenis have been displaced by the latest fighting, mostly within Yemen.

“We want the Saudis to cease their blockade and occupation of our country, and to stop their aggression against us. This is our demand!” Houthi leader Abdul Malik al-Houthi said in a televised speech, seated with a traditional dagger in his belt. Slogans on the wall behind him read: “Death to America, death

to Israel, a curse upon the Jews, victory for Islam.”

The spread of war to Yemen and Saudi Arabia threatens to worsen the global energy supply shortage caused since US and Israel attacked Iran in February.

US President Donald Trump has so far rebuffed pleas from the Saudis for military support fighting the Houthis, who agreed a ceasefire with the United States last year after Washington bombed the group for two months. “Well, hopefully we are towards the end of the war,” Trump said Wednesday, adding Iranians “want to make a deal. We’ll see how that works out.”

Sweden’s PM Kristersson resigns after losing election

Associated Press

Stockholm, September 17

SWEDISH PRIME Minister Ulf Kristersson submitted a letter of resignation to the Speaker of Parliament on Thursday following the announcement of a final vote count for Sunday’s election.

A group of Centre-Left opposition parties headed by the Social Democrats under Magdalena Andersson won 176 seats in Sunday’s vote for Parliament. Kristersson’s incumbent Right-

Wing bloc secured 173 seats, the election authority said.

Andersson, who became Sweden’s first woman Prime Minister in 2021, said the country would take a new direction after four years during which the government has driven a hard line on immigration and crime.

“In recent times there are those who have not felt welcome in our country,” she said in a speech carried on the X platform. “To you, I want to say



Prime Minister Ulf Kristersson

this: This is a new era now. That is what the Swedish people have voted for.”

Carney backs closer Canada-EU ties, Trump calls it a ‘hostile act’

Reuters

Strasbourg, September 17

CANADIAN PRIME Minister Mark Carney on Thursday welcomed proposal of becoming an “associate member” of the European Union, saying Europe and Canada were stronger together and should deepen ties to protect their citizens’ prosperity.

Hours earlier, US President Donald Trump had derided the European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen’s overtures as “laughable” and said he would hit Europe with further tariffs if he deemed the proposal hostile.

“Europe and Canada are each strong. Europe and Canada are even stronger together,” Carney told EU lawmakers.

“I am not proposing a third bloc in order to become a great-power rival — only with better manners,” he continued. “We



Prime Minister Mark Carney

do not seek power to dominate others. On the contrary, we are pursuing resilience so that no one can control our open markets, impair our sovereignty, threaten our territorial integrity, or undermine our freedoms, our democracies, our rule of law.”

Both the EU and Canada have been facing stiff rivalry and pressure from Trump’s administration on trade, among other matters, and from an increasingly assertive China.

Trump threatened Wednesday to take action against the

EU if it moves forward with von der Leyen’s proposal of associate membership for Canada.

“If they do that, if I think it’s at all a hostile act, I will put very serious tariffs or stop trading with Europe on many things,” Trump told reporters en route to an event in North Carolina, calling the proposal “laughable.”

“If it’s a good intention, that’s fine. If it’s a bad intention, we’ll put very heavy tariffs on Europe,” he added.

The European Commission said von der Leyen’s proposal — which is yet to be fleshed out and will need to be approved by EU member states to go forward — was not a hostile act.

“As our President (von der Leyen) made clear yesterday, the proposed strengthening of our partnership with Canada is not against anyone else, but for our common strength,” said Olof Gill, a European Commission spokesperson.

• BRIEFLY

NIGERIA

‘Menthol-laced’ drink kills 48, leaves 100 ill

AT LEAST 48 people have died and around 100 others are receiving treatment in southern Nigeria after consuming a drink suspected to contain methanol, officials said on Thursday. Banji Ajaka, Ondo state’s commissioner for health, said the cases had been reported in the Odigbo and Irele local government areas. A total of 182 people are believed to have been affected, he said. “This thing happened rapidly. Once they consume, depending on the quantity, the kidneys will pack up, the eyes will go, the brain will be damaged,” Ajaka said. Some of those who became ill after consuming the liquid have since been discharged from hospital, he added. Ondo state police. AP

PAKISTAN

Govt announces austerity drive as fuel prices rise

PAKISTAN ON Thursday announced austerity measures for three months to curb fuel consumption as conflicts in West Asia pushed up oil prices, threatening gas and power supplies. Fuel allocations for vehicles will be cut by 50 per cent, excluding those used by the armed forces, law enforcement and essential services. Markets must close by 9 pm, while marriage halls can operate until 10 pm and restaurants until 11 pm. Drug stores and medical laboratories are exempt. The government ordered a five per cent cut in non-employee expenditure, banned foreign trips and domestic travel for meetings, and prohibited dinners and purchases of government vehicles. PTI

Peter Max, famed for colourful psychedelic pop art, dies at 88

New York: Peter Max, whose colourful, psychedelic pop art expressed the optimism of the “flower power” movement of the 1960s and graced everything from postage stamps to a cruise ship, has died at 88, his son said in a written statement Wednesday. Max died Monday, the statement said. No cause was given.

Max began his career in graphic design in the 1960s, and his swirly, colourful, instantly recognizable designs epitomized the era’s “flower power” art. But thanks to his prolific output and fun, accessible style, Max’s work remained well known and popular well into the 21st century.

Max was the official artist for the Olympics, the Super Bowl, the Indianapolis 500, the World



Peter Max at the Academy of Recording Arts & Sciences in New York. AP

Cup, the World Series and many other events.. But in his first flush of success in the late 1960s and early 1970s, his murallike tableaux of flowers, the cosmos and cartoonish figures — all in vivid colors like turquoise, orange and neon green — seemed to be everywhere. Dorm room walls were plastered with his posters. Household furnishings like clocks and bedspreads sported his designs. AP

• FOUND IN BOLIVIA’S YUNGAS FOREST, THE CAT MEASURES ABOUT 18 INCHES LONG AND WEIGHS AROUND 1.4 KG, MAKING IT SMALLER THAN THE AVERAGE DOMESTIC CAT

In Bolivia, a new cat species identified— first in over a century

Reuters

September 17

A DIMINUTIVE wild cat that inhabits Bolivia’s cloud forest has been identified as a previously unknown species, marking the first time a new living cat species has been formally named and described in over a century.

The cat, called Tilcayo by local communities, is part of a group called tiger cats found across much of South America.

It was found in Bolivia’s lush Yungas forest, a mountainous region where forests are often covered by clouds and surrounded by high humidity, according to researchers. It

measures about 18 inches long and weighs around 1.4 kg, making it smaller than the average domestic cat. Researchers used genetic data to confirm that the cat is a new species, and gave it the scientific name *Leopardus tilcayo*, retaining its local name.

“Its fur is light brown ... with irregularly shaped rosettes across its body,” said Paola Nogales-Ascarrunz, a National Geographic Explorer and one of the authors of the study describing the newly identified species published on Thursday in the journal *Current Biology*.

Little is yet known about the cat’s biology and lifestyle. Remains of small rodents in scat samples suggest they may form



A *Leopardus tilcayo* cat, the newly identified species at the Senda Verde animal refuge in the Yungas region, Bolivia. REUTERS

part of its diet, while camera-trap evidence indicates it could be more active at night, Nogales-Ascarrunz said.

Tiger cats are so-called cryp-

tic species, meaning they cannot easily be distinguished merely by appearance, said evolutionary biologist and study co-lead author Jonas Lescroart of Uni-

versity of Antwerp in Belgium.

Tiger cats previously had been considered a single species, but genetic studies decades ago suggested the existence of multiple species.

Referring to the new species, Lescroart said, “Our information at this moment is limited to the two live individuals that we examined, and a small number of camera-trap records.”

One of the live cats is a 10-year-old male that now lives in Senda Verde Wildlife Sanctuary after being kept by a local family in their home.

Observing the Bolivian cat drew interest because “its characteristics did not match the descriptions, most of them

based on Brazilian cats,” Nogales-Ascarrunz said. “This made us wonder: what tiger cat do we actually have in Bolivia?”

The team analysed DNA from 38 cats sampled across several South American countries, including eight museum specimens. The study found that tiger cats are in fact five genetically distinct species.

“We never expected this Bolivian tiger cat to be a separate species, and no one had ever proposed it as a different animal, subspecies or otherwise,” Lescroart said.

Genetic analysis suggested that the Tilcayo lineage separated from other tiger cats about 1.4 million years ago.

FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 18, 2026



The Indian EXPRESS

JOURNALISM of COURAGE

NEW DELHI, LATE CITY, 22 PAGES

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Happening today

● **THE JOINT** committee of Parliament examining the contentious Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026 will hold its first meeting.

● **BCCI WILL** hold its 95th AGM during which it will discuss grant of associate membership to Cricket Association of Andaman and Nicobar Islands.

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Business as Usual

By EP UNNY



TRUSTS' VENU SRINIVASAN AMONG FOUR DIRECTORS BACKING CHANDRASEKARAN REAPPOINTMENT

Battle rages: Tata Sons board clears 5 more yrs for Chandra, Noel objects

Board also decides to pursue public listing, all eyes now on next AGM

George Mathew
Mumbai, September 17

THE CORRIDORS of Bombay House, the headquarters of the Tata conglomerate, have erupted into an explosive new power struggle. In a dramatic shift of trajectory on Thursday, the Tata Sons' board approved a fresh five-year extension for Executive Chairman N Chandrasekaran, alongside a pivotal decision to pursue a public listing to comply with Reserve Bank of India (RBI) mandates.

The decision to reappoint Chandrasekaran comes barely five months after the Tata Sons



(Clockwise from above) Tata Sons Executive Chairman N Chandrasekaran; Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata; and Chairman Emeritus of TVS Motor Venu Srinivasan at Bombay House, Thursday. ANI, FILE



board had deferred a proposal to extend his current tenure beyond its expiry on February 20, 2027 after it failed to secure unanimous support. Chandrasekaran had subsequently in August said he would not seek another term.

Noel: Listing will destroy company's character, page has turned on Chandra

George Mathew
Mumbai, September 17

ARMED WITH a legal opinion from Justice D Y Chandrachud, former Chief Justice of India, Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata said the reappointment of N Chandrasekaran as Executive Chairman of Tata Sons was legally void. He also warned that Tata Sons' listing will destroy its character.

Justice Chandrachud's opinion related to the "correctness of the Trusts' stand" that any appointment or reappointment required the approval of both the nominee directors of

ECONOMY PAGE 13

SP GROUP TABLES
RS 25,000 CRORE
STAKE SALE PLAN

the Trusts. While one nominee director, Venu Srinivasan, backed another five-year term for Chandrasekaran, Noel Tata rejected it.

Both the decisions taken at the board meeting of Tata Sons — reappointing Chandrasekaran, and public listing of Tata sons — need to be ratified in the annual general meeting of Tata

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

SEMICON INDIA 2026



Prime Minister Narendra Modi interacts with participants during Semicon India 2026 in New Delhi, Thursday. ANI

PM pitches India as trusted base for chip manufacturing

'India's economy growing... world's trust in India is also increasing'

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, September 17

THE WORLD needs "new and trusted locations" for semiconductor manufacturing and India is readying itself to meet that requirement, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said Thursday, as he pitched the country as an alternative manufacturing hub at a time when chip companies are look-

ECONOMY PAGE 13

SEMICON DRAWS UP TO \$12 BN IN INVESTMENT PROPOSALS: VAISHNAW

ing to diversify their global supply chains.

Inaugurating SEMICON India 2026 in New Delhi, Modi said India has now entered the second phase of its semiconductor journey, moving beyond policy announcements and construction of plants towards commercial production of chips.

He framed the push within a broader narrative of economic momentum, citing 7.8 per cent quarterly GDP growth, a

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

As Trump gets power to punish Russia partners, India warns of 'potential implications' for ties

US House clears Bill that can lead to tariffs up to 100% on Moscow's energy buyers

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, September 17

HOURS AFTER the US House of Representatives passed a Bill which will allow President Donald Trump to impose sanctions on Russia and tariffs up to 100 per cent on Moscow's energy trading partners, India said Thursday it "remains firmly committed to ensuring energy security for its 1.4 billion people" and warned of "potential implications" for "the bilateral relationship" with the US.

The Ministry of External Affairs, in a statement, underlined that "this issue has been discussed at high levels in recent months with various US

E. EXPLAINED

Amid talks to firm up a trade deal

Many in Delhi view the passage of this Bill as providing a leverage to the Trump administration at a time when it is working to conclude a trade deal with India. India had signed an interim deal in early February, which was supposed to lead to a full-fledged trade deal.

interlocutors". The US move comes at a time when Delhi and

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Missing in EC affidavit on SIR in Bengal: Break-up of appeals for name inclusion, exclusion

Of 38.20 lakh appeals, 1.02 lakh disposed of, poll panel informs SC

Damini Nath
New Delhi, September 17

THE ELECTION Commission of India has informed the Supreme Court that only 1.02 lakh of the 38.20 lakh appeals filed against the deletion and inclusion of electors in the West Bengal Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls have been disposed of so far, five months since the Supreme Court-ordered appellate tribunals began functioning.

The EC submitted a counter-affidavit Thursday in response to a July 17 notice on a petition by West Bengal Con-



At a SIR hearing in West Bengal's Murshidabad. EXPRESS FILE

38,20,683 Appeals filed

1,02,231 Appeals disposed of

37,18,452 Appeals pending

gress leader Prasenjit Bose who sought details of the pending appeals as well as additions and deletions to the rolls in the state.

But the EC counter-affidavit did not provide a break-up of how many appeals were filed by the 27.16 lakh deleted elec-

tors wanting to get back on the rolls or by the poll panel against inclusion of names.

On August 25, during a hearing on a clutch of petitions relating to the West Bengal SIR, Justice Joymalya Bagchi, one

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

INTERIM ORDER

Ahead of Bengal bypolls, TMC name, symbol are frozen by EC

Damini Nath
New Delhi, September 17

IN AN interim decision on Thursday, the Election Commission ordered a freeze on the name and election symbol of the All India Trinamool Congress, and directed the two rival factions to select new names and symbols until the dispute is resolved.

The EC's decision comes 10 days after it announced bypolls in two Assembly constituencies in West Bengal — Nandigram and Rejinagar — on October 6. Both the factions, led by Mamata Banerjee and Arup Roy, have nominated candidates for the bypolls.

"On due consideration of the totality of information available on record...the Commission is of the opinion that there are two rival groups in the All India Trinamool Congress, one led by Ms Mamata Banerjee and the other led by Shri Arup Roy, and each group is now claiming to be the party and therefore the matter requires a substantive determination by the Commission under Para 15 of the Election Symbols (Reservation & Allotment) Order 1968," the EC order said.

It is under Para 15 of the Symbols Order that the EC decides disputes within registered parties.

The order said there wasn't enough time to resolve the dispute before the bypolls. "In order to place both the rival groups on even keel and to protect their rights and interests, and going by past precedence", neither group would be permitted to use the name All India Trinamool Congress and

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

On Modi's birthday, his Varanasi seat home to NDA show of unity



Union Ministers Rajnath Singh, Chirag Paswan, Uttar Pradesh CM Yogi Adityanath, Andhra Pradesh CM N Chandrababu Naidu and UP BJP president Pankaj Chaudhary at Kashi Vishwanath Temple in Varanasi, Thursday. ANI

MORE REPORTS, PAGE 6

Lalmani Verma
Varanasi, September 17

THE BJP kicked off month-long celebrations as Prime Minister Narendra Modi turned 76 on Thursday, with allies N Chandrababu Naidu and Chirag Paswan joining senior party leaders, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh and Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, in the PM's parliamentary constituency Varanasi.

The four offered prayers seeking the PM's good health and flagged off a bike yatra from Varanasi to his hometown of Vadnagar in Gujarat. The bike yatra is being organised as part of the "Seva Sankalp Abhiyan" to mark Modi's 25 years in public office.

In Varanasi, 76 young priests performed special prayers and a milk "abhishek" on the banks of the Ganga seeking Modi's long

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

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ABHISHEK BEATS ROHIT'S RECORD WITH 30-BALL CENTURY IN T20I

DISHA SALIAN: CBI INVOKES CHARGES OF GANGRAPE, MURDER IN NEW FIR

EXPRESS special

Six months after docking, Iranian navy ship still in Kochi, with some crew members

Lavan got safe harbour the day a US submarine sank Dena near Sri Lanka

Divya A & Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, September 17

SIX MONTHS after the outbreak of the war in West Asia, Iranian Navy landing ship IRIS Lavan, which docked in Kochi on March 4, the day the frigate

IRIS Dena was sunk by a US submarine in the waters near Sri Lanka, remains at the port city with part of its crew.

The Lavan and Dena had come to India in February to participate in the International Fleet Review and the MILAN 2026

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



A March 7 Reuters photograph shows IRIS Lavan at Kochi port

FOUR YEARS INTO INDIA'S CHEETAH REINTRODUCTION PROJECT, TWO UNRELATED MALES SHARE KILLS, GROOM EACH OTHER AND DEFEND THEIR TERRITORY TOGETHER

These two cheetahs aren't related — but at Kuno, they have become inseparable

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, September 17

TWO MALE cheetahs stalk the wilderness of Kuno National Park, watching each other's back, sharing kills and establishing their territory. Separated by genetics and a whole continent, one could say they are brothers from another mother.

Exactly four years after the ambitious cheetah project was launched in India, wildlife officials at Kuno have begun celebrating this unusual male coalition, usually made up of siblings.

At Kuno, KNG23 was born to a cheetah named Nirva. CCB4

arrived from Botswana on February 28 this year.

"This is a very rare phenomenon," said Uttam Kumar Sharma, director of Kuno National Park. "What is particularly interesting is that these are two unrelated male cheetahs, with an age difference of around six to seven months, and yet they have accepted each other and formed a coalition."

The relationship began in circumstances that had little to do with any deliberate attempt to pair the animals.

Around March, KNG23, then about 16 months old, was separated from its mother and siblings after sustaining an in-

jury that required isolation. CCB4, meanwhile, arrived from Botswana without its sisters. The two young males were housed on opposite sides of a fence and continued to show interest in one another. KNG23 was later released into the wild with its mother, brother and sister on May 30. The family remained together for several weeks. By late July, however, KNG23 was injured again. By then, its sisters had dispersed into the wild on their own.

And so, KNG23 and CCB4 found themselves near each other once more. This time, the field team removed the fence between them.



Male cheetahs KNG23 and CCB4 at Kuno National Park

A budding friendship

Their first encounter was over food. According to Kuno's officials, the animals shared a kill without aggression, and neither tried to drive the other away. The team did not immediately interpret that encounter as evidence of a coalition. Sharing a meal by itself was not enough.

Then the bonhomie grew between the two.

KNG23 started following CCB4 and sitting nearby. The two began calling to each other when they were out of sight. They moved together, hunted together and shared kills. They were also observed grooming each other and, on at least one occasion, supporting each other

when a rival coalition challenged them.

"These were no longer simply two cheetahs tolerating each other. They were beginning to behave like a team. A coalition was taking shape," said a wildlife official.

For Sharma, the significance lies in what the animals may be demonstrating about the flexibility of cheetah social behaviour.

"Male cheetahs do form coalitions, but generally, when they grow older, they become less accepting of another unrelated male," he said. "If they form a coalition when they are very young, it can continue, but as they mature, it becomes more

difficult for two different males to stay together. That is why this particular case is unusual."

The test, therefore, will not be whether the two animals can remain together in an enclosure. It will be what happens as they mature and begin confronting the pressures of life in the wild: competing males, access to territory, food and eventually females.

The park already has other examples of male coalitions forming among the growing cheetah population. Kuno has a five-male coalition: three older males and two younger. The two male cubs born to Jwala have formed a coalition, while two of

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Former Keralam DGP Tomin gets a 4-year jail term in assets case

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, September 17

A SPECIAL vigilance court in Kottayam on Thursday sentenced former DGP Tomin J Thachankary to four years of rigorous imprisonment in a disproportionate assets case.

The Vigilance and Anti-Corruption Bureau alleged that the now-retired IPS officer amassed wealth disproportionate to his known sources of income between 2003 and 2007, with a 2007 FIR estimating excess at as much as 135 percent.

He retired in 2023. Vigilance court prosecutor K K Sreekanth said apart from undergoing imprisonment for four years, former DGP has to pay a fine of Rs 30 lakh — “He will have to be lodged in prison as the sentence exceeds three years. The trial court cannot grant bail to him”.

A charge sheet was filed in the case in 2013, but trial remained pending and resumed after a directive from Kerala HC last year. The then CPI(M)-led state government accorded sanction for further investigation against Thachankary in January 2021 and entrusted probe to another special investigation unit. Bobby Kuruvila, an anti-corruption crusader, challenged government order, arguing government could not have ordered further investigation when criminal proceedings against Thachankary reached a stage where final report had already been filed before special court.

The HC had expressed concern over the prolonged investigation and delays, attributing some of delay to the accused’s actions. It criticised the state for enabling such delays, which undermines public confidence in the justice system. The court noticed there was no new material brought to the government’s notice to seek further in-



Tomin J Thachankary

vestigation in the matter.

In August 2025, a division bench of the HC directed special court to expedite the framing of charges against the IPS officer based on the final report already filed before it by the Vigilance.

A 1987-batch Keralam-cadre IPS officer, Thachankary retired in 2023 as a DGP-rank officer and director general of investigation at State Human Rights Commission. Thachankary retired after 36 years in police in a career that saw him hold key posts in police department, but faced allegations ranging from custodial torture to illegal foreign trips and disproportionate assets. In early 2000s, Thachankary renovated the studio of the CPI(M)-controlled Kairali TV — a development that triggered speculation about his relationship with the party.

The arrest of his gunman at Kochi airport on charges of smuggling electronic equipment in 2002 was another low for the officer. The gunman had allegedly been accompanying Thachankary — then a DIG — on a return trip from Singapore to Kochi via Chennai, with a Vigilance probe eventually alleging that the gunman had illegally carried in the equipment with the knowledge of his boss.

Investigators alleged the IPS officer had flown to foreign countries 72 times between 1996 and 2001. The probe did not meet its logical end, prompting allegations of political pressure.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

Tata war rages

other. Noel Tata had voted against Chandrasekaran’s reappointment and declared the board’s vote legally void. In a separate statement, Tata Trusts said since Noel Tata, one of the Trust nominee directors, voted against the proposal, it was rendered legally void and without any basis.

Four of the total six directors voted favouring Chandrasekaran’s reappointment. Noel Tata was the only director who opposed the decision. Chandrasekaran did not vote.

The rift has exposed a deepening fault line between the holding company’s corporate management — the board and the Chairman — and its controlling shareholder, the Tata Trusts, which holds a decisive 66 per cent stake in Tata Sons. Tata group insiders are worried about the possibility of the worsening power struggle between Noel Tata and Tata Sons board impacting the group’s performance in the near term as Tata Sons guides capital allocation and new project proposals of the group.

After a tense board meeting on Thursday, Tata Sons Ltd said Chandrasekaran “acceded to the board’s request to re-consider his decision” to leave Tata Sons by February 2027. “The board thereafter resolved by a majority vote to re-appoint him as Executive Chairman for a further term of five years upon the expiry of his current tenure,” Tata Sons said in a statement after the board meeting.

Tata Trusts came out strongly against the resolution, stating it was a legal nullity in view of the provisions of the Articles of Association of Tata Sons. Noel Tata also submitted a legal opinion obtained from Justice DY Chandrachud, former Chief Justice of India, regarding “the correctness of the Trusts’ stand” at the board meeting on Thursday.

The board’s decision reverses that trajectory and places the

question of Chandrasekaran’s continuation squarely before the shareholders at the AGM. When and how the AGM will take place is a million-dollar question. Tata Trusts trustees themselves are divided on these issues.

This is significant because Tata Trusts has historically exercised considerable influence over the composition of the holding company’s board. The differences over Chandrasekaran’s continuation have been part of a broader governance tussle within the Tata Group.

The board’s decision also comes in the backdrop of the Reserve Bank of India’s directive that has effectively pushed Tata Sons towards a public listing. On September 11, the RBI rejected Tata Sons’ application to surrender its registration and remain an unregistered Core Investment Company, directing it to take the necessary steps to comply with the applicable regulatory requirements.

At Thursday’s meeting, the board also decided to take all necessary steps to comply with the RBI directive and proceed with the process required for listing Tata Sons.

The listing issue has itself divided Tata Trusts. While Noel Tata and some former Tata Sons directors have opposed taking the holding company public, other trustees — Srinivasan and Vijay Singh — have supported the move. The Shapoorji Pallonji group, which holds 18.37 per cent in Tata Sons, is also in favour of a listing.

The board also resolved to initiate steps to comply with the applicable RBI guidelines and said it would seek guidance from the RBI, Tata Trusts and other stakeholders on applicable compliance requirements.

The board includes N Chandrasekaran, Tata Sons Chairman; Noel Tata, Chairman of Tata Trusts; Venu Srinivasan, TVS Group Chairman Emeritus;

Harish Manwani, former global COO of Unilever; Anita M George, former World Bank official; and Saurabh Agrawal, Group CFO of Tata Sons.

On September 3, the Nomination Remuneration Committee of the Tata Sons’ board had met to discuss the re-appointment of Chandrasekaran. “After due deliberation, and in recognition of his contributions and the larger interests of the Tata Group, the NRC unanimously resolved to request him to reconsider his decision and to recommend him for re-appointment at the next Board meeting,” Tata Sons said.

Legally void, says Tata Trusts

Opposing the board’s decisions, Tata Trusts said: “Specifically, the process for appointing a chairman under the Article of Association requires a majority of the Trusts’ nominee directors voting in favour of the resolution... That process applies equally to a first appointment and to reappointing someone who already holds the office”.

“The board, accordingly, cannot lawfully hold a meeting or pass a resolution on the chairman’s appointment or reappointment unless both nominee directors are present, and cannot validly pass such a resolution unless both nominee directors vote in favour,” it said.

“Given that Noel Tata, being one of the Trust nominee directors, voted against the proposal, it was rendered legally void and without any basis,” Tata Trusts said. Venu Srinivasan is the other nominee of Tata Trusts on the board.

On August 12, 2026, the Chairman wrote to this board stating that he would not offer himself for a further term upon the conclusion of his present tenure on February 20, 2027. That was his own decision. “It was freely taken and clearly expressed. It was not sought from him by this board, it was not the subject of any resolution of this board, and it was not the outcome of any process of review,” it said.

TMC name, symbol are frozen by poll panel

the party’s “flowers and grass” symbol, it said.

“Both the groups shall be known by such names as they may choose for their respective groups, including, if they so desire, linkage with their parent party’ All India Trinamool Congress’... both the groups shall also be allotted such different symbols as they may choose from the list of free symbols notified by the EC for the purposes of the current bye-elections,” it said.

The two sides have been asked to submit their preferences for names and symbols by Friday, 11 am.

Earlier in the day, the EC met both the factions. After the meeting, MP Kalyan Banerjee, of the Mamata faction, told reporters: “...we have said that no interim order should be passed”.

The Arup Roy faction was represented by Leader of Opposition in the West Bengal Assembly Ritabrata Banerjee at the meeting with the EC.

The split in the party emerged soon after the BJP won the West Bengal Assembly elections in May. On June 3, around 60 of 80 Trinamool Congress MLAs rebelled against the party leadership, chose Ritabrata as the Leader of Opposition, and secured recognition from the Assembly Speaker. The rebel faction later declared Arup Roy as the party chairperson.

In its interim order on Thursday, the EC noted that Mamata had informed it on June 23 that a meeting of the party’s national working committee was held on June 20, and the names of office-bearers and members of the national working committee were declared.

Noel

Sons. If the AGM vetoes the proposals, these decisions will not be approved under the Companies Act.

It may be a while before the next AGM of Tata Sons is scheduled. But Noel Tata’s strident stand has certainly set the stage for a showdown whenever it happens.

The Tata Trusts Chairman said the leadership succession process at Tata Sons is final and the company should remain unlisted. Refusing to accept the board’s majority decision, Noel Tata said the “page has turned” and “it’s time now to move on”.

In a note to the board before the meeting on Thursday, Noel Tata said the Tata Trusts — which hold a controlling 66% stake in Tata Sons — have officially accepted the chairman’s August 12 decision not to seek a term beyond February 20, 2027, and stated that the company must explore all permissible avenues and options to avoid public listing.

The escalating rift between corporate management and the controlling shareholders threatens to stall timely resolutions on long-pending, group-wide strategic priorities. The impasse could delay crucial determinations on capital allocation, restructuring underperforming unlisted ventures and finalising a unified approach to various regulatory mandates.

Rebuffing efforts to table a re-appointment resolution, Tata said any premature decision on chairmanship would be legally vulnerable and risks exposing the group to unnecessary litigation at a time when critical regulatory issues remain pending before the Reserve Bank of India.

It’s clear from his statement that Tata is determined to bring in a new Chairman and take steps to avoid listing of the company. However, he’s unlikely to get support from the board given its five-versus-one scenario. He will have to wait till the AGM of the company where the re-appointment can be challenged and rejected. That also seems uncertain now as Venu Srinivasan, a nominee from Tata Trusts, is opposing Noel Tata and the AGM will have to wait till quorum is attained. The stalemate is likely to continue for some time, according to Tata insiders.

Tata is adamant on Chandrasekaran’s exit. “In so far as the Tata Trusts are concerned, the intimation made by the Chairman vide his communication dated August 12, 2026 has been duly accepted and has attained finality,” Tata said. Calling for a clear boundary between corporate governance and regulatory strategy, he urged the board to move forward by establishing a formal selection committee under the company’s Articles of Association, insisting that “it is now time to move on”.

“On August 12, 2026 the Chairman (Chandrasekaran) wrote to this Board stating that he would not offer himself for a further term upon the conclusion of his present tenure on 20 February 2027. That was his own decision. It was freely taken and clearly expressed. It was not sought from him by this Board, it was not the subject of any resolution of this Board, and it was not the outcome of any process of review,” according to Tata.

The group’s employees, lenders, counter parties, and the market have all proceeded upon it. So has the majority shareholder. “The page has turned. grounds.

“You had these ships, and we got a message from the Iranian side that one of the ships, which presumably was closest to... our waters at that point of time... wanted to come into our port. They were reporting that they were having problems. And so, my recollection is this was on the 28th (February). And on the 1st (March), we said, ‘okay, you can come in,’ he said.

“It took them a few days to sail in, and then they docked in

The majority shareholder has acted upon it,” he said.

He said Tata Trusts have accepted the chairman’s decision, and have requested that this company constitute a selection committee in accordance with its Articles of Association to appoint a successor. That acceptance, and that request are matters of record. They were formally taken and communicated, the note said.

“A resolution now for re-appointment moved at this meeting would therefore ask this Board to set aside three things at once: the Chairman’s own stated decision, the acceptance of that decision by the majority shareholder, and the further process which that shareholder has asked this company to set in motion,” he said.

The chairmanship of the company is an office held by a director of this company. The chairman’s own position as a director is presently uncertain, the general meeting at which that question falls to be determined not having been able to proceed for want of quorum, he said.

In the six-member board of Tata Sons, four directors — Venu Srinivasan, TVS group Chairman Emeritus; Harish Manwani, Former global COO of Unilever; Anita M George, former World Bank official; and Saurabh Agrawal, Group CFO of Tata Sons — voted for reappointment and listing of the company, while Noel Tata voted against the proposals. Srinivasan, who opposed Noel Tata, is a nominee of Tata Trusts on Tata Sons board, creating uncertainty about the reappointment of Chandrasekaran.

On the RBI directive on Tata Sons regarding compliance of guidelines, he said, “It does not mention listing. It prescribes no particular step, and it does not say that the Company is in breach. What its legal effect is, and what it requires of this company and by when, are questions upon which this Board has formed no view.”

Tata said a listed Tata Sons would be accountable to institutional and foreign shareholders whose legitimate interest is financial return. It is doubtful that such shareholders would sanction deployment of capital to rescue a group company in distress, or the funding of a greenfield venture whose returns lie fifteen years away, he said.

“In March 2024, under the guidance of the late Ratan Tata, it resolved, unanimously, that the company should remain unlisted,” he said. Noel Tata had earlier asked Tata Sons chairman about the issue of remaining unlisted. “The Chairman reiterated that the company has taken all necessary steps to remain private. I do not read the assurance given in September 2025 and February 2026 as having expired,” Tata said.

“This company holds something in trust. Its majority shareholder is a charity. Its dividends fund hospitals, universities and research for which no shareholder will ever be repaid. Its capital has repeatedly been placed at risk for reasons no analyst would have endorsed and from which the country has nonetheless benefited,” he said. “That is not sentiment. It is the operating model of this House, and it has stood the test of time... A listing will destroy its character and strike at the heart of this principle.” Any structural step towards a listing will, in any event, require shareholder approvals which only they can give, so their involvement is not merely desirable but unavoidable, he said.

Chip

recent sovereign rating upgrade by a Japanese credit rating agency, and the New Delhi Declaration adopted at the

BRICS Summit India hosted this month. “India’s economy is growing, and on the other hand, the world’s trust in India is also increasing,” he said.

Modi said India has achieved in about four years what generally takes countries around a decade to build, but described semiconductor manufacturing as a “never-ending journey”. Twelve semiconductor projects were approved under the first phase of the India Semiconductor Mission, spanning fabrication, packaging and other parts of the chip value chain. Five of these have already started commercial production.

The government has now moved to Semicon 2.0, a Rs 1.27 lakh crore programme that widens the focus beyond large chip factories to areas such as semiconductor equipment, materials, design, research and development, supply chains and skilled manpower. Modi said the next phase would see the number of projects increase further, as India sought to build the wider ecosystem needed around semiconductor fabs.

India is witnessing rapidly rising semiconductor demand. It is projected to reach \$110 billion by FY30 and exceed \$200 billion by FY35, while domestic manufacturing remains at a nascent stage. The country spent almost \$150 billion on semiconductor product imports between FY17-FY25. Imports grew at a CAGR of 23% during this period, and if this trend continues, annual imports could reach \$240 billion by 2035. The government, therefore, has identified building a comprehensive semiconductor ecosystem as an urgent national priority.

Micron Technology CEO Sanjay Mehrotra said the company’s Banag facility in Gujarat had begun shipping DRAM (Dynamic Random-Access Memory) and NAND memory products to customers globally. Micron expects to assemble and test tens of millions of chips at the plant this year and scale that to hundreds of millions next year. Infineon Technologies CEO Jochen Hanebeck said India had potential to strengthen its position across the global semiconductor value chain as its domestic market and tech capabilities expanded. The German chipmaker now has over 2,800 employees in India.

Russia

Washington are trying to firm up a bilateral trade deal after months of negotiations.

Sources said the government had conveyed, in the past weeks and months, the adverse impact of such a punishing move on the bilateral relationship to, among others, US Secretary of State Marco Rubio and US Ambassador to India Sergio Gor.

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar is expected to travel to the US for the UNGA session next week, and there could be a window for talks before Rubio heads to India for a bilateral meeting in October. They will also be in Canberra where Quad Foreign Ministers are to meet next month.

The Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026, passed by the US Senate last month, was approved by the House Wednesday evening and will now go to Trump to be signed into law. Besides 203 Republicans, 58 Democrats and an Independent voted in favour of the legislation. Seven Republicans and 152 Democrats opposed it.

After the Bill’s passage, Democratic Senator Richard Blumenthal, said, “China and India, you better buy your oil

and gas somewhere else.”

Responding to this development in the US, the Ministry of External Affairs said, “The Government of India has noted the passage of the Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act in the US Congress. We are monitoring further developments on this matter.” “As stated on several earlier occasions, India remains firmly committed to ensuring energy security for its 1.4 billion people. It will continue to do so through diversified sourcing and on the basis of evolving market dynamics,” it said.

“This issue has been discussed at high levels in recent months with various US interlocutors,” the MEA said.

It cautioned about the adverse consequences of the move. “Its potential implications for not just the bilateral relationship but also the international energy market have been very clearly articulated by the Indian side,” it said. India depends on imports to meet over 88% of its crude oil needs, and Russia makes up over half of these imports. “The Indian side has also made clear its determination to take all necessary measures to protect its trade and economic interests. Government will work closely with Indian trade and industry bodies to deal with the implications of these developments,” the MEA said.

that is when this coalition developed.”

“Once they are released and we observe them outside, we will be able to see how they perform in the wild and how they respond to conflicts and other challenges,” Sharma said.

That question sits within a broader transition at Kuno. Four years after the first cheetahs were brought from Africa to India, the project is no longer concerned only with whether individual imported animals survive. India-born cheetahs are now growing up, dispersing and beginning to establish territories of their own.

“If you look at the cheetah project over these four years, it has progressed step by step,” Sharma said. “The first year was about introducing the cheetahs and ensuring their survival. The second year was about births and ensuring that the cubs survived — establishing breeding and then improving cub survival.” “The third year was mainly about the cubs growing up and releasing them into the wild, including mothers with their cubs. Now, in the fourth year, our main focus is for the cheetahs to gradually begin establishing themselves.”

Varanasi

life, while Rajnath Singh, Adityanath, Naidu, Paswan, along with UP BJP President Pankaj Chaudhary, offered prayers in the sanctum sanctorum of the Kashi Vishwanath temple. “We have prayed to God that our Prime Minister Modi ji has a long life and remains healthy throughout his life. We have also prayed that the goal of a developed India can be achieved soon,” Singh said.

In his speech, Singh said Modi’s 25 years in public office were only a “half an innings” and that he would serve the country for many more decades.

“A good leader is not merely the one who holds a big position, but one who dreams big for their country. That is the difference between a good leader and a great leader. Good leaders do not only dream, but also turn those dreams into ground reality,” Singh said, citing financial inclusion, UPI, and the use of technology in everyday life as examples.

Recalling the famous dialogue “*Zindagi lambi nahai, badi honi chahiye*” (Life should not be merely long; it should be meaningful) from the Hindi film *Anand*, Singh said the PM had

achieved this through his leadership, vision, and dedication. “For the past 25 years, he has been discharging the responsibilities of Constitutional offices with utmost dedication and will continue to serve the country for decades to come.”

Naidu, the Andhra Pradesh CM and TDP chief, emphasised the unity in BJP-led NDA. “We stand together; we will stay together for the future. Our unity is our strength, our unity is the country’s strength. *NDA ek hai, NDA majboot hai* (The NDA is one and strong),” he said.

Naidu — who opened his address with “Har Har Mahadev”, “Bharat Mata ki Jai” and “Jai Shri Ram” and drew applause whenever he switched to Hindi — said the country could become a developed nation in another 20-25 years only because of Modi.

Naidu said NDA had provided stability to the country. “Stability will build confidence, confidence brings investment, investment creates jobs. The chain is simple. Today, the whole country can see the result. Andhra Pradesh felt this partnership directly. The Centre stood with us for Amaravati and for Polavaram. For us, cooperative federalism is not a slogan. It is a daily experience,” he said.

The Andhra CM also advocated for the linking of rivers. “If

you link all rivers, India will be unstoppable. If you link the Brahmaputra, the Ganga, the Mahanadi, the Cauvery, and the Godavari, then India will be a different India,” he said.

Paswan, the Union Minister for Food Processing Industries and the leader of LJP (RV), said he wanted to reassure that he stands firm in support of the PM. Recalling his association with Modi, he said his journey with the PM began around 12 years ago and that the latter had encouraged him in different stages of his political career. “Every moment spent with the PM has (had an impact on) my personality, my thinking, my struggles and my courage.”

Paswan said the PM had made efforts to bring different sections of society into the mainstream. “Whether it is women, youth ... There is no section, no caste, no religion where the PM, through his thinking, has not worked to bring that section and that individual into the mainstream,” he said.

After the speeches, 500 youngsters — wearing white T-shirts with photographs of religious places in Vadnagar, the Ganga, and the PM — set off on the bike yatra as BJP workers showered them with flowers. They are expected to cover 2,100 km in the next 20 days.

The crew was hosted at Indian naval facilities.

It is learnt that over two dozen essential crew members of the Lavan are still in Kochi, a long with the ship. The guardianship of the vessel has now been transferred to the Cochin Port Authority, sources said.

Responding to a query from *The Indian Express* for comment, the PRO of the Cochin Port Authority said, “As per directions from the Indian Navy, we are not in a position to dis-

close or share any information regarding IRIS Lavan at this stage. We are unable to provide any further details for the time being.”

The Lavan had 183 crew members on board when it docked at Kochi in March. A month later, India repatriated the non-essential crew members. It is learnt that over 50 crew members are still in Kochi.

On March 7, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar had said that India allowed the Lavan to dock in Kochi on humanitarian

Iran ship

multilateral naval exercises in Visakhapatnam. As the ships set out for home after the exercise, the war began. A third Iranian Navy ship, the fleet supply vessel IRIS Bushehr, sought refuge in Sri Lanka on March 5.

India allowed the Lavan to dock at Kochi on March 4 on humanitarian grounds after the vessel reported technical issues.

Bengal SIR

of the three judges on a bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, had told Senior Advocate DS Naidu who appeared for the EC: “Get your data, the nature of the appeals that are filed, whether it is for inclusion or for exclusion. And then we will take a call as to whether we prioritise the exclusion and then inclusion because an inclusion is not affecting an individual right, but an exclusion is denying a voting right. It will require some prioritisation. Nonetheless, it will bring down the burden (on the tribunals) to

some extent.”

The EC counter-affidavit showed that 38,20,683 appeals had been filed, of which 1,02,231 had been disposed of while 37,18,452 were pending.

The EC data showed that from December 17, 2025, when the SIR draft roll was published, until August 7, a total of 34.13 lakh Form 6, the statutory form for voter registration, were filled. This would include those applying for forms for the first time as well as those from the 58.20 lakh electors deleted in the draft stage of the SIR.

Of those, 4.86 lakh forms were unprocessed, 7.26 lakh forms for enrolment were rejected and 14,079 accepted. At

the same time, the EC data showed, a total of 6.39 lakh Form 7, the form for deletion, were filled, of which 14,506 were rejected and 3,355 were accepted.

The data showed that the gender ratio of the electoral roll — the number of female voters to 1,000 male voters — was 969 as on January 1, 2025 and had increased to 970 as on October 27, 2025, the day the SIR was announced in the state. The gender ratio fell during the SIR, reaching 956 in the draft electoral roll as on December 16, 2025, and recovering slightly to 964 in the final SIR roll published on February 28.

The data also showed that with a projected population of

10.40 crore as on January 1, there were 6.44 crore electors, meaning that the electors to population ratio (EP ratio) was 0.62, or 62 electors per 100 population.

The EP ratio is a measure of the health of the electoral roll. The number of voters should be close to the population above 18 years. During the 2024 Lok Sabha elections, the EP ratio for the country was 66.76 (electors per 100 population).

The SIR of electoral rolls was underway in nine states and three UTs from October 2025 when the Supreme Court, noting the trust deficit between the EC and the then TMC government in West Bengal, took the

Kochi. And the ship is there. And obviously, the people on the ship, a lot of them young cadets... They have disembarked. They are, you know, in a nearby facility... When they set out and came here, the situation was totally different. They were coming in for a fleet review, and then they got, in a way, caught on the wrong side of events. So for us, when this ship wanted to come in, and that too in difficulties, I think it was the humane thing to do,” Jaishankar said.

unprecedented step on February 20 of ordering adjudication of eligibility of electors in the state by judicial officers.

Around 700 such judicial officers decided on the eligibility of 60.06 electors who were marked “under adjudication” by the EC, ordering deletion of 27.16 lakh names and inclusion of 32.9 lakh. On March 10, the Supreme Court ordered the establishment of an appellate mechanism to give those aggrieved by the orders of the judicial officers a chance to appeal.

On March 20, the EC notified 19 appellate tribunals, each comprising a single retired High Court judge. The tribunals began functioning on April 13.

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GURUGRAM COUPLE ARRESTED FROM UTTARAKHAND

Adani Realty staff shot dead; ex-colleague, husband held

Pragnesh
New Delhi, September 17

A 31-YEAR-OLD Adani Realty employee, who left a Lajpat Nagar restaurant in South East Delhi after telling his sister he had an urgent meeting in Gurugram, was allegedly shot dead inside a car by his former colleague and her husband, police said on Thursday.

Gurugram residents Anya Vats and her husband Sanyam Sachdeva were arrested from Kainchi Dham in Uttarakhand nearly two weeks after Yuvraj Singh Manchanda, who lived in Sarita Vihar, went missing on September 6.

Yuvraj, an HR employee with Adani Realty, was having lunch with his sister, a doctor based in Faridabad, at Golden Dragon restaurant in K Block of Lajpat Nagar around 4 pm on September 6. He received a call and left abruptly, telling her he had a meeting in Gurugram and would return home by 10 pm.

“Around 4 pm, Yuvraj left the restaurant. When he did not return and his mobile phone was found switched off, the family made efforts to trace



The building in Sarita Vihar where the victim lived. EXPRESS

him,” said DCP (Southeast) Vineet Kumar.

When Yuvraj did not return for the next three-four days, his sister approached Lajpat Nagar police station and filed a complaint on September 11. An FIR was registered. During the investigation, police analysed his call records and found that the last call he received before leaving the restaurant was from Anya. His family then told police that Anya had allegedly been repeatedly calling and harassing him for a long time.

“As mobile phones of both Yuvraj and Anya were found switched off, extensive investigation was conducted, includ-

ing analysis of CCTV camera footage,” a senior officer said.

Meanwhile, the Delhi Police learnt that an unidentified body had been found inside a drain in Sector 70 of Gurugram on September 10.

“Photographs of the deceased were obtained and shown to the complainant and family members of Yuvraj Singh Manchanda, who identified him,” the officer said.

Police subsequently traced an active mobile number being used by Anya to Uttarakhand. A team arrested her and Sanyam from the Kainchi Dham area.

Police said Anya and Yuvraj had previously worked to-

gether at Emaar. In 2022, both were allegedly fired following allegations of financial mismanagement.

“The family of Yuvraj has claimed that he was fired because of Anya,” the officer said.

The two also allegedly had unresolved financial issues between them as well, police said, adding that while Yuvraj later found another job, Anya did not.

A police source said that Yuvraj’s family has alleged that Anya had been harassing him ever since: constantly calling, fighting with him and causing problems in his professional life.

On September 6, Anya allegedly called Yuvraj again. Police said he went to meet her, following which Anya and her husband got him into their car and shot him twice.

“They left the body inside the car for five to six hours, and then dumped it in the wee hours in a drain near their residence. They then left for Uttarakhand,” said the officer.

The couple has a one-year-old child, said police. “Both were produced before court, which sent them to five days of police custody,” said the DCP.

HC questions ‘blanket ban’ as cops deny nod to Karni Sena for Jantar Mantar stir

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 17

THE DELHI High Court on Thursday questioned the Delhi Police for denying permission to Kshatriya Karni Sena’s president Raj Shekhawat to hold a protest at Jantar Mantar against reservation policies, saying “how can there be a blanket ban?”

Justice Swarana Kanta Sharma was hearing a plea by Shekhawat challenging the Delhi Police’s denial of permission for organising a “peaceful protest” at Jantar Mantar on September 20 against the University Grants Commission (Promotion of Equity in Higher Education Institutions) Regulations, 2026.

Shekhawat’s proposed protest is seeking withdrawal of the 2026 regulations.

The police, while refusing him permission for the protest, has expressed that it apprehends more people will join the protest than is permissible.

“Just because you apprehend that some people will come....how can you refuse them?...If not Jantar Mantar, then suggest some other place. I am only asking the state how can there be a blanket ban?,” Justice Sharma inquired even as the Delhi police said that Jantar Mantar is a “very sensitive area”, adding that social media traction has led “the executive” to believe that “it (protests) will overspill”.

The police also informed the court that it has similarly refused permission to others also who have sought to protest at the site.

The court also suggested if the protests can be permitted with appropriate conditions in place. The HC will hear the matter next on September 22.

Before court today: Sir Sobha Singh Trust plea against RSS affiliate over rent dues of ‘15 yrs’

Shyamlat Yadav
New Delhi, September 17

A PETITION by the Sir Sobha Singh Public Charitable Trust over alleged non-payment of rent by RSS-affiliated trade outfit Bharatiya Mazdoor Sangh (BMS), among others, for four of its properties is coming up for a hearing before the Tis Hazari Court on Friday.

The rented premises comprise four rooms across two floors of the Sir Sobha Singh Building, located near the New Delhi Railway Station, which was once the headquarters of the Bharatiya Jan Sangh, the precursor to the BJP. The BMS occupies the four premises as its Delhi headquarters now.

The four matters related to the four portions are in court. In its petition, which was filed in 2021, the Sir Sobha Singh Trust has said that the respondents have been in continuous rent default for 15 years and continue to occupy the premises without authorisation.

Cases have been filed against Deshraj Gupta over three portions, and Jagdish Prasad Mathur over one (both Deshraj and Mathur are no more). Deshraj was the son of Hansraj Gupta, the late mayor of Delhi. The three other sons of Hansraj – Shiv Raj (also deceased), Rajendra (ex-Mayor and former Delhi minister) and Mahendra – are also named as respondents, as is the BMS.

Hansraj served as the Delhi Prant Sangh Chalak of the RSS for years and was mayor of Delhi Nagar Nigam from 1967 to 1972, as a Jan Sangh candidate. Mathur was an RSS pracharak who worked with the Jan Sangh and later with the BJP for decades.

Court records suggest that with none of the other respondents turning up in court, the



Office of Bharatiya Majdoor Sangh in Sobha Singh Building at Ajmeri Gate, New Delhi.

BMS alone is fighting the legal battle.

On January 28 this year, the BMS offered to pay the arrears, says its advocate Adarsh Tiwari. “Our case is solid. A certain rent amount is outstanding, and that we will pay.”

While the advocate of the Trust, Anand Singh, declined to comment, a source said: “They (the tenants) have been occupying the building unauthorisedly and not paying rent for several years.”

The BMS was founded in 1955 by Dattopant Thengdi. When the Jan Sangh started functioning from the building, it was a struggling outfit, and found its feet after 1967, when it became a part of coalition governments in a few states. A nearby building is now owned by the BJP and is still being used by it.

The Trust claims it has received no rent from the tenants since January 2006, with the arrears standing at more than Rs 1.27 lakh as of February 28, 2021.

According to the Trust’s petition, the tenancy was created around 1951 in the name of Hansraj, who was also an industrialist, with the premises to be used as a personal office linked to his work with both the BMS and Jan Sangh. Records show that the rent for one of the four portions was Rs 849.20 per month in 2013.

The Trust says rent and house tax were paid till 2005, with the last recorded payment of Rs 1,281 received by cheque dated January 24, 2006, for one of the portions.

As per the petition, on April 23, 2013, trustee Preminder Singh sent a notice seeking Rs 54,393 in arrears and invoking Section 6A of the Delhi Rent Control Act, 1958, which allows a 10% rent increase every three years. By that calculation, the monthly rent for a portion was Rs 772 in June 2013.

Again, on August 14, 2020, the Trust sent a notice to Gupta’s four sons and the BMS. The notice gave 15 days to pay the dues of Rs 2.48 lakh, with 15% interest, as well as to restore the premises and vacate.

The Trust has cited “unauthorised subletting” and “structural damage” as a second ground for eviction. As per its petition, a site inspection on July 14, 2020, showed the Gupta brothers no longer possessed the building and it was solely occupied by the BMS. And that the open balcony and verandah in front of the tenanted area had been enclosed and an unauthorised shed erected.

The Sir Sobha Singh Public Charitable Trust was created in March 1961 by Sardar Bahadur Sir Sobha Singh, with an initial endowment of Rs 5,000. Sir Sobha Singh was one of the principal contractors for Lutyens New Delhi, and behind the construction of historic buildings such as the South Block, the National Museum and parts of Connaught Place and India Gate.

The Trust’s original trustees included S Ujjal Singh (later Governor of Punjab and Tamil Nadu), S Bhagwan Singh, writer Khushwant Singh, S Daljit Singh and R B Nathu Ram.

MINISTER SAYS ALL DEMANDS MET, ONLY WAGE HIKE LEFT; UNION DISAGREES

‘This job doesn’t leave me with a single penny’: DTC drivers’ strike enters Day 3

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, September 17

Rs 862. This is how much a Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) bus driver earns in a day.

For many of them, the money is already spoken for long before the month is over. While for drivers like Joginder Singh, even getting to work takes a sizable bite out of that amount, for others, the wage is stretched between household expenses, loans and other costs incurred daily.

This calculation played out across Delhi’s bus depots on Thursday, when more than 10,000 drivers stayed off duty on the third day of their strike, leaving most of DTC’s 6,840 public buses parked.

The striking drivers are demanding improved service conditions, including a minimum daily wage of Rs 2,000, annual bonus, payment for working on government holidays, and medical insurance, among others.

Transport Minister Pankaj Singh said on Thursday that all the demands — except an increase in wages — have been accepted.

“I met the drivers today. Regarding their demands — whether related to medical facilities, leave, compensation for additional kilometres driven, or providing employment to a family member in the event of an unfortunate incident — I ensured that the concessionaire accepted all of them. I have secured approval for all their demands from the concessionaire,” he said.

“I also assured them that after consulting the Labour department and determining an appropriate amount, we would ensure that they receive a pay hike,” Singh added.

However, Lalit Chaudhary, president of the DTC Karamchari Ekta Union told *The Indian Express* that none of the demands of the drivers have been



(Clockwise from top left) Ashu, Imran, Sunil and Joginder.

met by the government in their negotiations. “The strike will continue on Friday,” he said.

Rs 80 to get to work

At Wazirpur, 150 buses stood inside the depot while drivers sat on mattresses outside. Among them was Singh (36), who has been driving for the DTC for three years. Every day, he travels from Jhajjar to Delhi to report for work, spending Rs 80.

“I need to support my two children, whose school fees are between Rs 2,500 and Rs 3,000 per month. Even travelling to work every day is a strain on my monthly expenses,” he said.

Singh drives around 105 km every day, making three rounds between Wazirpur and Nand Nagri. By the end of the month, he said, there is nothing left.

“I am currently asking friends to pay the EMI for my motorbike,” he added.

Petrol takes its share

The scene was similar at GT Karnal depot, where 121 buses remained parked and drivers

As strike leaves commuters stranded, some scramble to find alternatives, others pay more

Metro sees rise in passengers, 8 extra trains deployed

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, September 17

FIFTY-FIVE-YEAR-OLD FAREDA Jalal, a cancer patient, was sitting at the bus stop outside Lok Nayak Hospital in Central Delhi on Thursday, which marked the third day of an ongoing Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) drivers’ strike. Jalal was visibly exhausted after a chemotherapy session, and contemplating a difficult choice: whether to take a shared tempo for Rs 350, or the Metro that would require her to take the stairs, stand and walk.

A resident of Dwarka, Jalal usually takes the bus to and from the hospital. On Thursday, however, like several other passengers, she was stranded — scrambling to find other modes of transport.

The DTC’s 6,840 public buses see a daily ridership of around 40 lakh. With travel having been made free for



Parked buses at a depot in New Delhi, Thursday; (right) commuters bargain with an auto driver. AFSHANA BHAT

women, it is also among the cheapest modes of travel in the city. With more than 10,000 drivers currently on strike, according to unions, over 80% of DTC buses are off the city roads.

“I already spent Rs 350 to reach the hospital in the morning. It looks like I will have to spend that much again as taking the Metro will mean a lot of walking. I don’t think my knees can do so much,” Jalal said.

Around 20 km away, Radha (40) stood in front of Shadipur Depot in West Delhi. She had been trying to reach a jeans workshop, where she works, for the last one hour. “I boarded two buses, but one dropped me

at the next stop and another at the next red light,” she said. “But I have to report to work. I have to spend money on an autorickshaw ride now,” Radha says.

In Central Delhi’s ITO, 45-year-old Sheetal, who works as a domestic help, was bargaining with autorickshaw drivers for a ride to her Laxmi Nagar home, but in vain. “A shared ride usually costs Rs 20-30. But now every driver is asking for at least Rs 80. *Yeh auto wale faayda utha rahe hai hartalka, mooh boli rakam maang rahe hai* (The auto drivers are taking advantage of the strike. They are quoting whatever amount

they can),” she said.

Meanwhile, to assist commuters, the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation on Thursday deployed eight extra trains to run 20 additional trips.

Besides, the Delhi Traffic Police advised commuters to plan their journeys keeping in mind that the DTC service disruption is impacting traffic in certain areas.

According to officials, Delhi Metro has recorded a spike in ridership since the strike began on Tuesday. While 72.73 lakh passengers took the Metro on Monday, ridership rose to 76.86 lakh on Tuesday and further to 80.71 lakh on Wednesday.

● SOME TRADERS ARE HOPEFUL THE DECISION COULD BE ROLLED BACK BEFORE OCTOBER 15

Heard in Chandni Chowk: ‘No one carries cash now, merchants have to bear UPI fee’

Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, September 17

THE WEDDING and festive season rush is back in Chandni Chowk. The lanes are packed with shoppers picking up lehengas, sherwanis and sarees. But for traders, the buzz comes with a new worry – a 0.4% fee on UPI transactions above Rs 2,000, which the merchants will have to pay from October 15.

At Novelty Creations, where wedding clothes start at Rs 10,000, proprietor Rohit Khanna had been counting on the season to bring in good business. Now, he is calculating what the new charge could

mean for his margins.

“Almost all our products cost more than Rs 2,000 and everyone pays by UPI now. So, we will have to bear the charges. Along with the competition, a businessman’s primary obstacle to growth is the government,” he said.

“Our expenses are increasing every day. There is inflation, personal income tax, then GST and now this,” Khanna said, adding that his income had been “severely disproportionate” to his expenses.

Ajay Kumar Mittal, proprietor of a Lucknowi Chikankari store, echoed Khanna.

“Initially, they forced us to

shift to UPI. Now, 10 years later, they have levied charges. Some politicians say 0.4% is nothing. But in aggregate, for small traders like us, it is a huge number,” he said.

While there have been murmurs about switching back to cash transactions, Rakesh, a manager at another wedding garment store in the area, said that asking customers to make the switch is impractical.

“No one carries cash around these days. Even if we ask our customers to get the money from ATMs, most of them don’t work in Chandni Chowk and there is always a huge queue in front of the very few



Traders say asking customers to switch to cash is impractical. EXPRESS

that do,” he added.

There has also been talk of

customers splitting large bills into smaller UPI payments to

avoid the charge. Mittal, secretary of the Chandni Chowk Sarv Vyapar Mandal, said this was unlikely to work.

“Everyone has a limit on the number of transactions they can make in a day. So, most customers won’t be splitting a large payment into multiple smaller UPI transactions to avoid the charges above Rs 2,000,” he said.

Some traders, meanwhile, are hopeful the decision could be rolled back before October 15.

“One month will be more than enough time for the traders’ associations and the government to come to a consensus and make some changes,” said Anoop Goyal of

Anand Garments.

Mittal, however, is not so hopeful. “We have seen time and again, the RBI will introduce some measures, and we will have to bear the brunt. The RBI said the MDR (Merchant Discount Rate) levied for credit card transactions will be borne by us and not the customers... The MDR for UPI transactions is the start of something similar,” he said.

Mouj Baluja, owner of Balujas Shoes – a footwear store that has been around since 1919 – called the transaction fee a “strategic move” by the government. “First, they slowly eased us into UPI. Now, no one can

live without it. For this system to function smoothly, they have to levy these minimal charges.”

He worries that the fee could rise over time, increasing the burden on the merchants.

Chandni Chowk Sarv Vyapar Mandal president Sanjay Bhargava described as “unfortunate” the timing of imposition of the fee.

“The government could have introduced this in the next financial year along with the Budget. The market has been in a slump since the Red Fort blast last year, and just when things were picking up, the government has added to our problems,” he said.

Pay Rs 4 lakh more for Rahul event, Indore authority tells Congress

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, September 17

THE INDORE Development Authority (IDA) has asked the Congress to pay an additional Rs 4 lakh for the temporary use of government land for Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi's "Chhatron Ki Goonj" programme in Indore.

This comes after Congress had to shift to an alternative venue after its proposed programme at Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium was not permitted. The party has been allotted about 12,000 square metres of IDA land near Regional Park for the September 19 event.

The authority had allotted the land to the Indore city Congress committee for temporary use from September 17 to September 19. The IDA has now said that an inspection found that 4,800 square metres of the site had been used from September 14, three days before the permitted period.

In its September 16 letter to Indore city Congress president Chintu Chouksey, the IDA said the land had been allotted for the programme "from September 17 to September 19" and referred to an earlier communication that made it clear the land could be used only on the stipulated dates

Amid unease in Karnataka Congress, the brief life of a Siddaramaiah statue

Kalaburagi officials remove statue, cite lack of permission

Akram M
Bengaluru, September 17

AT A time when the Karnataka Congress is still in the process of settling down following a power transition, an incident in the city of Kalaburagi has added to the intrigue.

On Wednesday night, the nine-foot statue of Siddaramaiah was installed near a junction in Kalaburagi named after the former CM — the Siddaramaiah Circle — only for it to be taken down a day later. The statue came up along a route Shivakumar was scheduled to take to Afzalpur on Thursday on his way to launch several development projects as part of the Kalyana Karnataka Utsav.

"The image of the statue being installed went viral last evening (Wednesday). We do not know who put it up. Some youth have installed it without bringing it to the attention of Congress leaders or Siddaramaiah fans in the region. So far, no one has claimed responsibility," said Mahantesh Koulagi, a local Congress leader.

Kalaburagi City Corporation Avinash Shinde said no



The Siddaramaiah statue (left) that went up overnight at a junction in Kalaburagi city being removed on Thursday. EXPRESS

complaint had been registered on the issue. "The identity of those who put up the statue is yet to be known," he said.

The episode comes amid growing differences among various factions of the state Congress since Shivakumar took over as CM in June. While the transition of power initially appeared smooth, disagreements over the induction of ministers have highlighted the shifts in the party's internal power equations.

There has been speculation that Siddaramaiah was not happy with developments in the Congress, including the shifting of allegiance of several of his close associates such as Satish Jarkiholi, a Scheduled Tribe (ST) leader, and Zameer Ahmed

Khan to Shivakumar. The Congress leadership, however, persuaded the 78-year-old former CM with Cabinet positions for his son Yathindra Siddaramaiah and several of his supporters, leaving little room for rebellion.

Soon after Shivakumar became CM, veteran Congress leader and MLC B K Hariprasad was appointed Karnataka Congress chief. The appointment was viewed within the party as an attempt to prevent the concentration of power in Shivakumar's hands.

Siddaramaiah as face of the AHINDA (minorities, OBCs, and Dalits) bloc and his recent attempts to bring social justice back on party's agenda have not gone down well with many in the party, including Public

Works Department Minister Satish Jarkiholi who is a Shivakumar loyalist. After Jarkiholi was not invited to an AHINDA event in Bengaluru attended by Siddaramaiah and Deputy CM G Parameshwara, he said, "AHINDA is not the property of anyone." The remark was interpreted within the party as an assertion of Jarkiholi's claim to the AHINDA space.

Congress leaders acknowledged that the party's central leadership was monitoring these differences playing out in public. "This was expected after Siddaramaiah stepped down.

Though there was a realignment to prevent concentration of power, it has not satisfied everyone," said a Congress leader.

SC 'shocked' over unnatural deaths in Manipur camps, calls for report

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 17

THE SUPREME Court on Thursday expressed shock over a report about unnatural deaths in rehabilitation camps set up for people displaced by ethnic violence that hit Manipur in 2023.

A three-judge bench presided by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant sought a comprehensive report on deaths from the state Chief Secretary and ordered steps to ensure safety and dignity of the camp inmates.

The bench, also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, was hearing petitions dealing with the aftermath of the violence. The top court had earlier appointed a three-member committee under former Jammu and Kashmir Chief Justice Gita Mittal to oversee the relief and rehabilitation. The committee has been filing reports before the court from time to time, updating the status of the situation.

Perusing a report, the court

noted that it referred to news about unnatural death of 25 internally displaced persons (IDPs) sheltered in the relief camps across the state, one of them from sexual assault.

The court expressed its displeasure that though the committee had sought information on this, it was yet to be provided the same. It noted the committee had initially sought information on June 11 from Chief Secretary regarding deaths in relief camps and though some info was shared, it did not have requisite details. Therefore, another request was made on July 4.

"There are 25 IDPs who are stated to have died of unnatural deaths in the relief camps. One incident which has been reported to the committee is again very, very shocking. Because of sexual assault one of the victims has died... And the information was sought on 4th July. Why is that information not being furnished," the CJ asked the state government.

The counsel for the states said

he will look into the matter. "I will address the same immediately... We will expedite."

The bench also pointed out that a nodal officer had told the committee 640 deaths had occurred in the relief camps across eight districts, of which 34 were unnatural. Post-mortems were conducted in 20 cases while criminal cases were registered in respect of 25 deaths and prosecution has commenced in four cases. It pointed to inequities in payment of compensation to the next of kin, the court said.

The SC asked the state Chief Secretary to explain "as to why post-mortems were conducted only in 20 cases instead of all 34 cases. Similarly, the reasons as per the post-mortem report for the unnatural deaths be also explained. The state government is also obligated to explain as to why a meagre amount of Rupees 20,000 to Rs 30,000 has been paid to next of kin of internally displaced persons who met with unnatural death while they were sheltered in the relief camps".

CBFC flags screening of Umar Khalid documentary at IIT-Hyderabad

Says public exhibition of an uncertified film violates the Cinematograph Act

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, September 17

A PROPOSED screening of a documentary on jailed activist Umar Khalid at IIT-Hyderabad has likely been cancelled after the Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC) flagged the programme, stating that publicly exhibiting an uncertified film would violate the Cinematograph Act unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

The documentary, "Prisoner No. 626710 is Present", is directed by filmmaker Lalit Vachani. It was scheduled to be shown by a group of students at the institute's KRB Auditorium at 8 pm on Friday.

"Public screening of a documentary film that has not yet been certified by the CBFC is a violation of the Cinematograph Act unless a specific exemption has been sought under the Act," the CBFC posted on X. It also



Umar Khalid was arrested in September 2020 in connection with the northeast Delhi riots

tagged IIT-Hyderabad, stating the institute's authorities "may take note for necessary action".

Citing sources, PTI reported that the students have decided

to cancel the screening.

The invitation for the screenings said it was planned on the occasion of "Political Prisoners' Day". It also referred to death anniversary of Jatindra Nath Das, a comrade of Bhagat Singh, who died after a prolonged hunger strike in Lahore jail in 1929.

The development follows the postponement of a planned screening of the documentary at the National Law School of India University (NLSIU) in Bengaluru. This decision came after objections were raised by the RSS-affiliated Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP), which claimed that allowing the

screening would amount to using the campus for political propaganda. The student committee postponed the screening, citing "logistical and security considerations", while adding it would be held later in trimester.

Prisoner No. 626710 is Present is based on former JNU research scholar Khalid. He was arrested in September 2020 in connection with the alleged larger conspiracy behind the northeast Delhi riots.

Khalid was charged under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act and other provisions in the case and has remained in custody since his arrest.

कर्मचारी भविष्य निधि संगठन

Employees' Provident Fund Organisation

(श्रम एवं रोजगार मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार)

(Ministry of Labour & Employment, Government of India)

क्षेत्रीय कार्यालय, दिल्ली (उत्तर) /Regional Office, Delhi (North)

भविष्य निधि भवन, समुदायिक केन्द्र, वजीरपुर औद्योगिक क्षेत्र, दिल्ली-110052

Bhavishya Nidhi Bhawan, 28, Community Centre, Wazirpur Industrial Area, Delhi-110052

दूरभाष / /Telephone: 011 27376392 फैक्स/ Fax: 011 27376777, E-mail: ro.delhi.north@epfindia.gov.in

Ref: E/RO/DL (N)/DL/1366288/Comp-VII/2026-27 435/Int.

Dated: 16.09.2026

Public Notice

It is hereby notified to all concerned that an inquiry is under process in the Court of the undersigned for levy of Damages u/s 14B of the EPF & MP Act 1952 against the following establishment:-

S. no	Establishment Code	Name of Establishment with Address	Period of Inquiry	Next Date of Hearing	Competent Authority
1.	DLCPM1366288000	M/s Gracious Express, 8584, Arakashan Road, Paharganj, New Delhi-110055 & 8584, UG2, Ram Nagar, Paharganj, New Delhi-110055	From 01.06.2019 to 30.04.2024	22.09.2026	Regional P.F. Commissioner-II, Compliance-VII Regional Office, Delhi (North)

Despite being given ample opportunities of being heard, the concerned establishment or its representative has not appeared on the day of the judicial proceedings. However, one last opportunity is being accorded to the establishment to make its submission on or before the next date of hearing as mentioned above. It is also apprised that levy of Interest u/s 70 of the EPF & MP Act 1952 is also to be ordered against the said establishment for the mentioned period.

In the event of the non-appearance of the establishment/responsible person/representative on the above given date of hearing or non-receipt of any information, a decision will be taken on the basis of the available documents.

Sd/-

Kumar Shiladitya

Regional P.F. Commissioner-II

RO, Delhi North

Dated: 17/09/2026

Ref. No. DL(N)Adm.III/Publicity/2025-26/61

जड़ों से शिखर तक

18

सितंबर 2026

सुबह 11 बजे से

भारत मंडपम नई दिल्ली

डॉ. मनसुख मांडविया

केंद्रीय युवा और खेल मंत्री

किरेन रिज्जू

केंद्रीय संसदीय कार्य मंत्री, अल्पसंख्यक कार्य मंत्री

अनुराग ठाकुर

सांसद, BJP

कर्नल (Retd.) राज्यवर्धन राठौड़

युवा एवं खेल मंत्री, राजस्थान

श्रेयसी सिंह

खेल मंत्री, बिहार

गौरव गौतम

खेल राज्य मंत्री, हरियाणा

दिलीप तिकी

अध्यक्ष, हॉकी इंडिया

अशोक ध्यानचंद

पूर्व हॉकी खिलाड़ी, ओलंपियन, अर्जुन पुरस्कार विजेता

अजय कुमार

अध्यक्ष, बिहार ओलंपिक संघ

इशांत शर्मा

क्रिकेटर

शिवम दुबे

क्रिकेटर, टीम इंडिया

योगेश्वर दत्त

पूर्व फ्रीस्टाइल पहलवान, ओलंपिक पदक विजेता

सरदार सिंह

पूर्व हॉकी कप्तान

संदीप पाटिल

पूर्व क्रिकेटर, कमेंटेटर

आकाश चोपड़ा

पूर्व क्रिकेटर, कमेंटेटर

पारस डोगरा

कप्तान, सीनियर क्रिकेट टीम, जम्मू-कश्मीर

हरविंदर सिंह

पैरा-तीरंदाज, डबल पैरालंपिक्स मेडलिस्ट

अखिल कुमार

राष्ट्रमंडल खेल स्वर्ण पदक विजेता, अर्जुन पुरस्कार विजेता

अश्विनी नाचप्पा

पूर्व एथलीट, संस्थापक, अश्विनी स्पोर्ट्स फाउंडेशन

रानी रामपाल

हॉकी कोच, पूर्व खिलाड़ी

उदय विश्वनाथ देशपांडे

मलखंम कोच, पद्मश्री पुरस्कार विजेता

दीपा मलिक

पैरालंपियन, खेल रत्न, पद्मश्री, अर्जुन पुरस्कार विजेता

प्रीति जंगियानी

को फाउंडर, प्रो पंजा लीग

सत्यनारायण शिमोगा

मुख्य कोच, भारतीय पैरा-एथलेटिक्स टीम, राष्ट्रमंडल खेल 2026

अमित कुमार सिन्हा

स्पेशल प्रिंसिपल सेक्रेटरी, स्पोर्ट्स एंड यूथ वेलफेयर, कुलपति, उत्तराखंड स्पोर्ट्स युनिवर्सिटी

राकेश कुमार

पैरा-तीरंदाज, अर्जुन पुरस्कार विजेता, पैरालंपिक विजेता

PRESENTED BY

Kia Sorento

PARTNERS

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New Delhi



In New Avatar

ON THE occasion of PM Narendra Modi's 76th birthday on Thursday, the BJP encapsulated his journey from childhood to the highest office in India — and all the milestones in between — in a 1.15-minute video, set to a popular number *Destiny* from the film *Dhurandhar 2: The Revenge*. Conceptualised, according to party insiders, in a chapter-wise format similar to the Bollywood blockbuster, the video was released as a Netflix trailer. The caption accompanying the post on X read: "We've got some Netflix recommendations for you. Some journeys deserve your time. Witness one built on service, vision and determination." Divided into four chapters — Childhood, Formative Years, CM Years, PM Years... — the video comprises photos of his childhood, participation in defining party events, newspaper headlines, oath-taking ceremonies as CM of Gujarat and then as PM besides the achievements of the governments led by him.

Internal Rift

WITH THE Uttar Pradesh elections drawing near, there seems to be intense efforts from both the Samajwadi Party and the Congress to woo Brahmin leaders into their fold in the backdrop of the general impression that the community is miffed with the BJP in the state. Some moves from the Congress's state unit, however, appear to have irked a large section of party leaders. As per sources, a meeting between a former controversial health minister and an AICC leader and another one between a former MLA, who had been named in a murder case, and a top state Congress leader have left many party leaders confused. Both the controversial leaders are planning to join the Congress, sources said. A group of Congress leaders have vowed to "apprise" the national leadership of the "trouble" such inductions might cause to the party ahead of polls.

Manohar Lal meets US Interior Secy

Washington: Power Minister Manohar Lal met US Interior Secretary Doug Burgum in Houston on Wednesday, on the sidelines of the G20 Energy Abundance Ministerial, and discussed India's plans to meet the energy demands of its rapidly growing digital economy. PTI

'Govt needed to bend': Jarange calls off 20-day hunger strike

Express News Service
Mumbai, September 17

MARATHA RESERVATION activist Manoj Jarange Patil has ended his 20-day hunger strike and temporarily suspended his decision to proceed to Mumbai, giving the Maharashtra government three months to act on his demands on Maratha reservation.

Jarange, who had set out from Antarwali Sarati towards Mumbai as part of his agitation to push for reservation for the Maratha community, announced the decision at around 6 am after meeting a government delegation.

Among those who met Jarange early Thursday morning were Maratha Reservation Cabinet Sub-Committee Chairman Radhakrishna Vikhe Patil, Minister Dada Bhuse, MLA Suresh Dhas and MLC Prasad Lad, and the Beed district collector.

"I have decided to withdraw my hunger strike, but the protest will continue till our demands are met," Jarange said.

Announcing his decision to call off the strike, Jarange said that it is sometimes necessary to take two steps back to make a bigger move. "The government needed to bend before the community, and I made that happen through this agitation," he said.



Maratha quota activist Manoj Jarange Patil has also appealed to protesters, who had already reached Mumbai, to return. EXPRESS FILE

After the meeting, Jarange said the government had been given 90 days to fulfil the demands. If the demands were not met within this period, he said, the agitation would move towards Mumbai.

"Three years have passed since we started fighting for reservation. Now we will give the government another three months. We can say that we have been fighting for three years and three months. Although we are trusting the government, the agitation will continue. Even if we wait for 90 days, it will not make any difference. Let us consider this the last deception. These three months will be the last we give

the government," he said.

Jarange also appealed to protesters who had already reached Mumbai to return. While the hunger strike has been suspended, he said, the agitation itself would continue.

Explaining his decision, Jarange claimed that the agitation had brought to light around 58 lakh Kunbi records relating to members of the Maratha community and alleged that efforts were being made to reduce the number of such records. He also said the government had agreed to issue a revised Government Resolution concerning the Hyderabad Gazetteer.

"The government has said that 5.8 million Kunbi records

identified by the Shinde Committee will remain untouched and will not be reduced. The Kunbi certificates of the 4 public representatives from Marathwada that were revoked will be legally re-validated," according to him.

Jarange's health had deteriorated after he began his march from Antarwali Sarati towards Mumbai. He was administered saline at a pilgrim accommodation facility at the Vitthal temple in Patoda.

Welcoming Jarange's decision to call off the agitation in Mumbai, Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis said that the government has already accepted 12 out of 13 demands made on Maratha reservation.

"The maximum benefits to the Maratha community have been extended during the BJP-led government's tenure. The government is positively considering all his demands except one, which has legal implications," Fadnavis said.

"We are always committed to the welfare of all communities, including Marathas. We have accepted 12 demands. Only in one case are there some legal issues," the chief minister said, adding that most of the demands agreed upon are being implemented; they have to undergo an administrative process.

Putin, Tarique, Netanyahu, Meloni greet Modi on b'day

US Embassy wishes PM on behalf of Trump

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, September 17

WORLD LEADERS, including Russian President Vladimir Putin, Bangladesh Prime Minister Tarique Rahman, Israeli PM Benjamin Netanyahu and Italian PM Giorgia Meloni, wished PM Narendra Modi on his 76th birthday on Thursday.

The US Embassy in India also conveyed birthday wishes on behalf of President Donald Trump. Sharing an old photo of the two leaders, the US embassy posted on X, "On behalf of President Donald Trump, we wish Prime Minister @narendramodi a very happy birthday. Wishing you all the health and happiness in the coming year!"

The Russian Embassy in New Delhi said in a Facebook post that Putin had sent a message "warmly congratulating" Modi on his birthday. "You are rightly enjoying a deep respect



Bangladesh Prime Minister Tarique Rahman (left); Russian President Vladimir Putin

from your compatriots and great authority on the global stage. It is impossible to overstate your personal contribution to strengthening the special and privileged strategic partnership between India and Russia," the embassy said.

"The talks we held were undoubtedly substantive, frank and productive. As always, it was a genuine pleasure to talk with you, and our discussions once again demonstrated your extraordinary political wisdom and foresight. We will, of course, continue our constructive cooperation on pressing bilateral and international issues for the benefit of our friendly nations," Putin said in his message.



Union Home Minister Amit Shah with MoS Anupriya Patel, Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel and Maharashtra Deputy CM Eknath Shinde in Gujarat's Vadnagar on Thursday. EXPRESS

'Not a single stain on his kurta': Shah praises PM

Express News Service
Ahmedabad, September 17

AS PRIME Minister Narendra Modi turned 76 on Thursday, Union Home Minister Amit Shah said that Modi has lived a clean and corruption-free life, "like a lotus in the middle of a swamp, completely untouched by the water or the mud".

Shah made the remarks while addressing a public gathering in Vadnagar in North Gujarat's Mehsana district, where Modi was born on September 17, 1950.

"Since the time India gained Independence until today, no politician has set a record of serving for 25 years as both the head of a state and the head of the country. Modi Ji is the only leader who has accomplished this by continuously securing the public mandate for 25 years, winning every election, and receiving the blessings of the people. This is a very significant achievement. And the BJP and its NDA allies have decided to take this occasion to the people

across the country," Shah said.

"Some people who are cynical have asked, 'What is the need for this?' Today, I want to tell them: Modi Ji's life is such that it is essential to introduce it to every child, every adolescent, and every youth in India so that in the coming days, hundreds of Narendra Modis emerge from it and elevate India to its rightful place," he said.

Referring to close association with the PM since his early days in politics, Shah said that no one matches his simplicity. "...In his 25 years of public life, not a single stain mars his kurta. Even his opponents cannot accuse Modi Ji of corruption. Remaining like a lotus in the middle of a swamp, completely untouched by the water or the mud, he has lived a clean, corruption-free life."

"As I said, no one knows his family; that statement is, in a way, incomplete. The entire country knows Modi Ji's family because Modi Ji considers India itself his family. He considers the 1.4 billion citizens his family," Shah said.

age, according to the embassy.

Bangladesh Prime Minister Tarique Rahman posted on X, "Warmest birthday wishes to Prime Minister @narendramodi. Wishing you many happy returns of the day. May your dedicated service to the people of India always be accompanied by good health and high spirit."

Meloni, referring to Modi as a "friend", wished him in a post in Italian on X and expressed hope that the two countries would continue strengthening the bond of friendship.

Netanyahu's greetings were posted from the official X handle of the Israeli PMO, accompanied by an old photo of the two leaders' meeting. "Happy birthday, Narendra! Your leadership has transformed India into a world power. Together, we have built an unprecedented partnership between our two great democracies," the post read, adding that the India-Israel friendship had "never been stronger" and would scale even greater heights. He wished Modi "many more years of leadership, health and fulfilment".

Modi highlights Rs 3,000 aid to women, says 'cut money' no longer works in Bengal

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, September 17

TAKING A dig at the previous Trinamool Congress government, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said Thursday that "cut money" no longer prevails in West Bengal as money from the Annapurna Yojana reached the bank accounts of nearly 1.5 crore women across the state.

Addressing the 'Annapurna Divas' event virtually on his birthday — an initiative announced by Chief Minister Suvenudh Adhikari — Modi said the money under this scheme is being transferred directly to women's accounts, reinforcing that "less talk, more work" remains the guiding principle of the BJP government. He said the Rs 3,000 monthly aid under the scheme aims to strengthen women's self-confidence by easing household expense worries. "Our vision is that the women of Bengal should have both the power to make decisions and the courage to move forward. The Annapurna Yojana plays a crucial role in this. I extend my heartfelt congratulations to all the beneficiaries."

Modi noted that mothers and sisters played an important role in the change of guard on May 4, referring to the BJP's win in the Assembly elections. "As soon as the new government came to power in the state, work on the scheme began... Today, so many women are receiving money directly in their bank accounts. There is no cut money. No middlemen. Now, cut money does not work in Bengal."

"Together, we will build a new Bengal," Modi said.

● THE OVERTURES TO MAYAWATI'S NEPHEW COME AS PARTIES LOOK AT THE BSP'S CORE DALIT SUPPORT BASE AHEAD OF THE 2027 UTTAR PRADESH POLLS

NDA ally to Opp: Parties woo Akash Anand, eyeing BSP vote base

Maulshree Seth
Lucknow, September 17

FROM AN NDA ally to opposition parties and leaders of the Bahujan movement, political formations in Uttar Pradesh are attempting to reach out to Akash Anand, Mayawati's nephew, days after she "freed him" of party responsibilities.

This comes as parties continue to look at the Bahujan Samaj Party's support base ahead of the 2027 Uttar Pradesh Assembly election. Mayawati, however, has repeatedly ruled out electoral alliances.

Sanjay Nishad, Nishad Party Chief and an NDA ally, is among those who have appealed to Anand. Recalling the slogan, "*Ambedkar ji ke sapne adhure, Kanshi Ram karenge poore*" (Dr Ambedkar's dreams remain unfulfilled, Kanshi Ram will fulfil them), Nishad said, "I appeal to Akash Anand

ji to come forward, join the mainstream with his team and fulfil Kanshi Ram's dream."

Nishad's appeal comes days after Aazad Samaj Party chief and Nagina MP Chandrashekar also said that Anand would be welcome in his party. Chandrashekar said, "Brother Akash Anand wants to take the Bahujan mission forward. Even though he has used abusive words against me, if he wants to join the Aazad Samaj Party, he is welcome. We will work together."

Behind the move

Mayawati announced on September 10 that Anand was being "completely freed" from the BSP, after his father-in-law Ashok Siddharth retired from active politics. Anand had earlier been projected by Mayawati as her political successor and given important organisational responsibilities, but his posi-



BSP chief Mayawati and Akash Anand at a party workers' meeting at state party head office in Lucknow in May this year. EXPRESS FILE

tion in the party subsequently went through several reversals.

While some within the BSP expect that Anand could eventually be taken back by "*Behenji*", the interest from other

parties is also linked to the BSP's voter base. The party's vote share in Uttar Pradesh has declined sharply over the past two Assembly and Lok Sabha polls. In the 2017 Assembly elec-

tion, the party secured 22.23% of the vote and won 19 seats. Its vote share fell to 12.88% in 2022, when it won one seat. In the 2019 Lok Sabha election, the BSP polled around 19.43% of the vote in Uttar Pradesh and won 10 seats. In the 2024 Lok Sabha election, its vote share declined to around 9.39% and it failed to win a single seat.

While the BSP no longer has the legislative presence it once had, its support among sections of Dalit voters, particularly Jats, remains a factor that other parties are watching. Mayawati's repeated refusal to enter electoral alliances has further complicated the calculations of parties seeking to expand their social coalitions in the state.

Against this backdrop, political leaders appear keen to keep a channel open to Anand, offering him the possibility of pursuing the Bahujan political mission from their re-

spective platforms.

What Congress, SP say

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Congress state president Ajay Rai said the party would consider the possibility of working with anyone seeking to enter politics through democratic means. "Mayawati ji is aligned with the BJP", he said. "Akash Anand had spoken against the BJP, and there is pressure from the BJP on her. Anyone who wants to join through democratic means and is in the Congress, we will consider them."

Samajwadi Party Akhilesh Yadav, when asked recently whether he would take Anand into his party, responded that if Anand were brought to him, he would take him. "That is a decision for their party; people from other parties cannot say anything about it. If they bring him to us, we will take him in," Yadav had said.

India, Pak trade charges over collision of warships

Day after Delhi protest, its envoy in Islamabad too gets summons

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, September 17

A DAY after New Delhi lodged a strong protest over the "unprofessional conduct of Pakistani naval units" following a North Arabian Sea collision between a frontline Indian Navy warship and a Pakistan Navy vessel on September 15, Islamabad called the incident a "highly provocative and unacceptable action" within its Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ).

An EEZ is considered international waters, meaning that a country does not have territorial sovereignty over its EEZ. Foreign ships and aircraft enjoy the

freedom of navigation and overflight within the EEZ of a nation.

Pakistan's Ministry of Foreign Affairs summoned the Charge d'Affaires of the Indian High Commission in Islamabad over the incident, it said in a statement. As per the statement, the Pakistan Navy was carrying out its biennial exercise SEASPARK-26 when the Indian vessel executed aggressive manoeuvres in "dangerously close proximity to a Pakistani naval ship..." "The incident constituted a serious violation of international law and the bilateral agreement... and risked escalating tensions in the region."

According to Indian sources, the Pakistani vessel closed in on the Indian warship; it was not the other way around. Additionally, no warning was issued for the vessel to steer clear of that area, which is typically required during certain drills carried out in an exercise.



UP man 'held hostage' as domestic help and 'forced to sell blood' to repay mobile EMI

Express News Service
Lucknow, September 17

THE LUCKNOW Police on Thursday arrested two employees of a private finance company who allegedly forced a youth to donate his blood and work as a domestic help to recover the pending EMI amount against a loan the victim had taken to purchase a mobile phone. The police have announced a reward of Rs 25,000 on another absconding employee allegedly involved in the harassment.

Lucknow DCP, South, Mohammad Mushtaque told media that the two accused, identified as Aniket Singh and Sushant Sharma, have been arrested for harassing the victim, Newal, after his mother complained about her son being forcibly taken away by a few persons from the house on September 8. A case was lodged on September 14 on the mother's complaint, and an investigation initiated.

During investigation, the DCP said, the police team identified the accused as employees of a private finance company by using call details and other scientific evidence. While Aniket and Sushant were

arrested, one Shubham Singh is still absconding, he said.

While the victim had earlier narrated the harassment he faced to the police, the arrests were made after the two accused confessed to the crime on Thursday.

Newal, a resident of Rajaramkhara village in Nigohan police station area on the outskirts of Lucknow, had purchased a mobile phone from a local shop at a cost of Rs 21,500 in July end. The amount was financed by the private company located in Gomti Nagar area at a monthly EMI of Rs 2,799 for one year, the police investigation found.

Newal has no job or any other source of income but the shop and finance company employees still financed the loan amount. Newal could not even pay his first monthly EMI.

The recovery agents, Aniket and Shubham, visited Newal's house on September 8 and took him away. They allegedly took him to a blood bank where they forced him to donate one unit of blood, and collected the money thus obtained. Newal was later taken to Shubham's house where he was allegedly detained for over four days and forced to work as a domestic help.

TET paper smuggled out of Agra press under shoe insoles of staff hired by kingpin: Chargesheet

Mohamed Thaver
Mumbai, September 17

TWO DAYS before the Maharashtra Teachers Eligibility Test (TET) was scheduled to be held, the question paper was allegedly smuggled out of an Agra printing press hidden beneath the shoe insoles of a few employees who were paid Rs 8,000 each by the mastermind. This has been revealed by the Thane police, which traced the leak to the press.

The police have cited the "original paper" recovered from Bihar and the financial trail between the accused as key evidence in the case.

The Thane City Police on Thursday filed a nearly 3,500-page chargesheet against 18 accused, including two who are still wanted, in the TET paper leak case. Police have identified former coaching class teacher Bijendra Gupta as the alleged mastermind, while the other ac-

cused helped circulate the leaked paper in return for money.

ACP (Bhiwandi division) Vijay Marathe confirmed the filing of the chargesheet. "We have filed a nearly 3,500-page chargesheet against 18 accused, two of whom are still wanted. Based on further investigation, a supplementary chargesheet will be filed at a later stage," he said.

According to the chargesheet, the source of the leak was Mahim Patran Pvt Ltd, an Agra-based printing press where the TET papers were being printed. Two current employees and a former employee allegedly hid the paper under their shoe insoles and walked out of the press. Police say they were hired by Gupta for Rs 8,000 each.

A source close to the investigation said the original question paper was recovered from the Bihar residence of a relative of Gupta, who was subsequently arrested.

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 17

THE CENTRAL Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has registered an FIR in connection with the 2020 death of Disha Salian, the former manager of actor Sushant Singh Rajput, after the Bombay High Court directed the agency to probe the circumstances surrounding her death.

The FIR, registered on September 13 by the CBI's Special Crime Branch, names Disha's father Satish Ishwar Salian as the complainant. It invokes Indian Penal Code (IPC) sections related to criminal conspiracy, gang rape, murder, destruction of evidence, giving false information to screen offenders, and alleged misconduct by public servants.

The case was registered after the Bombay High Court, on September 2, directed the CBI to appoint an investigating officer, record Satish Salian's statement, and register an FIR. The court directed the Investigating Officer to probe all aspects surrounding the circumstances of Disha's death.

According to the FIR, Satish Salian's statement was recorded

The FIR records allegations naming several public figures, police officers, doctors, forensic personnel, security guards and others whose roles, according to the complainant, require investigation

on September 11, following which the case was registered. The FIR records the place of occurrence as Flat No. 1202, Regent Galaxy Apartment, Malwani, Malad West, Mumbai. It states that the alleged incident took place on the intervening night of June 8 and June 9, 2020.

Disha Salian died in June 2020 after allegedly falling from a building in Malad. Malwani police recorded the incident as a case of accidental death.

In his statement reproduced in the FIR, Satish Salian said his daughter, then 28, was working as a celebrity manager and had also worked with Sushant Singh Rajput. He alleged that the

family was initially told Disha had died by suicide and that he was under severe shock when police officers asked whether he had any suspicion about her death.

The complainant has alleged that he was not shown his daughter's body immediately, was later shown photographs at Malwani police station, and developed doubts after allegedly noticing an absence of blood or multiple visible injuries. The FIR records his claim that he was persuaded at the time to accept the version that Disha had consumed alcohol and accidentally fallen from the building.

The FIR records allegations naming several public figures, police officers, doctors, forensic personnel, security guards and others whose roles, according to the complainant, require investigation.

The FIR also reproduces several allegations made by Satish Salian regarding purported contradictions in CCTV footage, the alleged position of the body after the fall, records relating to clothing, forensic swabs, mobile phone seizure records, and medical and post-mortem documentation.

DISHA SALIAN DEATH CASE

Gang rape, murder charges invoked in CBI's new FIR

Aaditya Thackeray gets Rs 500-crore defamation notice

Express News Service
Mumbai, September 17

SATISH SALIAN, father of former celebrity manager Disha Salian, has sent a Rs 500-crore defamation notice to Shiv Sena UBT leader Aaditya Thackeray for making remarks against him amid his pursuit of a fresh probe into his daughter's death. The notice has also been issued to former state Home Minister Anil Deshmukh.

Aaditya Thackeray, who is named in the FIR in the Disha Salian death case, had earlier denied knowing or ever meeting her, and called her father's demand for a probe "politically motivated".

The notice states that Satish Salian had filed a petition before the Bombay High Court, seeking a probe into the death of his daughter in 2020. Based on the complaint, the CBI filed an FIR last week, but did not name anyone as an accused.

EXPRESS special

'Bangladeshi' tag, 87 days in detention: A villager's ordeal

Sweetie Kumari
Kolkata, September 17

FOR 70 years, Jalil Akhtar led a quiet and predictable life in Bagroi village in West Bengal's Uttar Dinajpur district. A landless villager, he survived on daily labour and the money sent home by his sons, who work as migrant labourers in distant states. Life as Akhtar knew it changed on the night of June 19. Picked up by the local police on suspicion of being a Bangladeshi national, he spent the next 87 days in detention, moving between a holding centre and jail, while his family sought to secure his release.

That night, around 11 pm, while the rest of the village slept, police officers from the nearby Dalkhola station arrived near Akhtar's house. They parked their vehicle at a distance, walked up to the cot where the elderly man lay, and took him away, his family alleged.

"None of us knew; even his family had no idea. They picked him up at night and drove off. When we searched for him the next morning, he could not be found. When I informed the police station, they said he was allegedly from Bangladesh. I asked, 'How could he be from Bangladesh? On what grounds did you bring this man?' We didn't get any response," Akhtar's cousin Motiur Rahman recalled.

Following his arrest, Akhtar was shifted between multiple locations, including a holding centre in Nizampur, 35 km away, and Islampur jail. "I was also kept near the Bangladesh border for four to five days. Since I am an Indian citizen, they could not send me. I stayed for more than a month at a detention centre and at the border... the rest of the days, I was in jail. Who will pay me for all the humiliation and harassment?" Akhtar told *The Indian Express*.



Jalil Akhtar was granted bail on September 15 after court ruled he had valid documents to prove Indian citizenship.

Rahman recalls how the family was not allowed to meet him in jail after a few initial meetings. "He was kept at the detention centre. I went once or twice, but after that, they didn't allow meetings. He was not allowed to keep a mobile phone. They kept moving him around... for no reason," he added.

As per sources, the FIR claims Akhtar was an illegal immigrant from "Andharahamapur village of Thakurgaon district of Bangladesh" who had entered India via the Hili-Malda border roughly 24 years ago. However, official records submitted by his family contradict these claims. According to Akhtar's family, his name appeared in the 1995 voters' list and the 2002 and 2026 electoral rolls after the Special Intensive Revision exercise. Police case diaries revealed that Akhtar had voted in elections as far back as 1982, his family added, saying that his entire family holds valid electoral documents and cast their votes in 2026.

"In his family, no one's name has been deleted. In 2026, he cast his vote. There is a voter slip... there is a voter list. He has two sons and two daughters. The sons' names are also on the voter list, and they also voted," Rahman insisted. Akhtar's defence counsel pointed out that under

the Indian Citizenship Act, individuals born before 1987 are not required to produce their parents' birth records to establish citizenship. Despite these protections, the police postponed Akhtar's bail hearings four times, citing verification delays.

During hearings at the Islampur court, Akhtar's legal team—local Legal Aid advocate Firoz Ahamed, high court advocate Syed Nafirul Islam, and the Association for Protection of Civil Rights' fact-finding team—urged the police to verify the documents on record.

Following directives from the magistrate, the investigating officer eventually submitted a report confirming that Akhtar's voter ID, PAN card, 1995 electoral list record, and 2002 SIR records were all authentic Indian documents. During a tense hearing before the additional chief judicial magistrate on September 2, the judge directly confronted the investigating officer, asking point-blank whether the government documents provided by the family were genuine. The officer stood in silence.

"...it is also noteworthy that repeated attempts at deportation have already been made, but the same could not be completed. The accused has consistently asserted his claim of Indian citizenship. In such circumstances, continued detention would not, at this stage, appear to serve any useful purpose," the magistrate said, granting Akhtar bail.

Akhtar was released from custody on September 15, after 87 days of detention.

Advocate Islam said, "The court granted bail, saying all documentation submitted by the investigating agency is genuine and that Jalil Akhtar, as per the reports submitted, is an Indian national."

Akhtar's family is still looking for answers.

BRIEFLY



A screengrab shows people helping the pilgrims who slipped on snow during 'Kora' ritual on Drilbu Ri mountain on Thursday. EXPRESS

HIMACHAL PRADESH

2 pilgrims die after slipping on snow during prayer ritual at Lahaul-Spiti

TWO PILGRIMS were killed and 11 others sustained injuries on Thursday after slipping on a snow-covered track while performing Kora, or 'parikrama' (circumambulation) at Drilbu Ri mountain, a revered Buddhist pilgrimage site, in Lahaul and Spiti district on Thursday, officials said. A rescue operation has been launched to evacuate others stranded along the route following a sudden snowfall, they said. The deceased were identified as Dawa Doma Bhutia, 74, a resident of West Bengal's Darjeeling, and Yangzin, 64, daughter of Kunu Ram and a resident of Keylong in Lahaul and Spiti, they said. ENS

MP: 4, including 2 children, crushed to death by truck

TWO CHILDREN were among four persons killed in a road accident in Madhya Pradesh's Morena district on Thursday, a police officer said. The incident took place on National Highway 44 under Nurbad police station limits at 4pm, he said. "They were travelling on a motorcycle from Gwalior when it collided with a garbage collection vehicle parked along the road. The four fell on the road... and were run over by a truck," he said. He identified them as Suraj Kushwah (18), Neerja Kushwah (20), Shrikant Kushwah (10), and Rajkumari (8). PTI

1 held for beating elderly woman to death in Mirzapur

A 70-YEAR-OLD woman died on Thursday after she was allegedly beaten with a stick in Khaire village under Jigna police station area here, police said. The accused, Ankit Dubey, allegedly assaulted Nidya Devi, without any apparent provocation, they said. When family Ramakant Pal and Tersu intervened, Dubey allegedly assaulted them. The injured woman was taken to a hospital by her family, where doctors declared her dead, the police said. Police registered a case and took the named accused into custody. PTI

Weeks after wedding, Hyderabad engineer found dead at US home

Sreenivas Janyala
Hyderabad, September 17

MOHAMMED JABER Hussain, a 27-year-old civil engineer from Hyderabad who got married on August 28, was found dead at a shared accommodation in Lowell, Massachusetts, on September 15.

The newly married couple were planning to move into their own apartment in the United States when tragedy struck. According to his father, Zakir Hussain, he married a woman whom he had known for about a year and who also resides in the US. "She is my friend's daughter from Gujarat, and we had arranged the wedding, which was held recently in Texas. After that, he returned to Lowell, where he was residing. He last called on September 14... it was an hour-long video call," he said.

His wife stayed back in Texas, where she is working.

According to Majlis Bachao Tehreek spokesperson Amjed Ullah Khan, who is assisting the family, Hussain did not come out of his room on the morning of September 15, prompting his flatmates to knock on the door.

When there was no response, they called the police, who found him unresponsive in bed. "He apparently suffered a massive cardiac arrest in his sleep," he said. The family is awaiting official reports from authorities.

Jaber is survived by his parents and a sister.

"The family is shattered and devastated. Jaber was a bond that held them together, loving and caring. He was full of life and looking forward to settling down after marriage. He was also very happy with his new job, which he joined in June," his father Zakir said. The family is not well off, and Jaber started supporting the others as soon as he started working.

Though the family first appealed to the Government of India for help in repatriating the body, they have now made the difficult choice not to bring the body to Hyderabad because they believe preservatives used in embalming may contain alcohol, which is forbidden in Islam.

"They are making arrangements to bury him there," Khan said. Jaber, who was working at a technology solutions company in Massachusetts, grew up in Santoshnagar in Hyderabad and completed his B.Tech in 2020 before going to the US in 2021 for higher studies.

He got a Master's in Civil Engineering from the University of New Haven, Connecticut, and then pursued a Master's in Management Sciences and Quantitative Methods from the University of Cumberland, Williamsburg, Kentucky.

He graduated in 2023 and immediately started working.

Rs 1.12-cr digital arrest scam: IIT Delhi graduate, bank manager among 6 held

The accused posed as telecom dept officials: Police

Express News Service
Mumbai, September 17

A WEB developer who graduated from IIT Delhi and a private bank operations manager are among six people arrested by the Mumbai Cyber police for allegedly cheating a 68-year-old Dahisar resident of Rs 1.12 crore in a 'digital arrest' scam.

Police said the accused impersonated officials of the Tele-

com Department, police and other agencies and threatened the victim with arrest in a fake Rs 238-crore money-laundering case. They allegedly showed him a fake Supreme Court notice and kept him under "digital arrest" through WhatsApp video calls before forcing him to transfer the money, said DCP (Cyber) Bajrang Bansode.

The accused have been identified as Gaurav Mahesh Goyal (40), an IIT Delhi graduate and web developer; Shikhar Mukesh Tyagi (28), a private bank operations manager; Rajesh Kumar Mohanlal Jain (54); Mohammad Tariq Anwar Momin (49); Ajay Kumar Kaliprasad

Sharma (35); and Chintankumar Sureshbhai Desai (46).

The fraud took place between July 30 and August 12. Police traced the first account that received the money and allegedly uncovered a network that arranged bank accounts and SIM cards to receive and transfer fraud proceeds.

Police said Desai travelled to Delhi and Bijpur in Uttar Pradesh with associates to collect the money. Investigators seized 20 mobile phones, two laptops, 25 bank accounts, ATM cards, passbooks and Aadhaar cards.

Police said Goyal is also an accused in a 2021 Bandra police case.

Remembering Razia Sultan Ismail, pioneering journalist and child rights activist

Usha Rai
September 17

RAZIA SULTAN Ismail, a pioneering woman journalist of the country and head of communications and deputy country head, UNICEF-India, died Thursday morning at an elder care facility in Noida where she lived for the last couple of years after suffering a stroke. She was 87. She is survived by an older sister.

An activist on child rights issues, Ismail started the India Alliance for Child Rights after retiring from UNICEF. Before

donning the mantle of child rights activist, Ismail taught at the Department of Journalism in Chandigarh University and moved to Delhi to work with The Indian Express in the late Sixties. She wrote well-researched long pieces on development issues for The Indian Express and even covered foreign affairs. Friends recall that after a visit abroad, where Indira Gandhi was expected as the Prime Minister of India, Ismail came back excited because she had been mistaken for her. She was fair-skinned like Mrs Gandhi, had short hair

and an aquiline nose.

Ismail wore many hats and was also the President of the global YWCA for a few years. But her life revolved around children. At the UN, she headed many panels that sought to bring the world order to focus on children, especially the poor and the marginalised, and how their lives could be improved. She was one of the first persons to create awareness about child sex ratio, sex selection, child marriages and child labour. While working in the Delhi office of Unicef, she brought attention to the state of street



Razia Sultan Ismail was 87

children and their exploitation. Her concern for children went beyond her official responsibilities and she went out of her way to wean them off the

streets, pushing them to education and schools and, where needed, often providing assistance from her pocket. Whether on the streets or in her own office she encouraged youngsters and made space for them.

As head of the India Alliance for Child Rights, she worked with the government in preparing an alternate report on child rights for submission to the Geneva headquarters. When the National Commission for Child Rights was established in 2007 with Dr Shantha Sinha heading it, she attended

all meetings to advise on and support initiatives for children. She also worked closely with the progressive women's organisations.

A warm-hearted and quick-witted human being, Ismail's other love was dogs. She lived life on her own terms. Home meant her dogs and caring for them. She had large dogs who sprawled on sofas and were treated like royalty. Once, when one of her dogs died, she brought home a gaddi puppy (shepherd dog from the hills) hoping it would bring solace to the other dogs. But the yappy

puppy was too much for the seniors, and knowing that I had just lost my black Labrador, she gave me this lovely golden-brown furry creature. I called him Brandy, and she would keep inquiring about him till he settled in.

For Ismail, the people who looked after her at home were like family members. She looked after them and their children. Her birthday was on Christmas and she would have an open house that day with food and gifts for all who visited. For friends and colleagues, it was an event marked

on their calendars.

My first trip abroad was with Ismail to the Philippines for a conference on child rights. It was a great learning experience for me but what moved both of us most was the true story of a young male journalist from Thailand who practised what the world was preaching by actually adopting a homeless child from the streets of Bangkok. Ismail leaves behind a legacy in the policies she shaped and the lives she transformed.

The writer is a veteran journalist

Day after newsroom raid, Keralam TV channel MD held for 'hoarding liquor'

Shaju Philip

Thiruvananthapuram, September 17

THE EXCISE department in Keralam on Thursday arrested managing editor and director of Reporter TV, Anto Augustine, on charges of illegal possession of liquor. Later in the day, a local court remanded him in judicial custody for 14 days.

This comes a day after Keralam Police raided premises of the channel in connection with an alleged cheating case linked to a failed bid to bring football legend Lionel Messi to the state.

During a search of Augustine's house in Wayanad, the special investigation team allegedly found 67 litres of illegal Indian-made foreign liquor (IMFL) and foreign-made foreign liquor. The excise department registered a case under the Kerala Abkari Act. In Keralam, a person is permitted to possess a maximum of three litres of IMFL. Excise sources said Augustine faces non-bailable offences and if convicted, could face up to 10 years in prison.

Augustine, taken into custody from Reporter TV's head office in Kochi earlier on Thursday denied charges. "I had handed over all documents related to Messi event. Now, the excise has come up with a case saying they had found a stock of liquor in my house. I have never consumed alcohol in my life. I will cooperate with the probe," Augustine



ReporterTV MD Anto Augustine was sent to 14-day judicial custody by a court on Thursday

said. He will be produced before a court in Wayanad.

The arrest comes a day after police raided Reporter TV's newsroom and the office of its parent company, Reporter Broadcasting Company (RBC), along with houses of Augustine and his brothers, Roji and Josekutty, in Kochi and Wayanad.

The raids stem from an alleged fraud involving the state sports department's attempt, during previous LDF government under Pinarayi Vijayan, to bring the Argentina football team to Keralam for an international match. It was to happen in late 2025, and the state handed over the stadium in Kochi to them. The match didn't happen.

After the Congress-led government came to power in May, the sports department allegedly found illegal financial transactions totaling Rs 126 crore and GST payment defaults. An FIR was registered on information from SIT under multiple charges.

Private participation not at the cost of ISRO's capabilities: Staff in fresh note

Anjali Marar

Bengaluru, September 17

PRIVATE PARTICIPATION in the space sector must not weaken Indian Space Research Organisation's own capabilities, nor should the technologies and facilities developed by it be transferred to private parties at "throwaway prices", a group of employee associations of ISRO has asserted in a fresh statement on the ongoing debate over the role of private companies in the country's space sector.

These associations first flagged their concerns in a letter to ISRO chairman on September 4, a day after the successful launch of GSLV-F17 mission. In that letter, they sought a series of clarifications on ISRO's role in the future, particularly in view of

reports that the agency was being readied to focus its energies only on a few strategic missions, while ceding rest of the space to private companies.

That letter prompted ISRO Chairman V Narayanan to state there was no move to privatise the agency, and it would continue to build and strengthen capabilities as it partners with private sector to expand space economy. He later addressed ISRO employees in a video-conference to allay concerns.

In their fresh statement, the employee associations reiterated that it was not against private sector participation, but this should not come at the cost of ISRO's own capabilities. "We are not opposed to private participation in the space sector. Indian industry, Public Sector Units

and start-ups have an important role in expanding India's space ecosystem. But private participation must strengthen national capability, not weaken ISRO's core functions," said a note from the Joint Action Council (JAC) of various employee associations. The undated note was issued and circulated among ISRO staff on Thursday. *The Indian Express* obtained a copy of note and confirmed its veracity from two serving employees. Attempts to get an official response from ISRO were not fruitful. The four-page note flags ISRO's capabilities have been built on public money, and could not become "source of private profit without adequate return to the nation".

"There must be a level-playing field, transparency and accountability. Technology devel-

oped with public money cannot become a source of private profit (making) without an adequate return to the nation. Public wealth cannot be transferred at throwaway prices or treated as a freebie for private entities," the JAC note said.

The note said there was a legitimate need to increase number of mission launches and this could not be achieved without private players. This did not mean mature technologies developed by ISRO are all transferred to entities. It mentioned two advanced rocket systems — the LVM3 and the under-development NGLV — and said these must remain with ISRO — "ISRO must retain the complete chain of capability from research and development to realisation, integration, testing and launch".

With 4,000-km yatra, Punjab BJP turns anti-drug campaign into pre-election political roadshow

Raakhi Jagga

Patiala, September 17

WITH A vehicle leading a convoy of over 100 vehicles, the Punjab BJP is set to launch its 13-day *'Nasha Mukti Yatra'* on Friday, turning its anti-drug campaign into a statewide political roadshow ahead of the 2027 Assembly elections.

Four yatras, beginning simultaneously from Pathankot, Fatehgarh Sahib, Fazilka and Talwandi Sabo, will collectively cover nearly 4,000 km and all 117 Assembly constituencies before

converging in Jalandhar on September 30, where Union Home Minister Amit Shah is expected to address a concluding rally.

The first yatra will be flagged off from Pathankot on September 18 by BJP national president Nitin Nabin. Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta will flag off the second from Fatehgarh Sahib on September 19, Union Law Minister Arjun Meghwal the third from Fazilka on September 20, and Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan the fourth from Talwandi Sabo, Bathinda, on September 21.

"... The main leaders will be in the rath and local district vehicles will follow..." said Punjab BJP spokesperson Pritpal Singh Ballawal.

The yatra follows a *'Mavan Mangdian Jawab'* (Mothers Demand Answers) programme organised in Chandigarh on Thursday, at which over 50 families affected by drug addiction and drug-related deaths from across Punjab shared their experiences. Punjab BJP president Kewal Singh Dhillon said the party would turn the issue into a people's movement. "This is a pain that cannot be endured or tolerated. This pain has

reached every household in Punjab today," he said.

The testimonies were pointed at the state's dereliction of issue. A mother from Abohar whose son died after drug addiction said: "... We work hard to support our families. We do not want free schemes — we want freedom from chhitta." Former Punjab BJP president Sunil Jakhar alleged prisons had become safe havens for drug smugglers and accused CM Bhagwant Mann of inducting gangsters into the party — citing induction of Gurpreet Singh Sekhon, described by Jakhar as a gangster-turned-politician, into AAP.

2 JeM terrorists killed in Udhampur; search for more continues

Bashaarat Masood

Srinagar, September 17

TWO JAISH-E-MOHAMMAD (JeM) terrorists were killed in an encounter with Jammu & Kashmir Police, army and paramilitary forces in the forests of Jammu and Kashmir's Udhampur on Wednesday night. The counter-insurgency operation in Udhampur's Brattal Sohan and Khubban forest areas of Majalta was launched after intelligence reports on terrorist movement in the area, prompting authorities to intensify combing operations.

Officials said the forces detected some suspicious movement, leading to an exchange of fire that killed two terrorists.

"In a joint intelligence-based operation during the intervening night of 16/17 September, confirmed inputs indicated the presence of terrorists in the general area of Brattal, Udhampur," the Indian Army's Jammu-based White Knight Corps said in a statement. "Despite hostile weather, difficult terrain and poor visibility, troops of White Knight Corps, Jammu Kashmir Police and CRPF launched a targeted counter-terrorism operation resulting in neutralisation of two terrorists."

Police identified those killed as Saddam and Mustafa. "An AK Assault Rifle (with 4 mags);

M4 Carbine (with 3 mags); a Glock Pistol (with 2 mags); and 4 grenades have been recovered from their possession," a statement issued later in the evening said.

Officials said the anti-insurgency operation continues in the area, as do search and surveillance.

"Security forces remain deployed to trace and neutralise any remaining threat," the Army said.

The latest encounter adds to a series of operations against JeM-linked terrorists in Udhampur's forested areas. According to security officials, the Jaish terrorists have set up their bases in the higher reaches of Jammu division over the last several years, especially the Kathua-Jammu-Udhampur belt that is connected to Jammu's Chenab region.

The area is characterised by dense forests and difficult terrain, which, compounded by its location between the Jammu plains and the higher reaches towards Doda and Kishtwar, makes tracking terrorists challenging.

Security forces have conducted prolonged searches in the Basantgarh-Ramnagar belt in recent years, with terrorists taking advantage of the terrain and dense foliage to remain concealed for extended periods.

Public flogging of handcuffed men: Gujarat govt issues notice to senior IPS officer

Aditi Raja

Vadodara, September 17

THE GUJARAT government informed the Gujarat High Court on Thursday that a show-cause notice had been issued to an IPS officer who is accused of publicly flogging, humiliating, and parading handcuffed persons. This sets in motion disciplinary proceedings against the officer.

Government Pleader G H Virk made the submission before a Division Bench of HC Chief Justice Sunita Agarwal and Justice D N Ray, which is hearing a public interest petition (PIL) about the alleged incident that took place in Surat on July 14. The state informed the court

that the Gujarat Director General of Police (DGP) had "concurred with the findings of a preliminary inquiry" by the Additional Commissioner of Police (Crime), Surat City.

A month ago, the HC had asked why the officer, Rajdeep-sinh Nakum, who was DCP in Surat city at the time of the incident, was still in his post.

On Thursday, responding to an oral query from the court, the state submitted as per convention followed by the Home Department, a show-cause notice issued even if officer has had an opportunity to give a statement during preliminary inquiry, and not doing so could subsequently "become a ground for litigation".

Supreme Court asks Tamil Nadu to comply with order to identify land for Navodaya schools

Express News Service

New Delhi, September 17

UNDERLINING THE need to strengthen cooperative federalism, the Supreme Court on Thursday asked the Tamil Nadu government to comply with its order to identify land for establishing Navodaya schools in all districts.

A bench of Justices B V Nagarathna and A G Masih also asked the Centre and state to resolve differences regarding language policy, funding, etc. through dialogue.

Justice Nagarathna said Navodaya schools would only strengthen the state's education network and provide more opportunities to students.

"We are not alienating you and we are not alienating them. Some more type of schools come in your state also which will only enhance high standard which we are aware of. This is not going to lower your standards. If Navodaya schools were going to lower the standard of education in Tamil Nadu we would have said that irrespective of what you would have said. That is not the case here. It will provide more opportunity," the judge remarked, adding "people in Chennai should not alienate Delhi and vice versa".

The bench was hearing an appeal by the state government, challenging the September 11, 2017, Madras High Court order asking the state to do the needful to establish the schools in all districts. The HC asked the State to identify an appropriate place and building for establishing the school and thereafter, to allocate suitable land in every district.

Hearing the challenge on December 15, 2025, the SC had asked the state to identify the land for the schools. On Thursday, the state sought recall of the order, but the SC gave it three months to comply. Senior Advocate Jaideep Gupta, appearing for the TN government, said the state's concern was about language policy of Navodaya schools.

He added that the opposition was not to the teaching of Hindi but the fact that it has to be taught as the predominant language in higher classes. Justice Nagarathna pointed out that there are many schools in the state where Hindi is taught and said the state should change its mindset. The judge added that such differences can be sorted out through discussions. "If you want Tamil as a second language, it is a matter which can be considered," Justice Nagarathna said and asked the state's Secretary to speak with the Central officials. "Ultimately everybody must work together," she said.

ANDHRA PRADESH CAPITAL REGION DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
Rayapudi, Thullur Mandal, Amaravati-522237 (A.P.)

E PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE
NIT No. /PROC/MAU61-USIOHB(G)/23/2026-HB, Dated: 17-09-2026

Name of the Work: AGICL - Engagement of Project management consultant (PMC) for Construction of Andhra Pradesh Judicial Academy in Prime location of Sports City, Pithikalapalem Village, Amaravati Capital City, Andhra Pradesh. The bid can be downloaded on AP e-procurement portal from 18.09.2026 to 03.10.2026 up to 14.00 Hrs. Due date for submission of Bid is 03.10.2026 up to 15.00 Hrs, Technical bid opening 03.10.2026 @ 16.00Hrs. For further details Please refer to www.approcurement.gov.in and www.agicl.org

Sd/- Managing Director, APCRDA, Amaravati.

Bangalore Electricity Supply Company Limited
(Wholly owned Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
(CIN - UO4010KA2002SGC030438)

NOTIFICATION INVITING TENDER (NIT)

(Through KPP Portal)

No: BESCOM/CGM(Proj)/DGM-1/AGM-1/BC-14/26-27/Cys-207 dated : 15.09.2026

BESCOM Invites tender for the work of "Replacement of existing 11KV OH line into UG Cable system in Davanagere City Sub-Division-2, Davanagere Division, Davanagere circle, BESCOM" on Total Turnkey basis under Percentage Quoting basis".

Tender Enquiry No : BESCOM/2026-27/EL/WORK_IDENT 1184 Availability of Bid documents : **23.09.2026 onwards**. Last date for submission of bid Queries : **03.10.2026 before 17:00 Hrs**. Pre-Bid meeting : **05.10.2026 @ 11:00 Hrs**. Venue of Pre-Bid meeting: **O/o Chief General Manager (Ele), 4th Floor, Project Section, B Block, Corporate office, BESCOM, K. R Circle, Bangalore- 560 001**. Last date & Time for bid submission : **23.10.2026 before 15:00 Hrs**. Opening of Technical Bids : **26.10.2026 @ 11:00 Hrs**.

The bid documents can be downloaded and necessary assistance can be obtained through the e-procurement portal from the website <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>

E-procurement Help Desk: Phone No: +91-8046010000 +91-8068948777 E-mail: support@eprocelpdesk.com

Aspiring bidders needs to be registered on e-procurement portal. Bidders can take the assistance from the e-procurement during office working hours.

Sd/-
Chief General Manager (Ele) Projects, BESCOM.
PH No: +91-94498 44885
E mail: cgmproject.bescom@gmail.com

OFFICE OF SENIOR TOWN PLANNER, GURUGRAM

Department of Town & Country Planning, Haryana
Sector-14, HSVP complex, 3rd floor, Gurugram.
Telephone- 0124-4014776
E-mail: stp4.gurugram.tpp@gmail.com

Dated: 17.09.2026

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform general public, allottees, landowners, collaborators, banks/financial institutions, and all other stakeholders that Licence No. 06 of 2016 dated 16.06.2016 was granted in favour of Shri Bhagwan S/o Sh. Bal Kishan in collaboration with Ocean Seven Buildtech Pvt. Ltd., under Section 3 of the Haryana Development and Regulation of Urban Areas Act, 1975 (Act No. 8 of 1975) under the Affordable Housing Policy, 2013, for setting up an Affordable Group Housing Colony over an area measuring 7.5 acres in the revenue estate of village Baburpur, Sector 109, Gurugram has been cancelled vide DTCP order Memo No. LC-3089/JE(SJ)/2026/28430 dated 07.08.2026.

Pursuant to proceedings initiated under Rule 19 of the Haryana Development and Regulation of Urban Areas Rules, 1976, and directives issued vide DTCP Memo No. LC-3089/JE(SJ)/2026/31699 dated 02.09.2026, the general public/allottees/stakeholders are hereby notified of the following:

1. Directive Regarding Payments: All allottees of the subject project are strictly informed not to make any further payments to the colonizer/ licensee (M/s Ocean Seven Buildtech Pvt. Ltd.), in accordance with Rule 19(2)(d) of the Haryana Development and Regulation of Urban Areas Rules, 1976.

2. Intimation of Claims, Encumbrances & Third-Party Rights: All allottees, collaborators, landowners, financial institutions, and other claimants having any claim, right, interest, encumbrance pertaining to the licensed land/project-including loans, mortgages, pledge of shares, or third-party rights are required to intimate and submit full particulars of their claim accompanied by relevant supporting documents, including allotment agreements, payment proofs, mortgage/ loan details, or contractual agreements within 30 days of the issuance of this Notice in the Office of the Senior Town Planner, Gurugram Circle, 3rd Floor, HSVP Complex, Sector-14, Gurugram.

Sd/-
Senior Town Planner
No. 49393/HR
Gurugram Circle, Gurugram

मध्यप्रदेश लघु उद्योग निगम मर्यादित
कार्यालय महाप्रबंधक (संघर्ष/निर्माण), संभाग-क्र. 01
पंचानन भवन द्वितीय तल, मालवीय नगर, भोपाल (म.प्र.)
दूरभाष क्रमांक : 0755-2673196
E-mail : laghubp01@gmail.com
क्रमांक :लउनि/निर्माण/संभाग-क्र. 1, भोपाल/2026-27/63
भोपाल, दिनांक 17.09.2026

निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

निम्न कार्य की निविदा ई-टेंडरिंग पद्धति से वेबसाइट <https://www.mptenders.gov.in> पर आमंत्रित की जाती हैं : कार्य का नाम- गोविन्दपुरा इंडस्ट्रीज (भविष्य के विस्तार) भोपाल जिला भोपाल में मल्टी-स्टोरी फ्लैट्स इंडस्ट्रियल पार्क का निर्माण कार्य, अनुमानित लागत राशि रु. 33,21,40,000.00 निविदा की समस्त जानकारी उक्त वेबसाइट पर दी जावेगी। निविदा में कोई संशोधन व परिवर्तन किया जाता है, तो वह उपरोक्त वेबसाइट पर देखा जा सकता है। बिना कोई कारण बताये निविदा को स्वीकृत अथवा निरस्त करने का अधिकार निगम के पास सुरक्षित है।

म.प्र. माध्यम/128117/2026

महाप्रबंधक (सं./नि.)

GOVERNMENT OF TAMILNADU - DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE
JOINT DIRECTOR OF AGRICULTURE, TRICHY - 620 020.
Ref: E/5981/2026 e - TENDER NOTIFICATION
For and on behalf of the Government of Tamil Nadu, e-tenders in two cover system are invited From the Manufacturers / Importers for the supply of Packing Materials for Liquid Biofertilizer Production Units for the year 2026-2027.

Sl. No.	Name of the Item	Approximate Value	Earnest Money Deposit to be paid
1	Supply of Packing Materials for Liquid Biofertilizer Production Units in Tamilnadu.	Rs.7,54,71,686/-	Rs.7,55,000/-

e-tender should be submitted for the items mentioned above along with specified Earnest Money Deposit. Earnest Money Deposit mentioned above is cumulative. However, EMD shall vary depending on the item/items for which the firm is / firms are participating which is clearly detailed in the tender document. The non-transferable tender document with the detailed specifications can be downloaded from e-tender website namely <https://www.tntenders.gov.in> free of cost. The time schedule for opening of the tender is as follows :

	Publishing Date	18.09.2026 at 11.00 am.
	Document download Start Date	18.09.2026 at 11.30 am.
	Pre-Bid Meeting Date	23.09.2026 at 03.00 pm.
	Bid Submission Closing Date	03.10.2026 at 05.00 pm.
	Bid Opening Date	05.10.2026 at 11.00 am.

For further particulars, Please contact Joint Director of Agriculture, Mannarpuram, Trichy - 620 020. Phone: 0431-2420554. E-mail: jdatrichy@gmail.com. DIPR/2892 /TENDER/2026 Joint Director of Agriculture, Trichy

Superintending Engineer Bulandshahr Circle, P.W.D. Bulandshahr E-Procurement Inviting Tender Notice

No. 9000/96M /E-TENDER/BSR CIRCLE/2026-27 Dated 08.09.2026
On behalf of Governor of Uttar Pradesh, Superintending Engineer Bulandshahr Circle, U.P.W.D., Bulandshahr invites following tenders of Item wise rate bid online through <http://etender.up.nic.in> from the eligible and approved Contractors registered with UP PWD, from Dt. 25.09.2026 to 01.10.2026 up to 12:30 P.M. as per the prescribed SBD. The technical bids will be opened online on dated 01.10.2026 at 12:30 P.M. If the office happens to be closed on the date of opening of the bids as specified, the bids will be opened online on the next working day respectively, at the same time and validity of bid will be considered from the original date. The date and time of opening of the financial bid shall be notified on the website.

Sl. No	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs.in Lac)	Bid Security (Rs.in Lacs)	Work Completion	Tender document fee including GST	Contractors Category
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
In anticipation of Sanction						
1	Widening and strengthening work of Lakhwati-Saidpur Road (ODR) from chainage 0.000 to 5.000 in District Bulandshahr	900.00	18.00	12 Months	Tender Cost-Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	A (Road Work)

- The Bid Security and Tender Document Fee must be deposit through Internet Banking.
- For the above work, it is mandatory to carry out maintenance work for five years from the date of completion of the work.
- All registered contractors have to upload Turnover certified by C.A. of last 5 Year and details of maximum cost work satisfactorily completed in last 5 Years on Chanakya software before Submission of tender. Details of e-tender uploaded on <https://etender.up.nic.in> shall also be uploaded on Uppwd Chanakya software, before last date & time of submission of bid.
- Bidder has to upload required documents as per Government order No. 879(1) /23-7-2020 P.W. Anubhag-7 Lucknow Dt. 25.08.2020 for "Prahari Application" in Chanakya Software by accessing hyperlink available on <http://roc.uppwd.gov.in> for Tendering Process
- Terms & Conditions related to bids are available on <https://etender.up.nic.in>

(Er. Rahul Sharma)
Executive Engineer
P.D. PWD Bulandshahr

(Er. Maneesh Verma)
Superintending Engineer,
Bulandshahr Circle, P.W.D. Bulandshahr

UPID-256315 Dt. 15.09.2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

GOVERNMENT OF JAMMU AND KASHMIR AGRICULTURE PRODUCTION DEPARTMENT

Mission Directorate, Holistic Agriculture Development Programme

NOTICE INVITING LIMITED TECHNICAL PROPOSALS

Limited technical proposals are invited from the concerned consultancy agencies empanelled with the National e-Governance Division (NeGD) under both Category A and Category C for establishment and operation of a Project Monitoring Unit under HADP.

The approved Limited Terms of Reference, submission requirements and schedule have been communicated to the agencies at their listed email addresses and are also available at <https://hadp.jk.gov.in/OrdersNotifications.aspx>

Only agencies covered by the limited selection process and fulfilling the prescribed eligibility conditions may submit proposals within the timeline specified in the ToR.

Sd/-
Accounts Officer, HADP
Agriculture Production Department
Government of Jammu and Kashmir

DIPK-NB-1660/26 - DATE 17 SEP 2026

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, P.W.D. CIRCLE BANSWARA (RAJ.)
Address - Near Circuit House, Jaipur Road, Banswara (Raj.) 327001
E-Mail - piu_banswara@rediffmail.com, sebanswara.pwd@rajasthan.gov.in
Phone - 02962-241808

क्रमांक:- जी-776 दिनांक:- 10-09-2026
NIB - PWD2627A2682

Notice Inviting Bid (17/2026-27)

Bids for Rehabilitation of various damaged BT Road in Banswara are invited from interested bidders from Dated 11-09-2026 9.30 am. to 22-09-2026 6.00 pm. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>), <http://sppp.raj.nic.in>) of the state. The approximate value of the procurement in Rs. 761.50 Lacs. UBN PWD2627WSOB11905 TO PWD2627WSOB11907

Sd/-
(Virendra Kumar Shah)
Superintending Engineer
P.W.D. Circle Banswara

DIPR/C/15982/2026

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियंता जलग्रहण विकास एवं भू-संरक्षण विभाग, उदयपुर
E-mail: SEWDS.UDAIPUR@RAJASTHAN.IN

क्रमांक : एफ () / निविदा/लेखा/2026-27/1667 दिनांक 10.09.2026

ई निविदा सूचना 85/2026-27

मुख्यमंत्री जल स्वावलम्बन अभियान 2.2 परियोजना क्षेत्र के अंतर्गत उदयपुर जिले के विभिन्न ब्लॉक (1 फैकज) में उपादन / जलग्रहण विकास कार्य के लिए बीड, अनुमानित मूल्य 205.25 लाख रुपये दिनांक 30.09.2026 को शाम 5.00 बजे तक इच्छुक चोलीदालाओं से आमंत्रित की जाती है। चोलियों से संबंधित विस्तृत विवरण राज्य सरकार के पोर्टल (<https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>), <https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in>) पर देखे जा सकते हैं।

यूबीएन संख्या: WSC2627WSOB02262

(अनिल सनाहट)
अधीक्षण अभियंता
जलग्रहण विकास एवं भू-संरक्षण विभाग
उदयपुर

DIPR/C/15955/2026 Date: 16/09/2026

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER KATAKA (R&B) CIRCLE, KATAKA
E-MAIL-ID-SECTCRB_2006@YAHOO.CO.IN, TEL/FAX - 0671-2301751/2302751

('E' - PROCUREMENT NOTICE)

Bid Identification N o.CCE.Ctc.(R&B)11/2026-27

- The Chief Construction Engineer, Kataka (R&B)Circle, Kataka on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites on Percentage rate basis bid in double cover system in ONLINE MODE from eligible contractors for Road works as mentioned below
- No. of work** : 02 Nos.
- Nature of work** : Road works
- Class of contractor** : 'B' & 'A' Class
- Tender paper cost** : Rs.10000/- (online)
- Available of bid document in the web site.** : From 21.09.2026 to 17.30 Hours of 08.10.2026
- Date of opening of bid** : Dt.09.10.2026 at 11.00 Hours.
- The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website <https://tendersodisha.gov.in>. Any addendum / corrigendum/ cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said web site

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer
Katka (R&B) Circle

OIPR-34001/34012/1/26-27/0029

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH
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ई-प्रोक्वायरेमेंट निविदा सूचना									
पत्रांक 3876/11 कैशियर (प्रान्छ०मेरठ) मेरठ/0/2026-27						दिनांक 07.09.2026			
1-महामहिम राज्यपाल उत्तर प्रदेश की ओर से उ०प्र० लोक निर्माण विभाग में पंजीकृत निविदादाताओं से ई-टेंडरिंग के माध्यम से स्थायी गये कार्य हेतु निविदा प्रतिशत दर पर आमंत्रित की जाती है।									
क्र० सं०	कार्य का नाम	अनुमानित लागत (रू० लाख में)	धरोहर धनराशि (रू० लाख में)	निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अधिकतम अवधि वर्षों सहित	अधीशायी अभियन्ता का पता	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता का पता	मुख्य अभियन्ता का पता	पंजीकृत टेकेदारों की श्रेणी
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
1	नये कार्यालय भवन का निर्माण कार्य के अन्तर्गत जनपद मेरठ में लो०नि०वि० प्रोग्राम में वृत्तीय कार्यालय भवन का नवनिर्माण का कार्य।	300.00	17.00	2000+300+ GST 18%= 2714.00	06 Month	प्रान्तीय खण्ड मेरठ	मेरठ वृत्त मेरठ	मेरठ क्षेत्र मेरठ	“ए” भवन कार्य
➤ बिल ऑफ क्वालिटी में लगाई गयी दरें सभी करो को जोड़ते हुये तथा जी०एस०टी० करों को छोड़ते हुये लगाई गयी है।									
➤ निविदा में निविदा शुल्क (कॉलम नं० 05 के अनुसार) ऑन लाइन केवल नेट बैंकिंग द्वारा भुगतान के पश्चात यू०टी०आर० प्रारिप्त रसीद के रूप में ही मान्य होगी।									
2	निविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत विवरण एवं शर्तें वेबसाइट http://etender.up.nic.in पर ऑनलाईन उपलब्ध है।								
3	बिड डाक्यूमेंट वेबसाइट http://etender.up.nic.in पर दिनांक 30.09.2026 से 07.10.2026 तक उपलब्ध है, जो कि दिनांक 07.10.2026 को समय अपराह्न 12:00 बजे तक अपलोड किये जा सकते है। निविदा की तकनीकी बिड दिनांक 07.10.2026 को समय अपराह्न 12.30 बजे ऑन लाइन खोली जायेगी।								
4	निविदा डालने हेतु निविदादाता के पास सर्टिफाइड प्राधिकरण द्वारा जारी डिजिटल सिग्नेचर सर्टिफिकेट होना अनिवार्य है।								
5-शासनादेश संख्या-879 (1)/23-7-2020पी०डब्ल्यू०अनु०-07 लखनऊ दिनांक 25.08.20 के आदेशानुसार फर्म/टेकेदार का प्रहरी रूप पर चाणक्य पोर्टल के माध्यम से निविदा डालने हेतु पंजीकरण करना आवश्यक होगा।									
6-धरोहर धनराशि शासनादेश संख्या 86/2026/649/2026/23-7099/106/2025 लो०नि०अनु०-7 लखनऊ दिनांक 23.05. 2026 में दिये गये निर्देशों के अनुसार ही ली जायेगी।									

अधिशायी अभियन्ता	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता
UPID-256295 Date 15/09/2026 www.upidadv.gov.in	मेरठ वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, मेरठ। Email -sepwdmrt01@gmail.com

Office of Superintending Engineer Rampur Circle, P.W.D. Rampur E-Procurement Tender Notice

No. 5038 /E-Nivida-R.Circle/26-27 Dated :- 03.09.2026

- On behalf of the Governor of UP, tenders for following work are invited by the Superintending Engineer, Rampur Circle, PWD Rampur online on website <http://etender.up.nic.in> from registered contractors Category as per column No.8 from date 24.09.2026 at 10.00 am to 03.10.2026 at 12.00 pm. Technical bid /Prequalification of tenders shall be opened on 03.10.2026 at 12.30 pm in office of undersigned by tender committee in presence of authorised representatives/bidders who wish to be present. Financial bid of the tenders' who qualify in technical bid shall be opened on date and time as specified by a notice in the office of undersigned. In case of Government holiday the required process shall be carried out on next working day.
- Details of the works under Rajya Vojna are following:

Sl. No	DISTRICT	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs.in Lakh)	Bid Security (Rs.in Lakh)	Time of completion of the work (Including rainy season)	Cost of tender documents including GST (Rs.)	Category of road contractor eligible	Address of Executive Engineer executing the work	Address of Superintending Engineer	Address of Chief Engineer
1	Bijnor	Construction of 4 x 4 mtr span 5 cell Box Culvert and Approach road in place of Raptia in KM 06 of Sherkot Harewali Road to Kopa Road (ODR) in District Bijnor	132.00	8.60	06 Months (Including Rainy season)	2354.00 (Security will be accepted only through net banking)	A, B Bridge Category	Provincial Division PWD Bijnor	Rampur Circle, PWD Rampur	Moradabad Zone, PWD Moradabad
2	Bijnor	Construction of 3 x 3 mtr span 3 cell Box Culvert and Approach road in place of Raptia in KM 07 of Sherkot Harewali Road to Kopa Road (ODR) in District Bijnor	86.00	6.30	03 Months (Including Rainy season)	2354.00 (Security will be accepted only through net banking)	A, B Bridge Category	Provincial Division PWD Bijnor	Rampur Circle, PWD Rampur	Moradabad Zone, PWD Moradabad
3	Bijnor	Construction of 3 x 3 mtr span 3 cell Box Culvert and Approach road in place of Raptia in KM 08 of Sherkot Harewali Road to Kopa Road in District Bijnor	86.00	6.30	03 Months (Including Rainy season)	2354.00 (Security will be accepted only through net banking)	A, B Bridge Category	Provincial Division PWD Bijnor	Rampur Circle, PWD Rampur	Moradabad Zone, PWD Moradabad
4	Bijnor	Construction of 3 x 3 mtr span 4 cell Box Culvert and Approach road at Baan Nadi on KM 01 of Shadipur Nehaur Road to Lakhuwala Road in District Bijnor	45.50	4.28	03 Months (Including Rainy season)	2354.00 (Security will be accepted only through net banking)	A, B Bridge Category	Provincial Division PWD Bijnor	Rampur Circle, PWD Rampur	Moradabad Zone, PWD Moradabad
5	Bijnor	Construction of 3 x 3 mtr span 2 cell Box Culvert and Approach road at Baan Nadi on Kakapur to Bilaspur Road in District Bijnor	35.70	3.57	03 Months (Including Rainy season)	2354.00 (Security will be accepted only through net banking)	A, B Bridge Category	Provincial Division PWD Bijnor	Rampur Circle, PWD Rampur	Moradabad Zone, PWD Moradabad

- The Rates adopted in the BOQ are including all other taxes but excluding GST.
 - The Bid Security and tender cost should be deposited online through Net Banking as per Column 5 & 7 in the table.
- All terms & conditions can be seen on website <http://etender.up.nic.in>. Additional Security will be payable as per rule at the time of Agreement and according to G.O. No 86/2026/649/2026/ 23&7099/106/2025 लोक निर्माण अनुभाग-7 दिनांक 23.05.2026. The bidder have to login on Prahari URL <http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahari> to upload required documents as per Government order 879(1) /दि०7-7-2020-176 (स०)०6 लोक निर्माण अनुभाग-7 दिनांक 25.08.2020 & E.N.C./H.O.D.'s uppd letter No. 417/13 रो०प्र० कै० ख०/20 दिनांक 28.08.2020

Executive Engineer PD, BWD, Bijnor Ph. 01342-262776 Email – pdbjnorr@gmail.com	UPID-256215 Date 15/09/2026 www.upidadv.gov.in	Superintending Engineer Rampur Circle, PWD, Rampur Ph. 0595 – 2351163 Email – pwdrampur@gmail.com
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GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE						
SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, FATEHABAD	SPECIAL REPAIR/IMPROVEMENT OF 02 NO. ROADS UNDER TOHANA CONSTITUENCY IN FATEHABAD DISTRICT (WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27) (GROUP-1) 1. SPECIAL REPAIR OF ROAD FROM UKALANA BHUNA ROAD TO DHANI SANCHLA (ROAD ID 5378) KM. 0.0 TO 2.70 IN FATEHABAD DISTT. 2. SPECIAL REPAIR OF ROAD FROM DHARSUL BHUNA ROAD TO DHANI DULAT ROAD KM. 0.0 TO 2.70 (ROAD ID 5598) IN FATEHABAD DISTT. (WITHOUT GST). + 5 WORKS	14.09.2026 28.09.2026	2270.29 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01667-220120 pwd-ecpd-fatehabad@hry.nic.in
2	PWD B&R, FATEHABAD	SPECIAL REPAIR/STG. OF 02 NO. ROADS UNDER FATEHABAD CONSTITUENCY IN FATEHABAD DISTRICT (WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27) (GROUP-1) 1.PG. BM PLUS PC ON FATEHABAD BHUNA ROAD TO MAJRA VIA BISLA KM 0.0 TO 2.30 (ROAD ID 5570) 2. STG. ON KAJAHERI TO KHAJURI JATTI ROAD KM 0.0 TO 4.55 (ROAD ID 5576) (WITHOUT GST). + 6 WORKS	15.09.2026 29.09.2026	2676.67 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01667-220120 pwd-ecpd-fatehabad@hry.nic.in
3	PWD B&R, HISAR	SPECIAL REPAIR OF ROAD BY POG. AND LAYING JPB IN THE BERM PORTION FROM LAJWA TO DAHIMA RD 0.500 TO 0.800 IN HISAR DISTT. (ROAD ID 4858)	CLOSING DATE 21.09.2026	12.33 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9878364499 pwd-ecpd-hisar@hry.nic.in
4	PWD B&R, AMBALA	WIDENING AND STRENGTHENING OF 04 NOS. ROADS UNDER PROVINCIAL DIVISION NO.1, PWD BANDOR BRANCH, AMBALA CANTT IN AMBALA DISTT UNDER AMBALA CANTT CONSTITUENCY UNDER WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27 (ROAD ID 62, 66, 153 AND 167) (GROUP 1) + 3 WORKS	14.09.2026 23.09.2026	1499.34 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0171297724 pwd-ecpd-ambala@hry.nic.in
5	PWD B&R, NARWANA	RE-MODELING OF SPEED BREAKERS ALONGWITH ROAD SAFETY SIGN BOARDS ON NARWANA TO TOHANA ROAD IN JINDO DISTRICT	15.09.2026 21.09.2026	8.03 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	7599999782 pwdnarwana@gmail.com
6	PWD B&R, KURUKSHETRA	CONSTRUCTION FOR THE WORK OF PWD REST HOUSE AT LAJWA IN KURUKSHETRA.	15.09.2026 21.09.2026	478.13 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01744297271 pwd-ecpd-kurukshetra@hry.nic.in
7	PWD B&R, HANSI	SPECIAL REPAIR OF ROAD FROM KHERI JALAB NARNAUND KHANDA KHERI DHARMKHERI KARELA ROAD AND KHANDA KHERI BYE PASS BY PROVIDING DBM PLUS BC AND RELAYING OF CCB/PP IN HANSI DISTT (ROAD ID 5170 AND 5242) (WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27) (NARNAUND CONSTITUENCY) (WITHOUT GST) (G-1) + 2 WORKS	15.09.2026 28.09.2026	2331.26 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01662359688 pwd-ecpd-hansi@hry.nic.in
8	PWD B&R, SIRSA	DINT FOR IMPROVEMENT OF ROAD FROM RANJA TO DHOTTAH KM. 1.30 TO 8.39 (ROAD ID 5902) IN SIRSA DISTT. IN RANJA CONSTITUENCY (WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27) UNDER HEAD-3054 (GROUP-3) (WITHOUT GST)	16.09.2026 30.09.2026	558.24 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01666-222569 pwd-ecpd-sirsa@hry.nic.in
9	PWD B&R, KARNAL	WORK OF 3 NOS ROADS (1) STG. WITH WBM PLUS SORM BM PLUS 20MM PC ON RAMPURA APP ROAD (ROAD ID-7330) FROM KM 0.00 TO 1.800 (2) WDG. AND STG. WITH WBM PLUS SORM BM PLUS 20MM PC, NEW CCB AND 80MM JPB ON BERM ON GARHI BIRBAL TO MAHAJLI ROAD (ID-12607) IN KM 0.00 TO 1.688 (3) WDG. AND STG. WITH WBM PLUS SORM BM PLUS 20MM PC ON MAHAJLI TO HANSU MAJRA (ID-12608) KM 0.00 TO 1.080 IN INDORI CONSTITUENCY, IN KARNAL DISTRICT (UNDER ODR WP 2026-27).	12.09.2026 25.09.2026	328.30 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9876009311 pwd-ecpd-karnal@hry.nic.in
10	PWD B&R, GURUGRAM	DEVELOPMENT OF LANDSCAPING WORK AT AERODROME BACHOD (NARNAUL) IN DISTRICT MAHENDRAGARH.	16.09.2026 30.09.2026	15.93 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9717214202 zileshingh01@gmail.com
11	PWD B&R, GURUGRAM	DEVELOPMENT OF LANDSCAPING AND BEAUTIFICATION WORK OF DISTRICT HOSPITAL, MANDOKHERA IN DISTRICT NUH (MENTENANCE WORK)	14.09.2026 28.09.2026	23.33 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9717214202 zileshingh01@gmail.com
12	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING, HISAR	SHIFTING OF EXISTING 1000 MM SIZE SEWER LINE AND OPEN BOX TYPE STORM WATER DRAIN PASSING THROUGH THE PLOT NO. 3434 TO 3437 AND 3464 TO 3473 OF SECTOR 14 PART -II BY 1200 MM Q/D HOPE SEWER LINE AND 1200 MM Q/D RCC NP-3 STORM WATER LINE RESPECTIVELY IN HISAR TOWN (DEPOSIT WORK)	CLOSING DATE 25.09.2026	408.45 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01662-247033 eehisar@gmail.com
13	KALPANA CHAVILA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR COMPREHENSIVE MAINTENANCE CONTRACT (CMC) OF SEWAGE TREATMENT PLANT (STP), EFFLUENT TREATMENT PLANT (ETP) AND WATER TREATMENT PLANT (WTP) AT KCSMC, KARNAL.	17.09.2026 28.09.2026	EMD 1.88 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8295340665 director.kagch-hry@gov.in
14	BPS GMC FOR WOMEN KHANPUR KALAN, SONPAT.	TENDER FOR CONSUMABLES VACUUM BASED PURPLE IN BPS GMC FOR WOMEN, KHANPUR KALAN +32 OTHER WORKS	15.09.2026 21.09.2026	EMD 3.25 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9416803361 bpsgmc.purchase@gmail.com
15	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA,ROHTAK	PREPARING & PRINTING OF SAIRA PLAN OF 13 NO. VILLAGES (NANDAL, KHAMASHERA, DHANAWA, RINDHANA, MOKHRA KHERI ROL, JINDRAN KALAN, GUDIAL, BHAINI CHANDERPAL, SEMAN, BHAINI MAHAPUR, BEDWA, TAJA MAJRA & NASIR PUR) UNDER THE JURISDICTION OF ROHTAK W/S DIVISION, ROHTAK (PRINT 04 NO. COPIES)	CLOSING DATE 24.09.2026	11.50 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9812211077 zenusnrtk@gmail.com

Office of Executive Engineer, Provincial Division, P.W.D., Ghaziabad E-Procurement Notice Inviting Tenders

No 2992 /4A-Camp Date- 13.09.2026

- On behalf of Governor of Uttar Pradesh invites Short Term online bids through e-tendering from the registered firm for Signage works as per Column 7 below Category. The bid document may be uploaded from dated **21.09.2026 to 26-09-2026 up to 12:00 PM**. Technical bids will be opened on date **26.09.2026 at 12.30 PM**. by the Committee in the office of the Executive Engineer, P.D., PWD, Ghaziabad. Date of financial bid will be informed separately to the technically qualified contractors. In case of holiday or office closed the technical bid/financial bids will be opened on next working day in the same manners.
-

Sl. No	DISTRICT	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs. in Lac)	Bid Security (Rs. in Lacs)	Cost of Tender	Category (Signage)	Time of Completion
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1		Signage work on Banthla Dikoli Road	16.60	1.66	2000+ 300 + GST 18%	A	01 Months
2	Ghaziabad	Signage work on Banthla Dikoli Road (ODR) in Km. 8 to Behta Hajipur Road in Km. 9, 10, 11, 12, 13 (500)	18.96	1.90	2000+ 300 + GST 18%	A	01 Months

- Terms / conditions and details related to the tender can be seen in the office of Executive Engineer, P.D. PWD, Ghaziabad, Superintending Engineer, Bulandshahar Circle, PWD, Bulandshahar and Chief Engineer, Meerut Zone, PWD Meerut.
- The terms / conditions and details related to the tender are available on the website <http://etender.up.nic.in>.
- In PWD technical evaluation of tenders is to be done by Prahari Software URL for Prahari is <http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahari/>
- According to Government Order No. 86/2026/649/2026/23.7099/106/2025 Lo. Ni. Anu. -7, dated 23.05.2026, additional performance security will have to be deposited & The contractor is required to deposit performance security valid for 45 days from the date of expiry of defect liability period For unbalanced bids, it will be mandatory to deposit additional performance security amount by the date of completion of work as per the Contract Bond.

Assistant Engineer P.D., PWD,Gzb.	UPID-256225 Dt. 15.09.2026 www.upidadv.gov.in	Executive Engineer P.D., PWD Gzb.
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Office of Executive Engineer, Provincial Division, P.W.D., Ghaziabad E-Procurement Notice Inviting Tenders

No 2993 /4A-Camp Date- 11.09.2026

- On behalf of Governor of Uttar Pradesh invites Short Term online bids through e-tendering from the registered firm for Road works as per Column 7 below Category. The bid document may be uploaded from dated **21.09.2026 to 26-09-2026 up to 12:00 PM**. Technical bids will be opened on date **26.09.2026 at 12.30 PM**. by the Committee in the office of the Executive Engineer, P.D., PWD, Ghaziabad. Date of financial bid will be informed separately to the technically qualified contractors. In case of holiday or office closed the technical bid/financial bids will be opened on next working day in the same manners.
-

Sl. No	DISTRICT	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs. in Lac)	Bid Security (Rs. in Lacs)	Cost of Tender	Category (Signage)	Time of Completion
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1	Ghaziabad	Special repair work of the first section of the Muradnagar canal bank to Jalalabad road.	15.60	1.56	2000+ 300 + GST 18%	A	03 Months

- Terms / conditions and details related to the tender can be seen in the office of Executive Engineer, P.D. PWD, Ghaziabad, Superintending Engineer, Bulandshahar Circle, PWD, Bulandshahar and Chief Engineer, Meerut Zone, PWD Meerut
- The terms / conditions and details related to the tender are available on the website <http://etender.up.nic.in>.
- In PWD technical evaluation of tenders is to be done by Prahari Software URL for Prahari is <http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahari/>
- According to Government Order No. 86/2026/649/2026/23.7099/106/2025 Lo. Ni. Anu. -7, dated 23.05.2026, additional performance security will have to be deposited & The contractor is required to deposit performance security valid for 45 days from the date of expiry of defect liability period For unbalanced bids, it will be mandatory to deposit additional performance security amount by the date of completion of work as per the Contract Bond.

Assistant Engineer P.D., PWD,Gzb.	UPID-256381 Dt. 16.09.2026 www.upidadv.gov.in	Executive Engineer P.D., PWD Gzb.
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OFFICE OF SENIOR TOWN PLANNER, GURUGRAM

Department of Town & Country Planning, Haryana
Sector-14, HSVP complex, 3rd floor, Gurugram.
Telephone- 0124-4014776
E-mail: stp4.gurugram.tcp@gmail.com

Dated: 17.09.2026

PUBLIC NOTICE
This is to inform general public, allottees, landowners, collaborators, banks/financial institutions, and all other stakeholders that Licence no. 103 of 2019 dated 05.09.2019 was granted in favour of Sh. Ratan Lal, Sh. Satbir Singh, Sh. Tej Prakash Ss/o Sh. Ram Gopal, Sh. Yograj, Sh. Dev Dutt Ss/o Sh. Shiv Narayan, Sh. Rohtas Singh Sh. Hans Raj, Sh. Desh Raj Ss/o Sh. Bhoop, Sh. Vasdev, Sh. Ram Avtar, Sh. Krishan Kumar Ss/o Sh. Ishwar Singh, Ms. Roshni, Skuntla, Prakash, Sunita, Rajbala D/o Sh. Ishwar in collaboration with Ocean Seven Buildtech Pvt. Ltd. in accordance with section 3 of Haryana Development and Regulation of Urban Areas Act, 1975 (Act no. 8 of 1975) and Affordable Housing Policy-2013 for setting up of an Affordable Group Housing Colony over an area measuring 5.10 acres in the revenue estate of village Badshahpur, Sector 70, Gurugram. has been cancelled by DTCP order Memo No. LC 3770/JE (RK)/2026/28412 dated 07.08.2026.
Pursuant to proceedings initiated under Rule 19 of the Haryana Development and Regulation of Urban Areas Rules, 1976, and directives issued vide DTCP Memo No. LC 3770/JE(RK)/2026/316704 dated 02.09.2026, the general public /allottees/stakeholders are hereby notified of the following:
1. Directive Regarding Payments: All allottees of the subject project are strictly informed not to make any further payments to the colonizer/ licensee (M/s Ocean Seven Buildtech Pvt. Ltd.), in accordance with Rule 19(2)(d) of the Haryana Development and Regulation of Urban Areas Rules, 1976.
2. Intimation of Claims, Encumbrances & Third-Party Rights: All allottees, collaborators, landowners, financial institutions, and other claimants having any claim, right, interest, or encumbrance pertaining to the licensed land/project—including loans, mortgages, pledge of shares, or third-party rights—are required to intimate and submit full particulars of their claim accompanied by relevant supporting documents, including allotment agreements, payment proofs, mortgage/ loan details, or contractual agreements within 30 days of the issuance of this Notice in the Office of the Senior Town Planner, Gurugram Circle, 3rd Floor, HSVP Complex, Sector-14, Gurugram.

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RAMNATH GOENKA

◆ IN 1932 ◆

BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

Rates must reflect inflation risks

IN LINE with expectations, the US Federal Reserve has raised interest rates by 25 basis points, lifting the target range of the federal funds rate to 3.75 to 4 per cent. The rationale behind the decision, which all committee members supported, is straightforward — inflation remains uncomfortably high. As Fed chair Kevin Warsh also acknowledged, “The plain fact is that inflation is too high and has been for too long.”

In August, US consumer prices rose 0.4 per cent on a seasonally adjusted basis (keeping the 12-month rate at 3.4 per cent), according to the US Bureau of Labour Statistics. Inflation was driven, in large part, by energy prices. Gas prices in the US are at \$4.43 a gallon, while diesel prices are at roughly \$6.4, up from \$3.7 a year ago, fuelling price pressures across the economy. The decision to raise rates is, however, at odds with US President Donald Trump’s desire for looser monetary policy. Only a few days ago, Trump posted on a social media platform, “High interest rates put the USA at a very unfair disadvantage, and I won’t allow that to happen”. The 10-year US bond yield is hovering around 5 per cent. Trump has, in the past, also rallied against the previous Fed chair Jerome Powell over the central bank’s interest rate decisions. Following the Fed’s decision, he posted, “LOWER THE INTEREST RATES FOR THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA, AND FAST!”. But, considering the projections — inflation, based on the personal consumption expenditures price index, has been pegged at 3.7 per cent in 2026, 2.3 per cent in 2027 and 2.1 per cent in 2028 — it raises the odds of further rate hikes. A healthy labour market — surpassing expectations, 1.6 lakh jobs were added in August, while the unemployment rate remained at 4.1 per cent — will give greater space to policymakers to tackle inflation.

The US Fed is, however, not alone. Central banks across the world are also tightening rates. Last week, the European Central Bank also hiked interest rates by 25 basis points as it sees inflation remaining “well above target for an extended period”. Their decisions come only weeks ahead of the October meeting of the RBI’s monetary policy committee. Considering the price pressures in the economy and recent inflation projections, adjustments to the policy rates are needed.

Rise above the politics of greetings

OFFICIALLY, IT was a “routine transfer” for “public interest”. The political context, though, tells a different story. Hours before her transfer, a group called the Hindu Legal Fund claimed it had lodged a complaint with the West Bengal Home Secretary against IPS officer Bushara Bano, until recently the Additional SP of Kharagpur. The officer’s alleged offence was the greetings she used while speaking on video about her alma mater, Aligarh Muslim University, and praising its Residential Coaching Academy for helping her clear the UPSC exams. “She began with *assalamu alaikum*, used In-shallah... and did not use Vande Mataram or Jai Hind. A serving officer representing the Indian state should maintain neutrality and use national expressions,” according to the Hindu Legal Fund. The government’s opacity regarding the transfer strengthens the impression that it gave in to the demand.

Nothing in the All-India Service Rules prevents an officer from using religious or cultural greetings, especially in a private capacity. The inclusive secularism envisaged in the Indian Constitution — which officials and governments are meant to uphold — allows space for religious and cultural expression. By seemingly punishing an officer for words meant for a particular context and audience, West Bengal’s BJP government is, deliberately or not, making the same mistake as its predecessors.

For the better part of five decades, state capacity in West Bengal has been eroded by a politics that saw “the party” and its affiliates — whether the CPI(M) or Trinamool Congress — all but exercise a veto over all aspects of governance. Much of the anger against the TMC government and its “syndicate” stemmed precisely from the fact that it was at once both overbearing where it did not need to be and absent where it was needed; that the law and the rules were selectively applied. The Suvenudu Adhikari government, rather than focussing on correcting this lopsided deficit, seems to be deepening it. In a state that needs conversations and policies around jobs, education and industry, the focus seems to be on diet, “gerua yatra” and how a young officer says hello and goodbye. It sends a message not of “minimum government, maximum governance” but of government high-handedness. The Suvenudu Adhikari government needs to be responsible and responsive, not to social media trolls and fringe outfits, but to a more expansive and inclusive idea of “public interest”.

A reality check for an ancient myth

FOR TWO-and-a-half millennia, the Parthenon in Greece has been credited with an architectural sleight of hand that contributed to its perfection. Architects and art historians have insisted that its curved base and gently bulging columns were engineered to correct optical illusions — that without such precision, the temple would appear to sag in the middle, much like a deep-bellied hammock. It is a wonderful story about the intellectual legacy of the ancient Greeks. It is also, according to Oxford University professor Alain Goriely, almost entirely fiction. The mathematician’s new paper debunks the myth, finding the illusions either unsupported by evidence or too microscopic to have been engineered.

The myth’s genesis, it turns out, was not with Ictinus and Callicrates, the architects of Parthenon, but from Vitruvius, a Roman writing four centuries later, whose hearsay was mistaken by Renaissance scholars for eyewitness knowledge. Goriely calls this the “supreme knowledge fallacy” — the flattering assumption that a civilisation capable of extraordinary art must also have possessed a modern scientist’s grasp of optics. In truth, the Greeks were still arguing about whether sight worked by rays shooting out of the eye — extramission, as Plato and others believed — or into it, intramission, as argued by Democritus and his cohorts.

Beyond the mathematics, there is also, it would seem, another lesson in Goriely’s findings: On how readily admiration can manufacture glib explanations. In a post-truth age, with its penchant for optical illusions that bend reality to one’s liking, Goriely’s most subversive invitation is not to admire the Parthenon less but to look at it more carefully. There are many things that make a civilisation great. The ability to discern when our certainties need a reality check is one of them.

THERE HAS been considerable discussion in these pages on the accuracy and/or credibility of the GDP data for March-June 2026. My guess is that internationally also this debate has assumed importance. Given this, I hope I can be excused for penning another op-ed on the subject.

It is important to separate the commentary on Indian data into two broad categories — national accounts data, and other data. I have had the privilege of being a member of several government committees since 1998. In 2006, I was appointed as a member of India’s first statistical commission (2006-2009) under the leadership of the late Suresh Tendulkar. Interacting frequently with staff members of the NSS and national accounts division, I emerged with the following observation on keepers of the statistical frame (and flame): “Don’t build a road because you may have an accident”. Stated more favourably, official Indian statisticians would err on the side of “accuracy” or “precision”. If a road is not built, if knowledge is not advanced, so be it — we purists cannot be wrong.

It is for this reason that India has not undertaken the task of conducting a household income distribution survey. I have begged the authorities to do an income distribution survey since 1998.

Note that in conducting consumption surveys, India has been a pioneer in world statistical surveys; and we have not worried about survey consumption ranging between 55 and 60 per cent of consumption estimated via national accounts. India was the first country to outline poverty measurement.

The World Bank’s famous dollar-a-day poverty line was the Indian poverty line! The first household panel survey was conducted by NCAER, the Additional Rural Incomes Survey, 1968-69 to 1970-71; an honour shared with the University of Michigan Panel Study of Income Dynamics, which conducted the first panel in 1968.

South Asian countries like Sri Lanka, Pakistan and Bangladesh have been conducting income distribution surveys for years, and India has finally joined the world in this endeavour. Given the dissection and healthy criticism of Indian data, it is important to point out the overwhelmingly unhealthy analysis, let alone criticism, of one of the most successful development transitions in history — China. I myself have published, and discussed, the “fact” that China has shown the fastest-ever poverty reduction over the last 25 years. But how many of us have asked how China obtains this result? And how do the World Bank and IMF treat and analyse Chinese data on poverty?

They don’t. They accept at face value what China provides via deciles of income and consumption, for rural and urban China. What analysis? China conducts household surveys like India does. But no unit-level data has ever been released to the public. My best understanding is that China provides four excel files, one each for consumption and income, rural and urban. There are 12 observations in each file — the 10 deciles and possibly the 5 per cent and 95 per cent mean levels. On that basis,



SURJIT S BHALLA

The ‘unintended’ consequences of that censorship have become evident since then: No matter how good the data produced in India is, there will always be doubt, one that is exploited by political opponents

An EV roadmap for a sustainable city



REKHA GUPTA

SEPTEMBER 17 marks Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s 76th birthday and the start of a month-long Seva Sankalp Abhiyan to mark 25 years of his uninterrupted leadership in government.

The nation is celebrating this occasion through the language that has defined his public life: Seva. In Delhi too, we are giving this spirit of *seva* a tangible form through several initiatives. Development projects worth more than Rs 13,000 crore are being inaugurated or launched during this campaign.

Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya’s philosophy of Integral Humanism reminds us that the individual, society, nature, and the larger universe cannot be viewed in isolation. Development must restore harmony. PM Modi has brought this understanding into contemporary public policy. His vision of a developed India cannot be separated from the creation of cleaner, more efficient and resilient cities.

India’s electric mobility journey demonstrates how rapidly such a vision can translate into reality. Total electric vehicles (EV) sales have risen from just 2,322 in FY 2014-15 to 25,45,622 in FY 2025-26. The Delhi government’s Electric Vehicle Policy is designed for this.

The urgency is undeniable. A Commission for Air Quality Management assessment submitted to the Supreme Court in January identified vehicular emissions as the largest primary source of Delhi’s winter air pollution, accounting for approximately 23 per cent. Two-wheelers constitute nearly 67 per cent of Delhi’s vehicle stock, while three-wheelers, commercial vehicles, and goods carriers clock exceptionally high daily mileage. Electrifying these high-use segments can deliver great environmental benefits.

The Delhi EV Policy outlines a phased transition. From January 1, 2027, new registrations of L5 three-wheelers and N1 goods carriers will move to an electric-only framework, with two-wheelers following from April 1, 2028. Fleet aggregators and delivery-service providers are also being moved towards electric mobility, while school buses will progressively increase their electric share to 30 per cent by March 31, 2030.

Affordability is central. Electric two-wheelers will receive purchase support of up to Rs 30,000 in the first year, along with scrapping incentives, while eligible

N1 commercial vehicles can receive purchase support of up to Rs 1 lakh. For private car owners, the policy provides a ₹1 lakh scrapping incentive for scrapping a BS-IV or older car and purchasing an eligible electric car priced up to ₹30 lakh ex-showroom, along with a 100 per cent waiver of road tax and registration fees until March 31, 2030. The scrapping incentive is capped at the first one lakh eligible applicants.

The real backbone of this transition is infrastructure. Delhi is aiming for 32,000 public charging points, requiring approximately 23,000 additional points over the existing network. Delhi Transco Limited will serve as the nodal agency for public charging and battery-swapping infrastructure, and a high-powered committee chaired by the Chief Secretary will bring together the departments responsible for transport, power, planning, environment, and finance to drive implementation.

EV dealers will be required to provide public charging facilities, while new civil infrastructure created by the Delhi government, MCD, NDMC, and Delhi Cantonment Board will have to be EV-charging-ready from the design stage.

DISCOMs have also been asked to facilitate the installation of separate meters for home EV charging. Public transport will be a crucial pillar. Delhi already has more than 5,000 electric buses, with a target of up to 13,000 in the next few years.

The road ahead is not without challenges. Behavioural change takes time, and infrastructure must keep pace with demand. Industry, government, and citizens will all have responsibilities.

The Seva Sankalp Abhiyan reminds us that governance is ultimately about service. The green transition reminds us that service cannot be limited to the present generation. We owe a debt to those who will inherit the city we build.

This is perhaps where the meaning of September 17 becomes larger than a birthday celebration. It becomes an occasion to reflect on the India we want to build and the Delhi we want to leave behind.

The Prime Minister has often spoken of a developed India by 2047. As India moves towards a developed, self-reliant and sustainable future, Delhi is determined to not only witness that transformation, but drive it.

The writer is chief minister of Delhi



SALMAN SOZ

Proof of growth lies beyond GDP number

THE CONTROVERSY on the latest GDP report stems from concerns around methodology, transparency and the veracity of the underlying data. I will not re-litigate this controversy here. Instead, I want to explore what it means when experts suggest that the economy does not feel as if it is growing at 7.8 per cent.

Joseph Stiglitz has long argued that GDP can rise even as many citizens feel worse off. That’s why household incomes, consumption, and economic security matter. When an economy is booming, people should find better jobs, see real incomes rising, save and consume with greater confidence, while businesses invest because they expect demand to endure.

The government cites rising labour-force participation as evidence that employment is no longer a serious problem. In the years after the India Shining campaign, BJP leaders cited surveys showing the creation of some 60 million jobs under the first NDA government. Much of that increase consisted of self-employment driven by rural distress. We know how that ended. Something similar is happening now. In 2025, Labour Minister Mansukh Mandaviya cited a 19 per cent increase in agricultural employment. And the share of workers in agriculture has also risen in recent years. For a developing economy, that is troubling; Development normally means workers moving out of low-productivity farming, not back into it.

Real wages, especially in rural India, rose strongly during the high-growth years of the 2000s. But wage growth has been much weaker in the last decade even as corporate profitability surged. The government’s own Economic Survey noted that corporate profits rose by more than 22 per cent in FY 2023-24, while employment at the firms it examined increased by only around 1.5 per cent. During the boom years, 2003-04 to 2007-08, net household financial savings averaged more than 11 per cent of GDP. By 2025-26, they had fallen to 6.2 per cent, a level last seen in the early 1980s. Borrowing alone does not indicate distress, but the combination of weakening financial savings and rising consumption borrowing is not what a broad-based boom should look like.

Two-wheeler and passenger-vehicle sales rose sharply in the April-June quarter. But a quarter’s data does not make a decadal trend. Two-wheelers, the entry point to middle-class mobility, grew at nearly 11 per cent a year in the decade before 2014. In the decade after, growth fell to under 2 per cent; even through 2025-26, it is barely above 3 per cent. Passenger vehicles slowed too.

Finally, investment. The earlier boom saw the investment rate rise from roughly 27 per cent of GDP in 2003 to close to 39 per cent by 2008. Investment today remains well below the peak during the UPA era, though it has recovered to about 34 per cent of GDP. But who is doing the investing? Public capital expenditure has played a major role while private corporate investment has been far less exuberant than record profits might suggest. Net foreign direct investment, too, has been weak. If businesses saw a durable demand boom ahead, one would expect considerably greater urgency in adding capacity.

None of this means 7.8 per cent is fiction. What I am asking for is not a lower number, but a different kind of proof. Show me private investment rising on its own, not propped up by government spending. Show me real wages climbing the way they did in the boom years. Show me two-wheeler sales closing the gap with their old growth rate, not coasting on one good quarter. Show me the workforce moving off farms again.

Soz is an author, economist and member, Indian National Congress

40 YEARS AGO

September 18, 1986



177 killed in South African mine

FIRE SPARKED off by a welding accident sent deadly chemical fumes billowing through a gold mine, killing at least 177 workers and injuring 235 in Kinross, South Africa, officials said. Rescue teams wearing breathing apparatus evacuated 2,200 men from the Kinross Gold Mines, 100 km east of Johannesburg.

US arsenal for germs warfare

THE PENTAGON is quietly increasing its

research into germs warfare. It is cloning some of the world’s rarest and deadliest of diseases to increase its arsenal for germs warfare. Critics are expressing fears that the US is laying the groundwork for a new biological weapons system.

PM on communalism

THE PRIME Minister, Rajiv Gandhi, made an appeal to keep religion and politics apart. Addressing a special Congress (I) convention at St Alberts College Grounds soon after his arrival in Cochin, he said the big-

gest threat to the country came not from outside but from within.

On Hindi, Tamil Nadu vs Centre

THE TAMIL Nadu Government has urged the Centre to withdraw its recent circular on use of Hindi in central government offices to avoid a law-and-order situation in the state. A “strongly” worded letter on the issue has been written to the PM, Rajiv Gandhi, by the state Finance Minister, V R Nedunchezhiyan, who also holds the Chief Minister’s portfolios in his absence.

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ILLUSTRATION: C.R SASIKUMAR

In the wake of the Satya Niketan tragedy, how should Delhi's student-housing crisis be tackled?

Fix the small-format housing problem



ADARSHA KAPOOR

THE COLLAPSE of a building in Delhi's Satya Niketan has brought to the forefront the failure of planning and regulation by development authorities and landowners. While the loss of lives and the apathy of those responsible is rightfully receiving attention, little of it is diverted to preventing similar occurrences in urban villages and unauthorised colonies, which are the only source of supply of "accessible" small-format housing in the Delhi-NCR.

Small-format housing is a shared accommodation and can range from a studio, a one RK (room and kitchen) unit, a one-BHK unit, small two-BHK units, or assisted units. For students, young professionals, nuclear families, senior citizens (either living alone or only with a spouse) and even persons with disabilities, from lower to upper-middle income brackets, such units are practical, thus in high demand for both ownership and rental. These are the backbone of a developed economy (look at the role of social housing in the Netherlands). But where are they?

Let's understand the predicament of the most vulnerable groups, in dire need of small-format housing. Students without allocated hostels need accommodation close to their educational institute to avert the inconvenience and cost of travel. Young graduates need affordable accommodation near offices and may pay a cost marginally higher than students pay for the same conveniences. For women, security considerations override all other conveniences, and securing housing is tougher (and expensive), irrespective of their willingness to pay. Nuclear families and senior citizens prefer to stay close to their desired school and healthcare facility. They pay a higher price ranging from Rs 25,000 to Rs 75,000 per unit of similar housing typology. They may get accommodation in planned parts of Delhi. Any less is always in unregulated areas. The hardships of securing respectable shelter for people with disabilities, foreign visitors, and minorities deserve a separate chapter.

The Master Plan for Delhi (MPD-2047) is responsible for ensuring supply, regulating circle rates, and ensuring sustainable development through public or private developers. The MPD-2047 says, "Nearly 85 per cent of the city's population belongs to low and mid-income segments. The high cost of land in the city has resulted in unaffordable housing which has led to proliferation of unauthorised colonies (UCs), slums, and densification of urban villages. Around

28.4 per cent of the households live in rental accommodation (Census, 2011). 32.3 per cent of the population are migrants (Socio-Economic Survey of Delhi, GNCTD, 2018-19) who prefer rental housing due to low entry and exit costs. Most of this rental housing demand is being catered by unplanned settlements." The document also highlights the huge deficit in the provision of different housing formats, especially the small-format affordable ones.

But let's look at the regulations for small-format housing in the MPD-2047. Such formats will get a maximum floor area ratio (FAR) of 300, ground coverage of 40, minimum plot area of 2000 sqm and a minimum right of way of 12m. On the one hand, the ground coverage and FAR make development of small-format housing unviable and on the other, identifying a land parcel of 2000 sqm or even undertaking land pooling, where required, is a Herculean task. This encourages illegal developments like Satya Niketan to thrive.

The MPD-2047 discusses involvement of the private sector through proposed redevelopment, land pooling and other provisions at length. The private sector has been eager to venture into this category of housing in Delhi. In theory, by increasing the variety of products, the private sector should have attracted a larger pool of end-users while boosting business.

The private sector, like in any other city, has been voicing the need for suitable regulations, location and fiscal tools to provide for the increasing demand for small format housing. For example, apart from allocation of land at suitable locations for such units, the development regulations need to allow higher ground coverages, ease of amalgamation/sub-division of land, ease of mixed-use, change of use, fiscal incentives in duties, and charges to ensure that the asset classes developed remain affordable for the actual end users.

The erstwhile Master Plan did allow plot amalgamation for group housing to improve housing stock and increase affordable units. So, the city got a King's Court and Queen's Court, "affordable" at Rs 25 cr per unit; or the Godrej housing in Okhla, with 2-5 BHK units starting at Rs 5.51 cr. The private sector cannot be blamed for this alone. The high cost of land development, the high Equivalent Car Space norms, the low Ground Coverage and the high "unforeseen" expenses make only a 3-BHK "sustainable" and even a small 2-BHK priced at a premium. Furthermore, the density regulations of plotted development disallow multiple-tenant housing per floor, forcing small developers to supply a 3-BHK and above.

Satya Niketan's failure, therefore, is not a one-off case. It is a collective failure of planning and implementation.

The writer is a practising urban designer



ISHAN BAKSHI

THE REACTION to the tragedy at Satya Niketan has unfolded along predictable lines. The municipal body has intensified its sealing and demolition drive. Calls for stricter implementation of building laws and greater regulation have gained traction. Alongside, the Delhi government has pitched for developing hostels for 10,000 students.

Unfortunately, none of this will dramatically alter the situation on the ground. Not only is the capacity of the Indian state to effectively implement the laws and codes it enacts constrained, it also lacks the resources to build the student accommodation on the scale that is required. Delhi University alone is home to almost 2.5 lakh undergraduate and postgraduate students. Juxtaposed against the roughly 9,000 hostel seats that the university and its affiliated colleges offer, it gives a sense of the demand-supply mismatch.

A market has naturally sprung up to bridge the gap. Private alternatives have come up in areas such as Mukherjee Nagar, Kamala Nagar, Ber Sarai, and other locations.

The steady decline of public educational institutions across the country has meant that there are very few islands of excellence that are left. Delhi University, being one of them, will continue to attract students from across the country. But for this large and ever expanding non-resident student population, no plans appear to have been drawn up, and no thought has been given to the development of the ancillary infrastructure needed to service the segment.

State financing of student accommodation is simply not possible at such a large scale. Government budgets are already stretched. Many universities and colleges, aided and unaided, are also unlikely to have the financial capacity to even attempt this. While some elite universities do have the resources and offer such facilities, can the state realistically force/regulate every institution, every academy to provide accommodation to its students?

There are private alternatives to consider.

Universities/colleges could, for example, contract out the hostel/accommodation facilities to private players. Vinayak Chatterjee, co-founder and managing trustee of The Infravision Foundation, says that under this arrangement, the private developers could build and run these

facilities, while ensuring adherence to building and safety norms. For real-estate developers, there is a guaranteed catchment market. Educational institutions could also directly enter into long-term contracts with formal establishments, lease apartments/accommodation in bulk and then allocate them to the students. Some institutions are already said to be experimenting with some versions of these models. In some Western countries, universities do assist students in navigating off-campus private housing. Some maintain accommodation listings, or even partner with listing platforms. Something along these lines could also be explored in India.

Where institutions have surplus land, it could be provided to real-estate developers on a lease for building housing facilities. For colleges with limited land, perhaps a land pooling framework could be worked out. For constructing student accommodation, the floor area ratio (FAR) could be significantly increased, allowing for a scarce urban resource to be more efficiently used — India has amongst the lowest FAR in the world. The Delhi government is said to be considering this option. As the cost of land is a significant component of the overall development costs, and would have to be re-couped, this option would help bring down the financial burden for students.

In all these alternatives, the educational institution saves on the capex cost for building the hostels themselves. The money could be spent on strengthening educational infrastructure — on teachers, labs, and the software of education.

Obviously, these private alternatives would charge rates that are higher than the subsidised hostel facilities that are currently offered by public universities. But students living in PGs are, in some sense, already paying market determined fees. In many cases, the location premium leads to the extraction of very high rents, as reports in this paper suggest. Structured alternatives would, however, give the students a better option. And for those without the means, perhaps some form of subsidy can be considered. In all these options, the educational institution is involved and does not get to wash its hands off the issue.

Exploring these options, however, requires an honest reckoning with the true costs of education in India. While public universities do keep the direct cost of education low, the total cost — including other services such as accommodation that are more often than not not subsidised — is considerably higher, and has to be borne by the students. The mistake of conflating low tuition with affordable education should be avoided.

The writer is senior associate editor, The Indian Express. ishan.bakshi@expressindia.com

For AI governance, hard laws and strong guardrails



SIGNAL TO NOISE

BY RAJEEV CHANDRASEKHAR

ON SEPTEMBER 10, Anthropic published a 154-page threat intelligence report documenting nine months of AI misuse — December 2025 to August 2026. Two days later, Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei published a blog post calling on the industry to slow the development of frontier AI. Within hours, OpenAI's Sam Altman and Elon Musk both agreed. Read together, these two documents tell us everything we need to know about where AI governance must go next.

The misuse cases Anthropic documented span seven harm categories and range from state-sponsored operations to lone actors. The transparency is commendable.

But the report's deeper significance is structural. AI is no longer merely a tool that generates harmful content. It is now an orchestration layer — connected to other software, running multiple stages of an operation simultaneously, enabling sophisticated attacks with fewer people and less expertise than ever before. Anthropic calls this "uplift": The AI capability boost measured in speed, scale, and depth of harm. A flagged Bangladesh disinformation operation was almost entirely automated — AI generated the content, other software turned it into videos, scheduling algorithms published them at optimised times. One person, 29 accounts, 1,500 fabricated stories. That is uplift.

And what Anthropic caught is almost certainly a subset of what was attempted. Anthropic also acknowledges that for its most capable current models, it can no longer assure that a sophisticated actor could not receive meaningful assistance in biological weapons research. That is not reassurance. It is an admission that there are no guardrails to prevent harm because governance has not kept pace.

Amodei's warning was stark: AI has been advancing drastically faster since roughly this summer, and swarms of rogue AI agents could take over the internet within six to 12 months. Three fierce competitors — building the world's most powerful AI — who have spent billions racing each other agreed in one weekend. That is not a PR moment; it is a fire alarm.

I asked a simple question on X: Is a voluntary slowdown possible? The competitive pressures, the capital, and geopolitics — with China operating outside any such agreement — make a unilateral slowdown extraordinarily difficult to sustain. Venture capitalist Chamath Palihapitiya noted the obvious: A market leader calling for a slowdown is also, conveniently, calling for an arrangement that protects its lead.

The voluntary slowdown debate is the wrong frame entirely. The right question is

not how to slow development. It is how to accelerate governance.

When I served as Minister of State for Electronics and Information Technology under Prime Minister Narendra Modi, we built India's platform accountability framework on the principle of Safe, Trusted, and Accountable. The IT Rules of 2021 established legal obligations for platforms operating at scale. That framework saw the future before it was obvious. Anthropic's report vindicates it.

The Bangladesh case is directly relevant to India. The techniques — automated account creation, AI-generated content at scale, optimised for rural low-literacy audiences — are applicable to any democracy with a large, linguistically diverse electorate. India has 950 million eligible voters and continuous state elections. AI-generated disinformation in various languages is easy to produce and difficult to detect. Requiring platforms to detect and disrupt such operations is not regulatory overreach. It is democratic self-defence.

The Alibaba distillation campaign — 151 million AI exchanges to copy a competitor's capabilities — will be run against Indian AI model too. The surveillance cases are a direct warning about AI becoming an instrument of control by those who possess it rather than communication, threatening the right to privacy guaranteed under Article 21 of the Constitution.

For India, several guardrails must be in place. Every AI platform above a defined scale threshold must be required to report detected misuse to CERT-In and a designated AI Safety Authority. To avoid cases like the Bangladesh operation, mandatory watermarking of AI-generated content in information operation was almost entirely automated — AI generated the content, other software turned it into videos, scheduling algorithms published them at optimised times. One person, 29 accounts, 1,500 fabricated stories. That is uplift.



political and public interest contexts is essential.

AI now orchestrates multi-step operations across software systems. Platform accountability rules must explicitly cover agentic AI — systems that act in the world, not merely generate text. New legislation must explicitly prohibit and criminalise systematic distillation and fraudulent mass API access.

Voluntary disclosure is not a governance system. We need a statutory body with powers to compel disclosure, audit systems, and impose restrictions. Governance risks can only be addressed by law.

India is uniquely positioned to demonstrate this. We are not the US, constrained by a deregulatory administration. We are not the EU, whose ambition has sometimes outrun its technical understanding. We are the world's largest democracy with a proven record of building technology policy at scale — DPI, UPI, Aadhaar, the IT Rules — and a direct stake in ensuring AI serves 1.4 billion citizens rather than a handful of American or Chinese technology companies.

The call from Silicon Valley's most powerful is, in effect, an invitation to governments to act. India can lead it with a legal framework that makes safety and accountability mandatory, enforceable, and permanent.

The writer, former MP, former minister of state for Electronics & Information Technology, Government of India, is BJP Kerala state president and MLA for Nemon. Views are personal

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

UPI fee

THE GOVERNMENT cannot say that its decision to introduce a 0.4 per cent fee on UPI (unified payments interface) payments above Rs 2000 will cause no financial burden to people ('A small fee, a stronger UPI', *IE*, September 17). The merchant discount rate (MDR) is a disincentive not only for the merchants but also for the customers. Merchants, or at least most of them, are sure to increase the prices of products to make up for what they pay as fees. They may prefer cash to digital payment via UPI for transactions above the threshold of Rs 2000 to avoid paying extra.

C David Milton, Maruthancode

THE DECISION of the National Payments Corporation of India to levy charges for transactions above Rs 2000 is not a welcome move, although it is stated to have good intentions ('A small fee, a stronger UPI', *IE*, September 17). Most of the population has by now adapted to the digital payment system, using it in all walks of life. People like me try to make all payments digitally. Recently, when my mobile phone was under service for about two

weeks, the absence of this digital payment system made me feel handicapped. The customers, and the general public, are bound to have an apprehension that the move will be followed up by making transactions chargeable to a wider population.

Jiji Panicker K, Alappuzha

Misuse of law

SECTION 299 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, inherited from a colonial-era law, has become a weapon for the mob ('Let's curb misuse of a legal relic that elevates the mob over the individual', *IE*, September 17). Its vague words about hurting religious feelings allows anyone to drag a writer, artist, or comedian through years in court, even when no conviction follows. This chills free speech and frightens creative people into silence. True faith does not need the state to punish every insult. Criminalising offence does not strengthen religion, it weakens democracy and the Constitution. Requiring government permission before registering such cases would stop frivolous complaints and protect the right to speak freely.

Babu Crishna, Bengaluru

My lessons in turning ambition into reality

constraint and saw the possibility of building a new engine of growth for Gujarat and, in time, for India.

In 2014, a new government came to power at the centre, and Modi became the Prime Minister of India. As the then-Secretary of the Department of Industrial Policy and Promotion, I was among the first officials to make a presentation to him. He was disappointed that India was ranked 142nd in the World Bank's Ease of Doing Business rankings and asked us to focus on a mission — to make India easier, simpler, and more efficient for its citizens and businesses.

We worked on the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, the Goods and Services Tax, and the elimination of outdated rules, regulations, procedures and Acts. Changing the mindset of departments was difficult, but we persisted. India eventually rose 79 places in the rankings.

PM Modi's belief in frontier technologies has consistently been accompanied by a willingness to create the policy and in-

stitutions that enable Indian entrepreneurs to build in new areas. Under him, India has created immense opportunities in AI, quantum computing, geospatial technology, drones, defence and space exploration. The success of India's space missions, including Chandrayaan-3 and Aditya-L1, has been accompanied by the emergence of a vibrant private space ecosystem.

At the same time, initiatives like the National Green Hydrogen Mission ensure that the country's development and industrial growth do not come at the cost of the planet.

I found myself at the head of India's apex policy think tank, NITI Aayog, by 2016. During a cabinet meeting, PM Modi asked me to begin work on India's most backward districts. That conversation led to the Aspirational Districts Programme, through which I saw the PM's deep belief in real-time data, measurable outcomes and the power of young officers. He was convinced that transforming these districts would transform India. The results confirmed his instinct. Dis-

tricts began improving their performance across health, education, agriculture, financial inclusion and basic infrastructure.

As I was leaving NITI Aayog, I called on the PM to offer my gratitude. He asked me to take on the responsibility of India's G20 Sherpa. Geopolitical tensions were high, and consensus seemed almost impossible. He was determined that India could bring countries together. It was in the grip of this conviction that the New Delhi Leaders' Declaration was crafted and unanimously passed.

Working with Prime Minister Modi has fundamentally shaped my understanding of leadership. I have learned that a leader must be willing to imagine what does not yet exist and then bring the full force of the state, the administration, and the nation behind that imagination.

The writer is former G20 Sherpa of India, CEO, NITI Aayog and Secretary, Department of Industrial Policy and Promotion



AMITABH KANT

I WAS beginning to lose hope that India's ambition to develop its first green-field city would become a reality. As CEO of the Delhi Mumbai Industrial Corridor Development Corporation (DMIC), I was tasked with driving the next phase of India's industrial urbanisation. Every chief minister had rejected our proposal, saying that earmarking 150 sq km for such a project was far too risky. Then I walked into the Gujarat chief minister's office. Narendra Modi heard me out and said, "150 sq km is too small. If you're going to dream, then dream big." He offered 750 sq km. In 2009, the Gujarat government enacted the Special Investment Region (SIR) Act and officially declared Dholera SIR alongside its master plan.

That conversation showed me the scale of his thinking. He did not see land as a



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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

• CLIMATE

How melting glaciers could ‘put 20% of GDP at risk’

Yashee
New Delhi, September 17

WHILE THE Himalayas’ melting glaciers are under the spotlight due to the Nepal floods, damage from the warming mountains also means economic drain — as glaciers retreat, water supplies become less reliable and the rivers that sustain agriculture, industry, cities and hydropower change. A new report puts a number to this economic dependence: More than a fifth of India’s GDP is underpinned by the Himalayas.

The report, ‘A resilient Himalaya: protecting a region at risk and securing future prosperity’, was compiled by the consultancy Systemiq, in partnership with Integrated Mountain Initiative, and supported by the International Centre for Integrated Mountain Development, Nepal, and GB Pant National Institute of Himalayan Environment, Uttarakhand. The report estimates that Rs 64.8 lakh crore, 21.5% of India’s FY24 GDP, is dependent on the Himalayas.

Glaciers and the economy

The Himalayas feed the Indus, Ganga and Brahmaputra river systems, supporting agriculture, cities and industry downstream. “The rivers that carry risk downstream also carry the water that sustains India’s economy: wheat and rice across the Indo-Gangetic plain, tea in Assam and Bengal, hydropower in the Northeast, and pilgrimage economies in downstream towns,” the report says.

On how it calculated the 20% of GDP figure, the report explains three layers it used: “(1) direct: GSDP of Himalayan states; (2) indirect: downstream agriculture, manufacturing, hydropower, and services reliant on Himalayan-fed rivers and groundwater recharge (rain-fed production excluded); and (3) induced: supply-chain (e.g., tractors sold from southern states to IndoGangetic Plains) and wage-spending effects (e.g., spent on food and services).”

The report highlights that the Himalayas are already a major disaster hotspot. They account for 18% of India’s land but around 35% of its disasters. Disasters can create food and water insecurity, disrupt supply chains, displace people and increase macroeconomic and sovereign-debt pressures, creating a cycle in which reconstruction spending leaves less money for future resilience.

The black carbon connection

The report identifies black carbon — soot produced by incomplete combustion — as a pollutant that is causing damage and which India has the power to act on fast, unlike global warming. It suggests modernising the brick kiln industry as a solution. Other experts agree with the dangers of black carbon. “Black carbon has a real, major, and measurable effect on the Himalaya. When it lands on snow, it darkens the surface, so the snow absorbs more sunlight instead of reflecting it. Modelling shows this ‘snow darkening’ effect alone adds about 40 watts/m² of surface heating in spring season across the Himalaya,” Nimish Singh, president and director, Gateway Research, the India arm of the Institute for Governance and Sustainable Development, told *The Indian Express*.

Singh said while fixing brick kilns would have measurable benefits, “brick kilns are not the whole story”. “Converting kilns to zigzag technology (a method of firing the bricks in a way that fuel is burnt more efficiently) cuts black carbon and particulate emissions by roughly 70% and fuel use by 20–30%. But adoption is uneven in India. Punjab and Haryana have completed the switch to zigzag kilns. Uttar Pradesh, India’s largest brick producer, is still at only 56%. The rest of India is running on traditional tech,” Singh said. But he added that “real progress needs kilns, cookstoves, transport, and crop-residue burning to be tackled together.”

• WILDLIFE

Orangutans in Odisha: The laws governing animal trade and repatriation

Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, September 17

LAST WEEK, the Odisha Forest department rescued five baby orangutans, a critically endangered animal, from a forest in Balasore district. As orangutans are native to the rainforests of Indonesia and Malaysia, the incident prompted multiple questions — how did they reach India’s shores? Were they smuggled? And does India need to return them?

The incident brings to the fore a trend that has been repeatedly flagged by wildlife crime control experts: That India is no more just a transit route, but is fuelling demand for exotic pets.

Global treaty on animal trade

The international trade of wildlife, their body parts and trophies is not prohibited. But it is strictly regulated through the Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species of Wild Fauna and Flora (CITES). The international treaty came into force in 1975, and India became a party to it in 1976. The treaty’s aim is to ensure that cross-border trade in wildlife and plants is legal, sustainable and traceable without harming their survival in the wild.

It is essentially a licensing system that puts in checks and controls on the import,

export and re-export of live animals and plants, wildlife body parts, and trophies. The controls are implemented via an exhaustive “CITES species-list”, which is divided into three appendices. These appendices determine the level of protection accorded to those species.

CITES protects around 6,700 species of animals, comprising 339 mammals, 159 birds, 113 reptiles, 24 amphibians, 26 fish, and 69 invertebrates.

Appendix-I listed species are those facing the threat of extinction. Such species can be traded only with valid permits — provided they are captive-bred and are for conservation purposes. Some notable and controversially allowed trade related to charismatic species includes elephant ivory, rhino horn, elephant and lion trophy hunting, and crocodile skin.

India’s Wild Life (Protection) Act, 1972, was amended in 2022 to harmonise it with CITES. The amendment added a Schedule to include CITES-listed species.

Repatriation not a must

There are three species of orangutans — Bornean, Sumatran and Tapanuli — and they are all listed under Appendix-I of CITES. This means their trade is strictly restricted to non-commercial purposes, such as research, transfers between recognised

• ECONOMY

Russia sanctions Bill: Tool for Trump, worry for India



SUKALP SHARMA & RAVI DUTTA MISHRA

THE US House of Representatives on Wednesday passed a sweeping Bill aimed at squeezing Russia’s revenue from oil and gas exports amid the war in Ukraine. The Bill includes provisions for charging up to 100% tariffs on the top five buyers of Russian energy — India is the second-biggest export market for Russian crude.

The ‘Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026’ — a watered-down version of a proposed legislation initially backed by the late US senator and named after him — received the US Senate’s (upper house) approval last month.

The Bill, which gives discretionary powers to Donald Trump on implementing its provisions, now just needs the US President’s sign-off after the lower house’s vote.

For India, the developments are significant. The country depends on imports to meet over 88% of its crude oil needs, and Russia currently accounts for nearly half of these imports. It remains to be seen if and when Trump turns the Bill into law through his signature, and how his administration implements its provisions, given the energy market crisis amid the West Asia conflict.

A key point to remember is that the Bill does offer some room for workarounds and concessions from Washington. One thing appears certain though: A law like this will give the Trump administration an additional lever to potentially exert pressure on India at a crucial stage in the bilateral trade agreement negotiations.

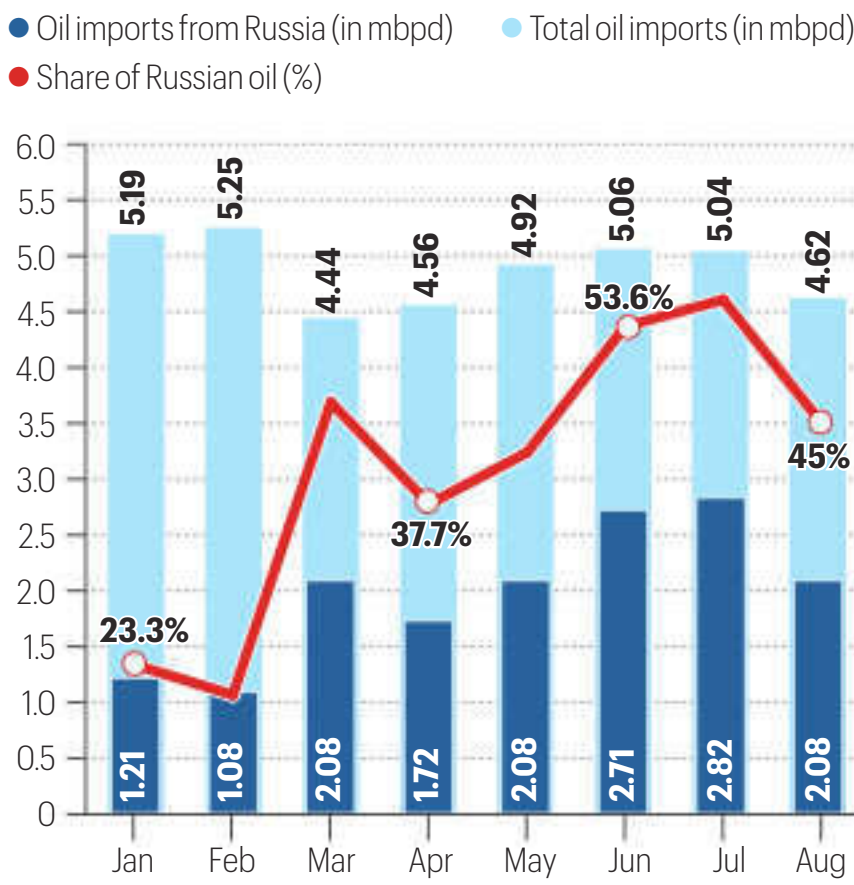
The Ministry of External Affairs said on Thursday that the government remains committed to ensuring the nation’s energy security “through diversified sourcing and on the basis of evolving market dynamics”.

The Bill and the energy market

Even for Trump, taking away millions of barrels of Russian oil from the global market when energy flows from West Asia remain highly constrained wouldn’t be prudent.

In that context, it’s worth noting that

• Russian oil makes up nearly half of India’s oil imports



SOURCE: KPLER, MBPD: MILLION BARRELS PER DAY

earlier this week, Trump called on Ukraine to halt strikes on Russian refineries, given the runaway oil and petroleum product prices amid stifled supplies in the global market. So will he now risk taking more Russian oil off the market by imposing punitive tariffs on countries buying Russian crude in large quantities?

At least till the West Asia crisis persists, Trump might want to exercise restraint and caution in implementing the proposed legislation in full force.

Doing the opposite would worsen an already worrying supply situation and send oil and fuel prices soaring even higher, something that the Trump administration wouldn’t want ahead of the midterm polls in the US later this year.

On its part, India would most certainly move to communicate its energy concerns to Washington, something that was done last year as well when the original draft of the Bill was mooted.

India has been in touch with US authorities over the proposed legislation. The MEA statement said: “This issue has been discussed at high levels in recent months with various US interlocutors. Its potential implications for not just the bilateral rela-

Supply shock
For India, meaningfully reducing Russian oil imports is just not an option amid the plunge in supplies from West Asia.

• For the same reason, it would also be a bad idea for the US to remove millions of barrels of Russian oil from the global market.



A Russian tanker. India depends on imports to meet over 88% of its energy needs, and Russian oil is a key part of that mix. GETTY

tionship but also the international energy market have been very clearly articulated by the Indian side.”

“Passing the Bill under these circumstances would be economic insanity, even for the US itself,” Abu Dhabi-based energy analyst Natalia Katona told *The Indian Express* on Wednesday. “US diesel crack spreads (margins) have already reached \$114 per barrel, largely because of the absence of Russian diesel from the market. Any logical economic assessment would argue against passing this Bill. However, given the level of political opportunism within the current administration and its apparent economic blindness, we should be prepared for anything,” she said.

Trade talks

Apart from energy flows, the Bill creates a second worry for India. It is yet to enter into a trade agreement with the US — it had only signed a framework agreement in February — and the US President might use the proposed law as leverage to exert pressure on Indian negotiators.

In fact, before the US Supreme Court struck down Trump’s tariff powers, the US President had indeed threatened India with

reciprocal tariffs amid the trade negotiations.

Trump in February had lost the authority to impose “reciprocal tariffs” after the US Supreme Court had ruled that the US president’s did not have the authority under the 1977 International Emergency Economic Powers Act to impose broad import duties. Since then, the administration has been finding newer ways to impose trade restrictions.

Now, trade experts say that Congressional approval places Russian oil-related tariffs on stronger legal ground. If the Act is signed, the US Trade Representative will identify the targeted countries and recommend tariff rates. These countries would normally have 180 days to reduce Russian energy imports or negotiate with Washington. The Bill does give powers to the US President to waive the application of its provisions, India is expected to push for those, if the Bill comes into force, according to industry experts and analysts.

The new version of the Bill proposes tariffs of up to 100% on the top five buyers of Russian oil and natural gas, against the proposal of a blanket 500% tariff on buyers of Russian energy in the original version.

While this reduction in proposed tariffs appears meaningful on paper, the cap is still too high for India.

Why Russian oil is key

With much of the West shunning Russian crude following the country’s February 2022 invasion of Ukraine, Russia began offering discounts on its oil to willing buyers. This is how a peripheral supplier became India’s biggest source of crude, displacing traditional West Asian suppliers.

Last year, the US did impose additional penal tariffs on India over its Russian oil imports, which was followed by a sizeable reduction in New Delhi’s imports of Moscow’s crude. But the West Asia war turned the trend on its head, as Russia was the only viable supplier of scale for an energy import-dependent India.

Analysts say that despite the threat of sanctions, Russian crude remains the most practical and competitive source of supply for Indian refiners and is extremely difficult to replace in the current market.

According to vessel tracking data from Kpler, India imported 2.08 million barrels per day of Russian oil in August, accounting for 45% of its total oil imports.

• SPORT

Skincare to sporting success: How collagen is powering athletes

Amit Kamath
Mumbai, September 17

FOR YEARS, skincare companies have marketed cosmetic products by focusing on collagen, claiming it to be a miracle worker of an ingredient that can ward off wrinkles, hydrate the skin and activate the “fountain of youth”. But there’s demand for collagen from another specific sub-set, too: high-performance athletes, chasing not wrinkle-free skin, but perfection on the sporting field.

It is used particularly by athletes — consumed orally as peptides or powder — coming back from injury and those who compete in sports that put a higher load on the body.

Wayne Lombard, the head of athletic performance for the Indian women’s hockey team, told *The Indian Express*: “The science is still developing about the use of collagen by athletes. But we know that using it as a supplement probably gives you 1-3% improvement in certain things. Why

athletes use collagen is because it helps with joint regeneration in ligaments, meniscus, labrum — all areas of the body that are relatively avascular (having few or no blood vessels, which means that there’s not much blood supply there).”

Supplements not the answer

Collagen is the most abundant protein in animals, found as a structural component of connective tissues. It is found in fibrous tissues such as tendons, ligaments, cartilage and skin, but its production slows with age.

Lombard, who also helps athletes, including badminton player P V Sindhu, decathlete Tejaswin Shankar, and long jumper Murali Sreeshankar, said that athletes use collagen to strengthen soft tissues to ensure they are in a “robust state”.

“This is so they don’t sustain overuse or acute injuries. When someone is injured, supplementing with collagen tends to help with not only regeneration of those soft tissues, but also some sort of help with blood

Range of benefits
• Collagen has been found useful for joint health and pain management.
• It is being used by athletes in rowing, swimming and athletics, particularly the triple jumpers, since these disciplines put a high load on the body.

flow,” he added.

It’s not just Lombard. Over at the Inspire Institute of Sport (IIS) in Vijayanagar — where many of India’s Asian Games-bound athletes are training — the belief is that supplementation is not the answer to everything. The high-performance training centre in Karnataka has enforced a “food first approach”, meaning athletes are encouraged as much as possible to get whatever their body needs from natural food sources rather than supplements. But collagen is used by athletes in sports like rowing, swimming and athletics, particularly the triple jumpers, since these disciplines put a high load on the body.

“Collagen is useful for joint health and pain management. In elite athletes, some regular supplementation, which is timed at specific phases in training or during rehab, will help maintain cartilage density, the cushioning of the joints,” Samuel Pullinger, head of sport science at IIS Vijayanagar, told *The Indian Express*.

‘Golden window’
Pullinger added that collagen has a “golden window” of when it should be taken and ideally should be paired with vitamin C.

“This is a major issue, unfortunately, in Indian sport. Athletes will see someone use a specific supplement or they will have read that a supplement is used and they will just use it, right? Like three times a day. With collagen, there’s a specific time period where it is going to be extremely valuable: around 45 to 60 minutes before training or a rehab session,” said Pullinger.

“This timing window is better than some of the other timings because it’s in and around the presence of amino acids in the bloodstream,” he said.

Pullinger also warned against athletes thinking of collagen as some sort of secret ingredient to athletic performance. “Some supplements are extremely valuable. But this is not going to mean that all of a sudden, you will go from finishing 28th to winning the gold medal in your event.”

• THE RISING DEMAND FOR ‘EXOTIC’ PETS

THE APPEAL of ‘unique and unusual’ pets is driving rising trade in exotic wildlife, says a report by Humane World for Animals India.

SEIZURES INDICATE 2 key routes: overland via Northeast India’s borders with Bangladesh and Myanmar, and by air via major international airports (Chennai, Bengaluru, Mumbai).

‘IF YOU LOOK at data from social media and seizures, it’s clear that Indians are acquiring many species listed in CITES. There is also massive trade in species not on the CITES list,’ says wildlife trade expert Uttara Mendiratta.

SOME OFFICIAL DATA first came to the fore in 2021, when the govt brought a voluntary dis-



The orangutans found in Balasore. EXPRESS

closure scheme. RTI data, obtained by Vidhi Centre for Legal Policy, showed **43,693** applications for amnesty were made from 30 states and UTs. Lemurs, kangaroos and ‘rhinoceros iguanas’ were among the species declared.

zoos and breeding projects.

The orangutans found in Odisha are suspected to be from Sumatra. Since they appear to have been traded for commercial purposes, in alleged violation of CITES, the treaty’s provisions and the 1972 Act mandate certain steps for their welfare or return.

The treaty does not make it obligatory to return animals to the wild.

The first challenge on the hands of en-

forced out at the expense of the state of origin. If it is not feasible, it has to be sent to a rescue centre or “such other place” as the management authority deems appropriate.

In the Odisha case, Indonesia’s Ministry of Forestry has reached out to Indian authorities. It is learnt to be “preparing technical requirements” for their repatriation if investigations confirm they are from Indonesia.

The treaty says the authority that has confiscated the animal must ensure that recipient states are cognisant of the impacts of repatriation. The amended Act prescribes a similar line of action, calling for consultation with the country of “export” for the animal’s return, or welfare at a recognised zoo or rescue centre in case it can’t be returned.

Challenges with repatriation

Repatriation involves establishing the country of origin, following protocols, handling legal tangles and, most importantly, maintaining the health of the confiscated animals.

A report on exotic pet trade in India by the global nonprofit Humane World for Animals India, released this July, said that repatriation is complex as the wildlife consignments change multiple hands, passing through different geographies, making a return to the wild rarely feasible. Many species, it said, are captive bred with no

known geographic origin.

Pawan Sharma, advocate and founder of the Mumbai-based wildlife rescue organisation Resqink Association for Wildlife Welfare, said that in the case of airport seizures, most of them are immediately returned to the place of origin in accordance with July 2025 guidelines of the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA).

Sharma said: “We have to keep science, conservation, welfare, and legalities in mind. Repatriation has to factor in what is the exact state of origin, whether that country is willing to take back the animals. Several times the place of origin is not the same as the range or habitats where they are originally found in the wild.”

Odisha: An atypical case

The rescue of the orangutans from a forested area is not a typical case of illegally trafficked wildlife seizure. Across India’s airports, sea ports and land border posts, seizures of illegally trafficked wildlife consignments are usually of multiple animals, sometimes in bulk. Small mammals, reptiles, and amphibians are stuffed in gunny sacks, small cages or plastic boxes. In an infamous May 2022 case from Mizoram’s Champhai district near the Myanmar border, authorities seized 468 animals from six or seven different species.

NOT AGREED TO USTR DEMANDS, ONLY RUPAY CREDIT CARDS CAN BE LINKED TO UPI

Govt to monitor if merchants are passing on UPI MDR to consumers

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, September 17

AMID FEARS shopkeepers and other sellers will pass on the burden of the merchant fee on UPI payments of more than Rs 2,000 and start charging consumers higher prices, government officials on Thursday said they will be monitoring developments on a daily basis once the new system comes into effect from October 15.

They argued that fully subsidising the fast-payment system won't ensure innovation in the sector and rejected claims the Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) of 0.4% has been introduced due to pressure from the US, adding that the government has in fact done the opposite of what the US wanted.

Sources also said the government is working with payment aggregators so that they reach out and explain to shopkeepers and merchants how the new MDR charges will work.

"From October 15, we will monitor on a daily basis whether merchants are passing on the MDR to consumers.

Comparisons will be made with last year," a government official said, requesting anonymity.

While another senior official admitted that the impact of the MDR will only be known once the new framework comes into place, the source expressed confidence that there won't be a fall in UPI transactions from October 15 and the government does not expect "much increase" in the use of cash.

"As a sovereign nation, if we want to have our own institutions, then some transactions have to bear the cost," the official said, adding that "only time will tell" if multiple payments of Rs 1,999 are made to avoid paying the MDR fee.

Earlier this week, the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) announced a revised framework for the levy of a Merchant Discount Rate on UPI transactions of more than Rs 2,000. Paid by sellers, the MDR will apply only on person-to-merchant transactions. Money transfers between two individuals will not face any charge.



Earlier this week, the NPCI announced a revised framework for the levy of an MDR on UPI transactions of more than Rs 2,000. REUTERS

'Not acting under US pressure'

Officials also rejected criticism that the MDR on UPI had been introduced due to external pressure. According to them, if the government was acting under US pressure, it would have allowed credit cards other than RuPay to be linked with UPI – something which the United States Trade Representative had called for in its March 2026 report on foreign trade barriers. Global card issuers such as Visa, Mastercard, and American

Express are all US companies. Only RuPay-backed credit cards can be linked to UPI.

"But we have not agreed to what USTR said," a source said, adding that the government is "consciously promoting RuPay debit cards" by keeping all transactions using them outside of the purview of the MDR, whether the amount is below or above Rs 2,000.

"Any foreign company operating in India would like their product to be as competitive as local ones. But if the govern-

ment has kept RuPay debit cards free (of MDR), how can anyone think we are acting under foreign pressure?"

The USTR report had also expressed concerns about India's decision to limit the number of UPI transactions a third-party app can process at 30% of the system-wide figure. This, it said, created a "non-level playing field".

Walmart-backed PhonePe and Google Pay account for almost 80% of all UPI transactions. The 30% cap, initially set to come into force in January 2023, has been postponed several times, with the current deadline being December 2026.

"Smaller Indian players have come to us and said they cannot compete, have no source of revenue, and don't have deep pockets like these giants. Introducing MDR enables new players to enter and let existing small players compete," the official said. "The issue has been that we haven't been able to implement the 30% cap. But to implement it, smaller players have to be able to come up and compete."

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Semicon 2.0 draws up to \$12 billion in investment proposals, says Vaishnaw

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, September 17

THE GOVERNMENT has received investment proposals between \$11-12 billion under the second iteration of India's chip manufacturing programme, spanning several key sectors in the semiconductor supply chain, Union Electronics and IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said on Thursday.

Addressing reporters at the Semicon India 2026 conference, Vaishnaw said the commitments include investments across semiconductor equipment, materials, gases, chemicals and substrates.

The investments are expected to come over the next two to three years, he said, without mentioning the names of the companies that have shown an interest in investing in India.

"The investment numbers that we are seeing today are of the order of Rs 1 lakh crore, or about \$11-12 billion. Many of them don't want us to take their names, but they will make those investment announcements after approvals from their board and shareholders," Vaishnaw said. To be sure, these proposals have been received under the Rs 1.27 lakh crore India Semiconductor Mission 2.0, which offers government subsidies for sev-



Union Electronics and IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw. ANI

eral functions across the chip ecosystem, including design, broader supply chain, and manufacturing and assembly.

India has identified semiconductors as a key economic driver, with New Delhi keen on building a domestic base for the technology as a national priority. India is also witnessing rapidly rising semiconductor demand. It is projected to reach \$110 billion by FY30 and exceed \$200 billion by FY35, while domestic manufacturing remains at a nascent stage.

India spent almost \$150 billion on semiconductor product imports between FY17-FY25. Imports grew at a CAGR of 23% during this period, and if this trend continues, annual imports could reach \$240 billion by 2035.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Tripura Natural Gas Company Limited
(A Joint Venture of GAIL (India) Ltd., Tripura Industrial Development Corporation Ltd., A Govt. of Tripura Undertaking and Assam Gas Company Ltd., A Govt. of Assam Undertaking)
Shilpa Nigam Bhawan, Khejur Bagan, Agartala, Tripura-799006
Phone: 03813500431 | email: hr@tngclonline.com
Web: www.tngclonline.com | CIN : U23201TR19905GC003451

CAREER OPPORTUNITIES IN VARIOUS GRADES
Tripura Natural Gas Company Limited invites **ONLINE** applications from Indian nationals for recruitment of **03 Executive posts in O&M, BIS and Fire & Safety disciplines**.
For detailed advertisement and instructions for filling the online application form, please visit '**CAREERS**' section of **TNGCL website: www.tngclonline.com**
Commencement of on-line Registration & Submission of Application **19th September, 2026 (from 11:00 hrs onward)**. Last date for on-line Registration & Submission of Application **9th October, 2026 (Till 18:00hrs)**. **Corrigendum/ Addendum**, if any, will be hosted on TNGCL's website www.tngclonline.com. Applicants are requested to visit the website regularly to keep themselves updated.
Advt. No. TNGCL/OPEN/MISC/II/2026

BENGALURU METROPOLITAN TRANSPORT CORPORATION
Central Office: Stores & Purchases Dept., K.H. Road, Shantinagar, Bengaluru-560 027.
No: BMTC/CO/CO.SP/TENDER/13/2026-27 Date: 16.09.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER
BMTC Invites Tender for Procurement of the following Goods through KPP Portal:

Sl. No.	Tender No.	Description	Tender Value (approx) Rs. in Crores	Last date for bid submission in KPP Portal
Short-Term Tender				
1	BMTC/2026-27/IND0349	Procurement of Pre-cured Tread Rubber and Allied materials.	1.96	23.09.2026 at 17.00 Hrs
Regular Tender				
2	BMTC/2026-27/IND0350	Procurement of Spring Clamps	0.10	05.10.2026 at 17.00 Hrs

The above mentioned tender details can be obtained from <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>. Further any addendum/corrigendum in respect of change in calendar of events, specification, other tender terms and conditions etc. will be uploaded/published through kpp portal only.
Note: Interested Bidders need to register in the e-procurement portal. For further information visit BMTC Central Office or log on to <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>
Sd/- CONTROLLER OF STORES AND PURCHASES (Tender Inviting Authority)

Rs 15,000 crore: What the UPI levy will fetch, and why the govt is backing it

Aanchal Magazine
New Delhi, September 17

● MDR DEBATE

BEGINNING OCTOBER 15, UPI payments above Rs 2,000 to merchants will attract a 0.4% levy called the Merchant Discount Rate (MDR). MDR is the fee merchants pay to the entities that help facilitate a digital transaction.

The new MDR framework, announced Tuesday, is expected to generate around Rs 15,000 crore, an official linked to the payments platform told *The Indian Express*. This amount — which will be shared between banks, payment apps and payment service providers — marks the first step in the direction of a levy to be charged through the country's payment systems for the UPI payment mode that had become almost an equivalent to cash over the last six years.

Banks and other financial players in the payments framework have long been calling for the MDR charge, citing the high costs of running the payments infrastructure. The government has been subsidising payments with turnover less than Rs 50 crore. The government paid a total of Rs 8,730 crore under the incentive scheme between FY22 to FY25.

The government had consistently denied that there was a plan

THE NPCI argued that the government has been indirectly footing the bill for large merchants, and questioned the subsidies being given to large merchants such as Amazon or Flipkart

THESE BIG players are already paying MDR at higher rates on payments through other non-UPI digital payment modes — Visa, Mastercard, and American Express cards for instance

to impose an MDR on UPI. In fact, as recently as June 2025, the Ministry of Finance said in a social media post: "Speculation and claims that the MDR will be charged on UPI transactions are completely false, baseless, and misleading... The Government remains fully committed to promoting digital payments via UPI."

Now, with the reintroduction of the MDR levy, the cost versus benefit debate is again in focus. To put the numbers in perspective, Rs 15,000 crore accounts for less than 4% of the net profits of all listed commercial banks in India seen in FY26. When seen against the profits earned by the top three lenders — State Bank of India, HDFC Bank and ICICI Bank — the MDR receipts' would come to be 7% of their combined net profits of Rs 2.13 lakh crore in the financial year 2025-26.

'Right step'

Critics argue that UPI transactions could have continued for free given the benefits for the public at large, but officials maintained that this marks a step in the "right direction". "In my assessment, it is a step towards magnificently changing everything. At the same time it has to be reasonable. Over a period of time, it has to change but this marks a step in the right direction," the official mentioned above said.

Before the payments framework moved to a zero-MDR regime in January 2020, MDR of up to 0.30% was applicable for UPI P2M (person-to-merchant) transactions. In January 2020, to promote digital transactions, MDR was made zero for RuPay Debit Card and BHIM-UPI transactions through amendments in Section 10A of the Payments and Settlement Systems Act, 2007 and Section 269SU of the Income-tax Act, 1961.

Transactions of more than Rs 2,000 make up just 4% of all payment-to-merchant payments in volume terms, but they account for 67% of total value of such payments. And UPI processed a whopping 2,451 crore transactions valued at Rs 29.9 lakh crore in August 2026 alone. This volume highlights UPI's role as the main financial engine of the Indian economy.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

TATA SONS BOARD MEETING

SP Group tables Rs 25k-cr stake sale plan

ENS Economic Bureau
Mumbai, September 17

TATA TRUSTS Chairman Noel Tata tabled a proposal from the Shapoorji Pallonji Group (SP group) regarding the monetization of a portion of the Tata Sons shareholding held by Sterling Investments Corporation Pvt Ltd (SICPL) and Cyrus Investments Pvt Ltd

(CIPL) at the board meeting on Thursday.

The transaction envisages a sale of such number of Tata Sons shares held by SICPL and CIPL as would, at a minimum valuation, as determined in accordance with Rule 11UA of the Income Tax Rules 1962, yield a gross consideration of Rs 25,000 crore. SP group holds 18.37% stake in Tata Sons.

"It was also indicated that the following structure would be acceptable to the SP Group. The share buyout would be carried out in two tranches over an 18-month period. Tata Sons would initiate a selective capital reduction process through the NCLT and valuation of Tata shares would be done as per Income-tax fair value," Tata Trusts said.

GST of 18% on UPI MDR can be claimed as input tax credit: Source

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, September 17

WHILE A Goods and Services Tax (GST) of 18% will apply on the Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on UPI transactions of more than Rs 2,000, businesses registered under the indirect tax regime can claim the same as input tax credit, a senior finance ministry official said on Thursday.

The official, though, admitted that unregistered sellers who have an annual turnover of less than Rs 40 lakh but receive more than Rs 1 lakh every month as UPI payments — and therefore don't qualify as 'small merchants' exempt from MDR — may end up paying GST on payments of more than Rs 2,000.

However, the official argued this would be a very small

number of merchants and the matter can be "reasonably tackled by the GST Council".

The Ministry of Finance's Department of Revenue did not respond to a request asking for comment. GST comes under the revenue department.

The MDR on UPI payments of more than Rs 2,000 comes into effect from October 15. The GST Council is set to meet on October 7. The official did not say whether the matter will be discussed at the upcoming meeting.

As per the revised MDR framework announced earlier this week by the National Payments Corporation of India, a merchant facing an MDR of 0.4% on a UPI payment of Rs 10,000 will have to first pay a fee of Rs 40 and GST of Rs 7.2 on that Rs 40. For those where the

MDR is a flat Rs 5, the GST will be 90 paise.

According to the aforementioned official, the majority of those who are under the GST registration threshold of Rs 40 lakh won't have to pay MDR — and therefore, any GST on top of that — for multiple reasons. One, they may be receiving less than Rs 1 lakh per month as UPI payments. Two, they may not be receiving any payments via UPI which are for more than Rs 2,000, threshold above which an MDR is applicable.

"96% of P2M UPI transactions are under Rs 2,000. For small merchants with a turnover of below Rs 40 lakh, 99% of their UPI payments may be smaller than Rs 2,000," the official said.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

After US Fed and others, will RBI also raise interest rates in Oct?

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, September 17

A NEW Chairman at the helm of the US Federal Reserve was supposed to push forward President Donald Trump's agenda to lower interest rates in the world's largest economy. However, economic realities and responsibilities are not so easily ignored.

On Wednesday, the US central bank's rate-setting panel, the Federal Open Market Committee (FOMC), increased the federal funds rate target range by 25 basis points (bps) to 3.75-4%.

This was the Fed's first rate-hike in three years.

One basis point is a hundredth of a percentage point.

Strikingly, all 12 FOMC members voted to increase the key interest rate, including new Fed Chair Kevin Warsh, who was appointed by Trump after the end of Jerome Powell's term earlier this year.

The White House was not particularly happy with the decision. A spokesman called it "rather unfortunate" and not backed by a "particularly compelling economic case" from the point of view of the Trump administration. The Fed, though, thinks US economic activity is expanding at a "solid" pace.

"While uncertainty remains elevated owing, in part, to geopolitical developments, domestic spending has been resilient. Productivity growth is strong, and capital investment is robust. Job gains have kept pace with the workforce, and the unemployment rate has changed little," the FOMC said in its statement. It added that "inflation remains elevated" and its decision

to increase rates will support a "timelier return" to the 2% inflation target.

"The Committee will deliver price stability," it concluded, sounding a lot like the Reserve Bank of India.

Rate hikes globally

The Fed wasn't the only central bank to raise interest rates on Wednesday: central banks in UAE and Bahrain both raised their main interest rates by 25 bps to 3.9% and 4.5%, respectively, mirroring the decision in the US.

And while the Bank of England left its policy rate unchanged at 3.75% on Thursday, the Bank of Japan on Friday is widely seen raising interest rates to 1.25% — the highest in 31 years.

"The risks to Japanese inflation are skewed to the upside," ANZ economists said in a note last week. "There is no resolution in sight to the conflict in the Middle East or indication of when traffic through the Strait of Hormuz will normalise. The JPY (yen) remains weak, which is contributing to higher import price pressures; and strong AI demand could add to goods and services prices," they further said, adding that with wage growth high and growth above the its potential, there is a greater risk than before of elevated oil and import prices being passed on to domestic inflation.

Let it be forgotten, the European Central Bank last week raised interest rates by 25 bps, noting that the upward price pressures caused by the West Asia conflict are set to keep inflation "well above target for an extended period".

India's inflation headache

The RBI's Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) is scheduled to meet October 5-7 and it is increasingly expected to announce a 25-bps rate hike of its own. This would be the first rate hike by the RBI in three-and-a-half years and take the repo rate to 5.5%.

Like the rest of the world, India has its own inflation troubles. In August, all measures of inflation — for households, wholesalers, and producers — increased. The RBI's main indicator of price levels, the Consumer Price Index (CPI), rose 4.82% in August, marking the third straight month it had come in above target.

The RBI is mandated to target CPI inflation of 4% within a tolerance band of 2-6%. While CPI inflation is within this range, some economists see it jumping to 5.7% in September. The central bank expects CPI inflation to average 4.7% in July-September, 5.9% in October-December, 5.5% in January-March 2027, and 5.3% in April-June 2027.

According to Soumya Kanti Ghosh, State Bank of India's Group Chief Economic Adviser, the process of generalisation of price pressures has started — something the MPC said in August there were "little signs of".

"Going forward, we believe CPI inflation may cross 6.5% mark before dropping to less than 6% in early 2027. (It is) Time to build moats through a 25-bps hike in October and December MPC (meetings) each, and then to pause and take stock with upcoming data," Ghosh said.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

● MARKETS

			
Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▲	US Dollar ▼
74,314.59	23,270.60	₹1,51,849	₹95.93
-21.86	53.00		
-0.03%	0.23%	Silver ▼	Oil ▼
		₹2,29,642	\$126.88

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA
GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1G; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF SEPTEMBER 16, 2026

SALE NOTICE
(Pursuant to the Order Dated 13.08.2026 of Hon'ble NCLT, Chennai Bench)
HALLMARK LIVING SPACE PRIVATE LIMITED (In Liquidation)
(CIN: U45400TN2012PTC084362)
Regd office: Suite A, No-43, Old No.62/2, United Plaza, Usman Road, T. Nagar, Chennai - 600 017.
Site: 'Emerald' Chettipunniam, GST Road, Opp. To Mahindra World City (Next to RTO office) Chengalpattu - 603002

E-AUCTION UNDER THE INSOLVENCY AND BANKRUPTCY CODE, 2016
Invitation of Bids in respect of sale of the property given below of M/s Hallmark Living Space Private Limited (in Liquidation) ("Corporate Debtor") under Regulation 32 of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India (Liquidation Process) Regulations, 2016 pursuant to the order of the Hon'ble NCLT, Chennai Bench dated 13.08.2026 on "As is where is basis, As is what is basis, Whatever there is basis and Without any recourse basis" by the Liquidator, appointed by the Hon'ble National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT), Chennai Bench, vide its Order Dated 17.08.2018. Interested persons shall refer to and understand the complete E-AUCTION PROCESS INFORMATION DOCUMENT containing details of Terms and Conditions of E-Auction, E-Auction bid form, Eligibility criteria, Declaration by bidders, Earnest money deposit etc., details of which are available at Corporate Debtor's Website www.hallmarklivingspace.co.in and service provider's website. The prospective bidders shall submit an undertaking stating that they do not suffer from any ineligibility under section 29A of the Code to the extent applicable and that if found ineligible at any stage the earnest money deposited shall be forfeited. Prospective bidders shall deposit the Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) in the Banknet auction platform. The E-Auction Sale will be conducted strictly subject to said E-Auction process information document through the E-Auction platform <https://bbi.baanknet.com/e/auction-ibbi/home>. The applicable GST and other taxes / duties will be extra.

Property	Inspection Date	Date and Time of e-Auction	Reserve Price (INR)	EMD Amount & Due Date (INR)	Bid Increase Amount
Proposed Building Area of 8.98.137 Sq.ft not fully Built-up and Land 7.62 acres (excluding 6388 sq. ft. UDS) situated at "EMERALD" Chettipunniam, GST Road, Opp. To Mahindra World City (Next to RTO Office) Chengalpattu - 603002.	Between 19/09/2026 to 12/10/2026 Timing : 11:00 AM to 5:00 PM	15/10/2026 Between 03:00 PM to 05:00 PM	Rs. 70.50 Crores (Rupees Seventy Crores and Fifty Lakhs Only)	Rs. 7.00 Crores (Rupees Seven Crores Only) Due Date : 12/10/2026 till 6.00 p.m.	Rs. 25.00 Lakhs (Rupees Twenty Five Lakhs only)

Sale notice shall be read in conjunction with the E-Auction Process Information Document. For E-Auction details, contact Email : support.baanknet@psbfinance.com, Toll Free No. : +91 8291222020. You may also contact the undersigned or email at csdhanapal.ibr@gmail.com for further details about the sale. If any modification in time lines and / or in the E-Auction Process Information Document including terms and conditions, it will be notified in the website of the Corporate Debtor i.e. www.hallmarklivingspace.co.in and baanknet.com
S. Dhanapal,
Date : 18.09.2026 Liquidator for Hallmark Living Space Pvt Ltd (in Liquidation)
Place : Chennai IBBI Regn No: IBBI/PA-002/IP-N00060/ 2017-18/10112
Suite No.103, First Floor, Kaveri Complex, 96/104, Nungambakkam High Road, Nungambakkam, Chennai – 600 034 Tel.No:044-45530256/0257. Email ID - csdhanapal.ibr@gmail.com

NPCL
Noida Power Company Limited
Electric Sub Station, Knowledge Park-IV, Greater Noida-201310
(CIN: U31200UP1992PLC014506)

TENDER NOTICE Date: 18-09-2026

e-Bids (Technical & Commercial) are invited from the prospective Bidders for;

NIT No.	Tender Description	EMD (Rs.)	Start and Due Date & Time of Submission
NPCL/FY25-26/021.	Hiring of agency for the upgradation of SAP S4HANA version from 2020 to 2025 – On-premise.	1.00 Lac	Start Date: 18-09-2026 Due Date: 03-10-2026
NPCL/FY25-26/023.	Hiring of agency for GIS System upgrade for NPCL.	1.00 Lac	Start Date: 18-09-2026 Due Date: 03-10-2026

Cost of Individual Tender Document (Incl. GST) Rs 1180/-.
For other tender details and further amendment/corrigendum, please visit our website: www.noidapower.com --> Procurement --> Tenders

HEAD CMM

UBI: Mohan R Prabhu, respected ACVO, Union Bank of India, visited Muzaffarnagar on the subject of "Probity for Prosperity" under Vigilance Awareness. Addressing the gathering, he advised all employees to discharge their duties with honesty, integrity and goodwill. He further emphasised every decision should be taken keeping in mind the larger interest of the customer, the bank and the society. Therefore, he urged all colleagues to give topmost priority to honesty, transparency and high ethical values in all our work.



BOI recently celebrated its 121st Foundation Day with great enthusiasm and fervor. The occasion was graced by the presence of Mr. Chetan Chandra, Regional Manager, BOI, Dehradun, and Mr. Bhanu Pratap Singh Nabiyal, Deputy Regional Manager. The ceremony was attended by staff members, retired employees, and representatives of third-party insurance companies at the Research, Development & Training Institute, Dehradun. On this occasion, Regional Manager Mr. Chetan Chandra extended warm greetings to all staff members on Foundation Day and praised their dedication and commitment to the Bank. The Foundation Day celebration concluded with a colorful cultural program presented by staff members.

REC has achieved a landmark milestone in India's capital markets with the country's first pilot issue of tokenised corporate bonds under SEBI's Regulatory Sandbox Framework. The Rs.500-crore issue, comprising a Rs.100-crore base issue and Rs.400-crore green shoe option, was bid through NSE's EBP platform. It received an overwhelming response, attracting bids worth Rs.796 crore, nearly eight times the issue size. REC accepted Rs.500 crore at a 7.30% annual coupon for a tenor of one year and nine months. The tokenised issuance enabled same-day pay-in, allotment and listing on NSE and BSE, demonstrating the potential of technology-led market innovation, faster settlement, atomic Delivery-versus-Payment (DVP) and shared-ledger transparency.

SRM UNIVERSITY celebrated Teacher's Day 2026 by honouring faculty members for their contributions to teaching, research and institutional growth. Chief Guest Prof G P Raja Sekhar, Vice Chancellor, Andhra University, Visakhapatnam joined Prof CH Satish Kumar, Vice Chancellor, SRM University-AP, and other university leadership for the ceremony. Addresses highlighted Dr S Radhakrishnan's enduring respect for teachers, the relevance of his philosophy to the National Education Policy and National Credit Framework, and the importance of teamwork, adaptability and innovation. Nine faculty members received the University Outstanding Faculty Awards 2026 for excellence across research, teaching, and institutional development.

HURL has been recognised among the "Top Organisations with Innovative HR Practices" at the 25th Asia Pacific HRM Congress Awards in Bengaluru. The honour acknowledges HURL's efforts to foster progressive people practices, workplace innovation and employee empowerment while building a future-ready workforce. The organisation continues to promote an inclusive and enabling work environment where employees grow, ideas flourish, and excellence is encouraged. Through employee-centric initiatives, HURL strengthens a culture of learning, collaboration, and continuous improvement, reinforcing its commitment to organisational excellence and sustainable growth.

OICL celebrated its 80th Foundation Day at NBCC Convention Centre, New Delhi, marking eight decades of insurance service. The company has grown from a Rs.99,950 premium base in 1947 to business exceeding Rs.21,000 crore in FY 2025-26. Key launches included Oriental DigiBiz, enabling direct online insurance purchases, and a digital Motor Own Damage claims journey. New customer-focused products were also introduced. Nationwide celebrations featured insurance awareness camps, helmet distribution drives, and the planting of 5,414 saplings under the "Ek Employee Ek Ped" campaign.

MAGIC BILLION has signed an MoU with the Government of Madhya Pradesh to create structured international career pathways for skilled and trainable youth. Anchored at Sant Shiromani Ravidas Global Skills Park, Bhopal, the partnership will connect candidates with opportunities in Germany and other European markets across technical trades, manufacturing, engineering and vocational pathways. The programme will cover skill and language preparation, assessment, employer linkage, documentation, visa support, deployment and post-placement assistance. Magic Billion will leverage its global employer network, while the state will support talent mobilisation and coordination with skill-development institutions.

CORPORATE BRIEFS



MOHUA: Union Minister Manohar Lal Chaired a meeting with State Urban Development Ministers and officials to review preparedness for Swachhata Hi Seva 2026, running 17 September–17 October under the theme 'Swachhata Mein Sahbhag, Swachh Bharat, Viksit Bharat.' Focus areas include Cleanliness Target Units, SafaiMitra welfare shivirs, Jan Bhagidari, and Waste-to-Wealth initiatives. He urged citizens to clean homes on 17 September and light a diya symbolizing commitment. The emphasis was laid on 25 September (Deendayal Upadhyaya's birthday) for inclusive drives, 1 October for nationwide Shramdaan, 2 October (Swachh Bharat Diwas) for special drives and tree plantation, and 7 October marking the PM's 25 years of public service.

RECPDCL handed over Musalgaon Power Transmission Limited SPV to Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Company Limited on 9 September 2026. MSETCL won the project through RECPDCL's Tariff-Based Competitive Bidding process for a BOOT-basis intra-state transmission project. The handover occurred between Ratnesw Kumar (RECPDCL) and Amit R. Naik (MSETCL), with senior officials present. The project involves a 220/132/33 kV substation at Musalgaon, a ~111 km 220 kV double-circuit line to Bahaleswar and Raymond, and a ~13 km 132 kV line to Sinner. It carries a 12-month timeline and an estimated cost of Rs. 560 crores.

NHB: India's residential real estate market continued to witness price appreciation in the April–June 2026 quarter, with all seven key primary markets recording annual growth, according to the National Housing Bank's Housing Price Index. Bengaluru led the major cities with a 21.5% rise, followed by Chennai at 10.8%, Ahmedabad at 7.9%, Kolkata at 6.9%, Mumbai at 6.2%, Hyderabad at 5.2% and Pune at 3.7%. Across the 50-city index, assessment prices increased 2.7% sequentially during Q1 FY27. Faridabad recorded the highest annual growth at 24.4%, while Kalyan Dombivali declined 1.7%. Bengaluru and Faridabad also posted strong quarterly gains of 7.2% and 7.1%, respectively.

BOB has launched bob World 2.0, its next-generation, AI-powered mobile banking application, unveiled at Global Fintech Fest 2026 in Mumbai. Built on a modern microservices-based architecture, the app offers a smarter, personalised, conversational, and secure banking experience, laying the foundation for an integrated omnichannel ecosystem. Key features include voice-enabled payments and navigation, Personal Financial Management, hyper-personalised services for customer segments such as women, senior citizens, NRIs and millennials, and multi-layered security with real-time protection. The platform marks a significant step in Bank of Baroda's digital transformation journey.

BHEL has been conferred the prestigious 'Rajbhasha Keerti Puraskar' by the Rajbhasha Vibhag, Ministry of Home Affairs, for excellence in Official Language implementation. The company secured the Second Prize among Public Sector Enterprises in the 'A Region' category. Tajinder Gupta, Director (Power) and Additional Charge, Human Resources, BHEL, received the award from the Minister of State for Home Affairs, Bandi Sanjay Kumar, on September 14, 2026, during Hindi Diwas celebrations and the 6th All India Rajbhasha Conference in Navi Mumbai. BHEL had also received the Keerti Puraskar in 2023–24 and 2024–25.

CCIC: Akhilesh Kumar, DDG (Textiles), Ministry of Textiles, and Chairman, CCIC, along with Bimal Gopalachari, Managing Director, CCIC, inaugurated the 'Exhibition-cum-Sale' of Designer's Atelier on September 12, 2026, at Central Cottage Industries Emporium, Janpath, New Delhi. The showcase promotes India's rich textile heritage and authentic handloom and handwoven products, while giving artisans and weavers a wider platform to connect with consumers. Bringing together traditional techniques, indigenous craftsmanship, and contemporary design, the exhibition features intricate weaves, traditional prints, modern silhouettes, and designer collections, celebrating India's diverse textile traditions.



GNN has intensified efforts to improve air quality, helping the city rise to 9th place nationally in the Clean Air Survey 2026, from 18th in 2024 & 12th in 2025. Under Municipal Commissioner Vikramaditya Singh Malik, various departments are working collectively to curb dust & pollution. Fifteen anti-smog guns, 32 water sprinklers & 12 road-sweeping machines support dust-control measures, while interlocking & paving have been completed across more than 49 km of dust-prone areas. The Horticulture Department is also expanding the city's green cover. Over 1.44 lakh trees were planted in 2024 & more than 1.5 lakh in 2025. In 2026, around seven lakh trees are being planted under Upan Yojana & other initiatives, strengthening Ghaziabad's environmental resilience.

IRCTC has undertaken significant upgrades to strengthen its online rail ticketing system, with 89% of reserved tickets now booked online. On September 7, 2026, it recorded a historic single-day high of 20,06,353 tickets, followed by 19,50,699 bookings the next day. The upgraded NGeT system, new UI, enhanced server capacity, CDN, and Anti-BOT measures have improved performance and security. Anti-BOT technology has reduced malicious traffic by 55–65%. Aadhaar authentication, restrictions on agents during the opening window, and action against suspicious accounts further promote secure, equitable bookings. Despite heavy demand, NGeT has reported no outages.

CRB: Railway Board Chairman and CEO Satish Kumar visited DFCIL's Corporate Office at Sector-145, New Delhi, on Saturday, reviewing technical, operational & safety arrangements. He inaugurated the War Room and directed officials to develop a dedicated dashboard for 24-hour monitoring of freight trains and prompt rectification of deficiencies. Emphasising technology and innovation, he called for collaboration with RDSO, AI-based employee training and exploration of new technologies. He also inaugurated an Electronic Interlocking Training Setup at the Heavy Haul Institute, aimed at strengthening technical skills, operational safety, and efficiency.

SUBHARTI UNIVERSITY celebrated its 18th Foundation Day with a focus on education, culture, service and nationalism. The ceremony began with a Sanatan prayer and lamp lighting before Bharat Mata's portrait, while guests were presented with saplings promoting environmental responsibility. Students and faculty members who brought national and international recognition to the university were felicitated across categories for academic excellence, social service, innovation and outstanding contributions. Chancellor Dr. Stuti Narayan Kakkar said the occasion was an opportunity to assess achievements & chart the institution's future direction, emphasising values, service, culture and social responsibility. Founder Dr. Atul Krishna recalled the university's journey and remembered co-founder late Sangh Mata Dr. Mukti Bhatnagar. Chief guest and first Vice-Chancellor Prof. (Dr.) V.P. Sahay also shared his memories and encouraged youth to pursue diligence, discipline and determination.

SC DAV SCHOOL organised a career guidance session on "Company Secretary as a Career" for Classes XI and XII in collaboration with the Institute of Company Secretaries of India (ICSI). Resource person Mr. Pradeep Joshi, Company Secretary, provided insights into the profession, eligibility criteria, career opportunities, and the pathway to becoming a Company Secretary. The interactive session helped students understand the scope and significance of the profession, enabling them to make informed career choices.

VELOCITY VINFAST, authorised dealer partner of VinFast, has opened an 11,500 sq. ft. EV showroom in Sector 63, Noida. Inaugurated by Tapan Kumar Ghosh, CEO, VinFast Asia, the facility offers integrated 3S services covering sales, service and spares, alongside consultations and test drives. It showcases the VF 6, VF 7, VF MPV 7 and Limo Green. The VF 6 starts at Rs. 18.19 lakh, while the VF 7 starts at Rs. 22.99 lakh. Customers can also access charging, maintenance, warranty and assured buyback benefits.

FIMS HOSPITAL is a premier 250-bed Multi Super Specialty Hospital serving Sonipat and the National Capital Region (NCR), with a focus on clinical excellence, innovation and compassionate care. Equipped with advanced medical technology and ultra-modern diagnostic facilities, the hospital offers accurate diagnosis and evidence-based treatment. Its facilities include MRI, CT Scan, Digital X-Ray, Ultrasound, cath lab, neuro lab, Neuro Lab, Interventional Radiology and comprehensive pathology services. Modern modular operation theatres with advanced infection-control systems support safe surgical outcomes. Under Chairman R.P. Jain's leadership, FIMS provides comprehensive care across 26+ specialties, including Cardiology, Neurology, Oncology, Gastroenterology, Orthopedics, Knee and Joint Replacement, Nephrology, Urology, Critical Care and more. Experienced multidisciplinary teams develop personalised treatment plans, combining expertise and technology to deliver quality healthcare and improved clinical outcomes.

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE
Invitation of tender through
E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

The Divisional Engineer-IV, Northern Railway, Delhi Division for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tender on prescribed form for the following work.

1	Name of work with its location	1. Left over Work & Deficiencies in Railway Qtrs. on PPDE-SNP Branch line under ADEN/Jind. (NIT 42/26-27-W-IV)
2	Approx. cost of work.	(1) Rs. 2,34,37,384.29
3	Earnest money	(1) Rs 4,68,800.00
4	Date and Time of submission of tender and opening of tender	Bidding Start date for work no. Up to 15:00 hrs. On 25.09.2026 opening of e-Tender at 15:00 hrs. on 09.10.2026
5	Website particulars, published e-tender, notice location etc. complete details of tender can be seen and web site where the tender form can be downloaded	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in

No. 128-W/260/Tender Notice/ 42/26-27-W-IV Date: 17.09.2026 3230/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
(See Section 82 Cr. PC)
84-Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Ankit Joshi S/o Vijay Ram Joshi R/o H.No. G-936, Devii High School Sangam Vihar, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 119/2019 U/s 323/354/506/34 IPC & 8/12 Pocco Act at P.S. Tigr, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ankit Joshi** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ankit Joshi** have absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Ankit Joshi** of **FIR No. 119/2019 U/s 323/354/506/34 IPC & 8/12 Pocco Act at P.S. Tigr, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.10.2026**

By order
Anuj Kumar Singh ASJ (FTSC) (POCSO)
Saket Court South District, New Delhi

DP/12246/SD/2026

महाराष्ट्र शासन, गृह विभाग (बंदरे व परिवहन)
महाराष्ट्र सागरी मंडळ
सागरी अभियंता व चीफ सर्वेअर
इंडियन मर्कटाइल सर्विस, तिसरा मजला, रामजीभाई कपानी मार्ग, बेलाई पिंजर, मुंबई-४०० ००९.
दूरध्वनी क्र.: ०२२-२६२९११२४, फॅक्स क्र.: ०२२-२६२९११२४
Web site : <https://mahammb.maharashtra.gov.in> Email : mecs.mumbai@mm.maharashtra.gov.in

E-Tender Notice - (Year 2026-2027)
Main Portal : <https://mahatenders.gov.in>
Department Portal : www.mahammb.maharashtra.gov.in

DIGITALLY signed E-Tender for the work "Lease of MMB owned 02 nos. Cutter Suction Dredgers for 03 years further extendable by 02 more years (Bareboat Charter)" invited by Maharashtra Maritime Board, Mumbai.

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Earnest Money Deposit (Rs.)	Blank Tender Form Amount (Rs.)
1.	Lease of MMB owned 02 nos. Cutter Suction Dredgers for 03 years further extendable by 02 more years (Bareboat Charter).	1,26,000/-	1,180/-

The details can be viewed online and downloaded from the Government of Maharashtra E-Tendering Portal <https://mahatenders.gov.in> from **18.09.2026 at 1100 hours (IST)** onwards. The right to reject any of all tenders without assigning any reason is reserved with undersigned.

Sd/-
Marine Engineer & Chief Surveyor
Maharashtra Maritime Board, Mumbai

DGIPR-2026-27/2873

कार्यालय अधिशाषी अभियन्ता सानिवि जिला खण्ड प्रथम बीकानेर
क्रमांक : 1337 दिनांक : 10/09/26

Notice Inviting Bid – : 05 / 2026-27

Bids for the Construction of Various Non-patchable (Renewal) / Missing link road of Sub Dn Bikaner, Khajjuwala, Dantore & Pugal for the year 2026-27 & Various Deposit works [CM Thar Yojana, MP & MLA LA] are invited from interested bidders upto 16.09.2026 [09:30 AM] to 22.09.2026 [06:00 PM] & Open date 23.09.2026 [11:00 AM], other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal <http://www.pwd.rajasthan.gov.in> and <http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in> of the state and departmental website. The approximate value of the procurement is Rs. 477.58 Lakh.

UBN No.	1. PWD2627WSOB11860	2. PWD 2627WSOB11859
	2. PWD2627WSOB11861	4. PWD 2627WSOB11862
	5. PIAD2627WSOB11863	6. PWD 2627WSOB11864
	7. PWD2627WSOB11865	

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
PWD Distt. Dn-I, Bikaner

DIPR/C/15941/2026

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता
जन स्वास्थ्य अभियांत्रिकी विभाग, वृत्त शुद्धन
ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या 07/2026-27 सं 08/2026-2027

निविदा की कुल लागत (रुपए लाखों में)	500.00 लाख (कुल 2 कार्य, सबसे बड़े कार्य की लागत 300.00 लाख)
कुल प्योर राशि	अनुमानित लागत का 2 प्रतिशत /0.5 प्रतिशत
निविदा दाखल करने की अंतिम तिथि	दिनांक 07.10.2026 सायं 6.00 बजे तक
निविदा अनलाइन करने की अंतिम तिथि	दिनांक 07.10.2026 सायं 6.00 बजे तक
ई ग्राम निवृत्ति के सम्बन्ध में उठाया जाने वाला अग्रलेख करने की अंतिम तिथि	दिनांक 07.10.2026 सायं 6.00 बजे तक
निविदा तकनीकी बिड खोलने की तारीख एवं समय	दिनांक 08.10.2026 प्रातः 11.00 बजे से

निविदा से संबंधित अन्य आवश्यक विवरण डीआरडीआर की वेबसाइट www.dipr.rajasthan.gov.in, sppp एवं वेबसाइट <http://WWW.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> पर देखे जा सकते हैं।

UBN. NO, NIT No. 7/2026-27-PHE 2627 WSRCO 5360
MIT No 8/2026-27-PHE 2627 WSRCO 5361

(राजपाल सिंह)
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता
जन स्वास्थ्य अभियांत्रिकी विभाग
वृत्त शुद्धन

DIPR/C/16045/2026

क्षेत्रीय कार्यालय,
उ०प्र० प्रदूषण नियंत्रण बोर्ड, सहारनपुर।
33/18, कपिल विहार, निकट विष्णुकर्मा चौक, सहारनपुर 247001, उ०प्र०

खनन पट्टा इकाई M/s RDB MINES. Partner-Rajdeep Bhatia. H.No. 24, Gate No. 01, Raj Vihar Colony, Paper Mill Road, Saharanpur द्वारा गेटा नं०- 01 (टोटल लीज एरिया- 13.0 हेक्टेयर), ग्राम-शाहजादपुर बांस अहममल, तहसील-बेहट, जनपद-सहारनपुर उ.प्र.पर, सैण्ड / बजरी / बोल्टर (आर०बी०एम०) हेतु खनन कार्य किया जाना प्रस्तावित है। उक्त योजना में जनपद-सहारनपुर क्षेत्र की तहसील बेहट के अन्तर्गत गेटा नं०- 01 (टोटल लीज एरिया-13.0 हेक्टेयर), ग्राम-शाहजादपुर बांस अहममल, तहसील-बेहट, जनपद-सहारनपुर उ.प्र.पर, सैण्ड/बजरी/बोल्टर (आर०बी०एम०) का खनन कार्य किया जाना प्रस्तावित है।

खनन पट्टा इकाई M/s RDB MINES. Partner-Rajdeep Bhatia. H.No. 24, Gate No. 01, Raj Vihar Colony, Paper Mill Road, Saharanpur द्वारा गेटा नं०- 01 (टोटल लीज एरिया- 13.0 हेक्टेयर), ग्राम-शाहजादपुर बांस अहममल, तहसील-बेहट, जनपद-सहारनपुर उ.प्र.पर, सैण्ड/बजरी/बोल्टर (आर०बी०एम०) हेतु प्राधिकरण द्वारा पर्यावरण, वन एवं जलवायु परिवर्तन मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार द्वारा जारी ई०आई०ए० अधिसूचना 2006 के अन्तर्गत पर्यावरणीय स्वीकृति प्राप्त किये जाने हेतु लोक सुनवाई के सम्बन्ध में उ०प्र० प्रदूषण नियंत्रण बोर्ड के समक्ष आवेदन प्रस्तुत किया गया है। राज्य बोर्ड द्वारा भारत सरकार के पर्यावरण, वन एवं जलवायु परिवर्तन मंत्रालय द्वारा निर्गत अधिसूचना सं० एस०ओ०-1533, दिनांक-14.09.2006 के अन्तर्गत उक्त परियोजना क्रियान्वयन इकाई द्वारा स्वतः गेटा नं०- 01 (टोटल लीज एरिया- 13.0 हेक्टेयर), ग्राम-शाहजादपुर बांस अहममल, तहसील-बेहट, जनपद-सहारनपुर उ.प्र.पर, सैण्ड/बजरी/बोल्टर (आर०बी०एम०) का खनन कार्य किये जाने हेतु पर्यावरणीय स्वीकृति जारी करने से पूर्व लोक सुनवाई की सुचना जारी किया जाना आवश्यक है एवं इस सुनवाई के अन्तर्गत क्षेत्रीय आम जनता को किसी भी आपत्ति / सुझाव हेतु 30 दिन का नोटिस दिया जाना आवश्यक है। लोक सुनवाई पैनल की संरचना पर्यावरणीय अधिसूचना सं० एस०ओ०-1533 दिनांक-14.09.2006 के अनुसूचि होंगी एवं प्रस्ताव से संबंधित सक्षम अभिलेख निम्न कार्यालयों में उपलब्ध हैं:-

- कार्यालय जिलाधिकारी, सहारनपुर।
- क्षेत्रीय कार्यालय, मध्य क्षेत्र वन एवं पर्यावरण मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार, पंचम तल, केन्द्रीय भवन सेक्टर-एच, अलीनगर, लखनऊ।
- उ०प्र० प्रदूषण नियंत्रण बोर्ड, टोपसी-12वीं, विभूति खाड़, गोमती नगर, लखनऊ।
- कार्यालय उपजिलाधिकारी बेहट, सहारनपुर।
- क्षेत्रीय कार्यालय, उ०प्र० प्रदूषण नियंत्रण बोर्ड, 33/18 कपिल विहार, सहारनपुर।

अतः समस्त सर्वसाधारण को इस नोटिस के माध्यम से सूचित किया जाता है कि उक्त परियोजना व पर्यावरणीय स्वीकृति के सम्बन्ध में लोक सुनवाई अपर जिलाधिकारी (विचार/राज्य) महोदय, सहारनपुर की अध्यक्षता में दिनांक-22.10.2026 को दोपहर 02:00 बजे से, तहसील बेहट सभागार, सहारनपुर पर की जानी है, जिसमें समस्त सर्वसाधारण उपस्थित होकर अपनी आपत्तियाँ प्रस्तुत कर सकते हैं, अथवा सुझाव, विचार, टीका टिप्पणीयाँ लिखित रूप में प्रकाशन की तिथि से 30 दिन के अन्दर उक्त उल्लेखित कार्यालयों में प्रस्तुत / प्रेषित कर सकते हैं।

क्षेत्रीय अधिकारी

UJVN Ltd.
(An Uttarakhnad Govt. Enterprises)
H.O. "UJJWAL" Maharani Bagh, GMS Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone-0135-2763808 Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvn.in

RO No. 822 e-TENDER NOTICE Date: 16.09.2026

Office of Executive Engineer (I&P-I), "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, GMS Road, Dehradun, invites online bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:

Tender No. 02/UJVNL/EE(I&P-I)/2026-27
Name of Work:- Providing services for obtaining Terms of Reference (ToR) & carrying out Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) studies, preparation of detailed & comprehensive Environment Management Plan (EMP) & obtaining Environmental Clearance from MoEFCC, New Delhi for Sela Urthing Hydro Electric Project-114 MW in district Pithoragarh.

Estimated cost :- Rs 30,90,000 (applicable GST Extra)

Date of availability of bid document on website: 21.09.2026 at 11:00 Hrs
Last date for submission of bids on website: 14.10.2026 up to 17:00 Hrs

For fuller & further details, kindly visit "e-procurement portal <http://uktenders.gov.in>"

Executive Engineer (I&P-I)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Geeta W/o Vijay Pal Singh R/o H. No. 5, Khasra No. 20/12, Naveen Vihar, Begum Pur Extn., Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 371/2022 U/S 33 Delhi Excise Act, PS Begum Pur, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Geeta** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Geeta** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Geeta** of **FIR No. 371/2022 U/S 33 Delhi Excise Act, PS Begum Pur, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **19.10.2026**.

By Order,
Ms. Anuradha Jindal
Add. Chief Judicial Magistrate
North-West Court No. 101, First Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/13194/RD/2026(Court Matter)

GOVERNMENT OF RAJASTHAN
OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
Watershed Development and Soil Conservation JODHPUR
(Near RTO Office, BJS Colony Jodhpur-342006)
क्रमांक:- WDS/Jodhpur/Tender/MJSA2.2/2026-27/24493677 दिनांक :- 11-09-2026

NOTICE INVITING BID
NIB No. - JODHPUR/04/2026-27

Bids for Execution of following Watershed Development Works under MJSA 2.2 Scheme of estimated cost as mentioned above are invited from interested bidders up to 24.09.2026, 02.00 PM. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> or <https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in>) of the state, and www.watershed.rajasthan.gov.in departmental website.

Bid No.	Block	Name of Work	Estimated Cost, Rs.in lakhs	UBN No.
MJSA-2.2/ BIL/04/01	Bilada	Construction of various WHS under MJSA 2.2 in Block- Bilada	194.94	WSC2627 WSOB02304
MJSA-2.2/ BAL/04/02	Balsar	Construction of various WHS under MJSA 2.2 in Block- Balsar	124.06	WSC2627 WSOB02309
MJSA-2.2/ CHA/04/03	Chamu	Construction of various WHS under MJSA 2.2 in Block- Chamu	126.90	WSC2627 WSOB02310

(Ghanshyam Singh Rathore)
Superintending Engineer
Watershed Development & Soil Conservation
Jodhpur

DIPR/C/15998/2026

Telangana Tourism Development Corporation Ltd
"Tourism House" # 3-5-891, Himayyannagar, Hyderabad-500029
e-Procurement Tender Notice No. TGTC/PRJ/12/08/2026-27/S&L Show/ Godavari Pushkaralu, Dated: 17.09.2026

Sl. No.	Name of the work	Bid Downloading Start Date
1	2	3
1	Expression of Interest (EOI) for Development of Sound & Light (Multimedia) show at Basar/Kaleshwaram, Telangana for Godavari Pushkaralu - 2027	23.09.2026
2	Supply of Boats, Jetties, Life Jackets, Life Buoy, Life Guarded Rescue tube, Magic Floating Jetties for Godavari Pushkaralu - 2027	23.09.2026
3	Development of Riverfront 5 Star Resort at Buddhavanam, Nagarjunasagar on BOT basis under PPP mode	24.09.2026
4	Development of Budget Hotel cum Wayside Amenity at Buddhavanam, Nagarjunasagar on BOT basis under PPP mode	24.09.2026

Bids are invited on e-Procurement platform from eligible contractors. Further details can be seen @ e-procurement market place www.tender.telangana.gov.in

Sd/-MANAGING DIRECTOR
TGDC, Hyderabad

DIPR R.O.No.547-PP/CL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27 Dt:17-09-2026

The Brihanmumbai Electric Supply & Transport Undertaking
(OF THE BRIHANMUMBAI MAHANAGARPALIKA)

TENDER NOTICE
E-tenders are Re-invited for the supply of following item.
(1) 82023 - Request For Proposal (RFP) for Operation of Stage Carriage Services (With Driver and Conductor) for Public Transport of 200 Midi CNG Non-AC Buses in the City of Mumbai & Its Extended Suburbs on Gross Cost Contract (GCC) Model, (2) 82156 – Triennial cont. for Xeroxing of U/T Documents.

Note: For more details, log on to website <https://mahatenders.gov.in>

PRO/AAM(M)/67/2026 GENERAL MANAGER

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS KATHUA
E- mail: sspkathua@jkpolice.gov.in
Fax/Phone No.: 01922-234010

LOOK OUT NOTICE

On 01-09-2026, one person namely Anchal Singh S/O Saran Das P/O Marhoon Tehsil Billawar District Kathua lodged a written report at PS Malhar stating therein that on 30-08-2026 his wife namely Sushma Devi, age 23 years left the home in the morning hours without informing anyone in the family and did not return back home till date. The complainant made best efforts to search her wife but all in vain. On this, missing report vide DD No. 03 dated 01-09-2026 has been entered at Police Station Lohai Malhar.

During the course of investigation, best efforts were made to locate missing individual, whereas she is still un-traced.

As such Description Roll/Photograph of said missing individual is being shared with the appeal that anybody having clue/information about her whereabouts may inform us accordingly. The informer will be rewarded suitably:-

● Name	Sushma Devi
● Husband	Anchal Singh
● Permanent Address	Marhoon
● Present Address	Marhoon
● Tehsil	Billawar
● Police Station	Malhar
● Age	23 years
● Height	5 feet
● Complexion	Wheatish
● Build	Normal
● Face	Long
● Eyes	Black
● Languages known	Hindi/ Dogri

Any information related to the whereabouts of the subject may be communicated on following contacts:-

- DPO Kathua- 01922-234010 (Phone/Fax)
- dpokathua@jkpolice.gov.in (Mail ID)
- PCR Kathua- 01922-234311 (Phone/Fax)
- Police Station Lohai Malhar – 9186316023

DIP/J-10694/26 – DATE 17 SEP 2026

Sr. Superintendent of Police, Kathua.

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, L SUMATHI wife of, LAKSHMIKANTH R presently residing in Quarter No. A3, Tejas Enclave, Race Course, New Delhi-110003, have changed my name from L SUMATHI to SUMATHI T vide Affidavit, date-17/09/2026 0040878940-11

I Kulsum Ahmed W/o Md Sahanawaz R/o D-2-3-603/49/1/42, Patel Nagar, Near Hanuman Temple, Amberpet, VTC-Amberpet, PO-Amberpet, Dist-Hyderabad, Telangana-500013, have changed my name to Heena Begum 0071061055-1

I, ANITA DEVI D/O MATA PRASAD W/O LUCKY, R/o F-169, GALI-NO.1, TILAK-NAGAR, VIHNSNU-GARDEN, NEW DELHI-110018, have changed my name to ANITA. 0040878952-1

I, SAPNA ZARWAL KAUSER D/O LATE SH. BALDEV RAJ ZARWAL RESIDENT OF FLAT 13/3, TOWER K, AWHO SHANTI VIHAR SECTOR 95, GURGAON 122505 That I the above-named deponent have changed my name from SAPNA ZARWAL KAUSAR to SAPNA ZARWAL for all future purposes. 0071061083-1

I, No-9111700W, Hav Bilal Ahmad Bhat, RO/Tehsil-Lalpura, District - Kupwara-193223, In my service record name and D o B of my son has been wrongly mentioned as Abu Huzaifa, 29-12-2015 instead of Mohammad Ariz, 01-03-2017. It needs corrections. Objections be filed to concerned authority within seven days. 0020520334-1

I, RESHMA RANI DUA, W/o-Vipin Dua, R/o: I-15B, First Floor, Ganga Ram Vatika, Tilak Nagar, New Delhi-110018, Have Changed My Name to RESHMA DUA. 0040878940-3

I, Pallvi Aggarwal W/o Ankush Vashishtha, R/o Tower B5-1206, Smart City Golf Homes, Sector-4, Greater Noida, G.B. Nagar, UP-201301, have changed my name to PALLAVI AGGARWAL for all future purposes. 0071061037-1

I Daulat Ram Solanki S/O Dalip Singh R/O WZ-16, Badial, Palam Village, New Delhi-110045 Have Changed my Name to Daulat Ram. 0040878949-8

I, RIAZUDDIN S/O ALIMUDDIN R/O-67B, Hauz Rani, Malviya Nagar, New Delhi-110017 have changed my name to RIAZUDDIN. 0071061071-1

I, Vicky Singh Bhama, S/o Sh. Suresh Singh Bhama, R/o-36, Magni Mohalla, Tikri-Gujjar, P.O-Baroli, District-Palwal, Haryana, declare that my name and DOB are wrongly mentioned as Vicky Singh Bhama -28.07.1989, instead of my correct name Vicky Singh Bhama and DOB-28.07.1990. Both names refer to one and the same person. 0040878853-2

I, AZRA, D/o-Mohd Tayyab, R/O-H No. 3165, 4th floor, Kucha tara chand darya ganj delhi 110002 have changed my name to AFSHA permanently 0040878949-1

I, K M Saxena S/o Hori Lal Saxena R/O B-84 Oriental Apartments, Plot No-50, D C Chowk, Sector-9, Rohini, North west Delhi-110085, have changed my name to Krishna Mohan Saxena 0071061069-1

I, Vicky Singh Bhama, S/o Sh. Suresh Singh Bhama, R/o-36, Magni Mohalla, Tikri-Gujjar, P.O-Baroli, District-Palwal, Haryana, declare that my name and DOB are wrongly mentioned as Vicky Singh Bhama -28.07.1989, instead of my correct name Vicky Singh Bhama and DOB-28.07.1990. Both names refer to one and the same person. 0040878853-2

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I, AZRA, D/o-Mohd Tayyab, R/O-H No. 3165, 4th floor, Kucha tara chand darya ganj delhi 110002 have changed my name to AFSHA permanently 0040878949-1

I, Ram Vriksh S/o Paltoo Ram R/o House No. - 1986, Block - i, Jahangir Puri, North west Delhi -110033, have changed my name Ram Variksh to Ram Vriksh, with effect from 20/12/2018, Hereafter, I shall be known as Ram Vriksh. 0071061036-1

I, Mobin S/o Mohan Singh R/o 56, Block O, Chanakya Park-2, Uttam Nagar, West Delhi-110059, have changed my minor son's name from Mohsen Ahmad Aged 12 Years to Mohsin Ahmad forever 0071061070-1

I, hitherto known as, SUNITA SHARMA, W/o- MANOJ SHARMA, R/o-4/1974/1, PANDAV ROAD, BHOLA NATH NAGAR, SHAHDARA, DELHI-110032 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as SONIA SHARMA. 0040878949-7

I, Gursimran Boora Kumar w/o Deepanshu Kumar R/o B-402, Prerna Apartment, Plot No.-33, Sector-10, Dwarka, Delhi have changed the name of my minor daughter Gurbani Kumar Kashyap, aged 5 months and she shall hereafter be known as GURBANI KASHYAP. 0040878850-1

I, Ameena W/o Hitesh Kumar, R/O, T-6 BAZAR LANE JANGPURA, BHOGAL, NEW DELHI 110014 have changed my name to JUHI. 0071061051-1

I, Madhu W/O Dharmender Singh R/O H.No.204, G/F, Gali No.03, Village Karkadooda, East Delhi-110092, have changed my name to Mithalesh. 0040878951-1

I, TOSIF S/O Mohd Yusuf, H-306, Gali No-7, Janta Madzoor Colony , Welcome, Delhi-53, have changed my name to MOHD TOUSIF. 0071061134-1

I, Ranjana Chandel W/O VIRENDRA KUMAR CHANDEL R/o Plot.No-40A Village- Saini, Sector-12, Greater Noida West, Bishrakh, Gautam Buddha Nagar Uttar Pradesh-201301 has changed my name from KM RANJANA DEVI to RANJANA CHANDEL for all future Purposes. 0071061079-1

I, Ashish Pal Singh, S/O- BHUPINDER SINGH VAID, R/O-F-10/31, KRISHNA NAGAR, DELHI-110051, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO ASHISH PAL SINGH VAID PERMANENTLY. 0040878952-2

I, Ramesh Mohata S/o Jagdish Prasad Mohata R/O-A20, SF, Rampuri, Chander Nagar, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Ramesh Kumar Mohata. 0071061130-1

I, SHWETA VERMA, W/o-Hemant Dhunna, R/o:RZC-24, Near Gandhi Market, West Sagarpur, New Delhi-110046, Have Changed My Name to SHWETA DHUNNA. 0040878940-4

I, Inder Kumar S/o Piitha Ram, R/o 16/842-E, Bapa Nagar, Padam Singh Road, Karol Bagh, Central Delhi-110005 have changed my name to Inder Kumar Kanwadia 0071060900-2

I, Om Prakash, S/o-Mr. Hari Nath Ram, R/o-House No.108, Madangiri Village, South Delhi, New Delhi-110062, have changed my name from Om Prakash, S/o-Mr. Hari Nath Ram to OM PRAKASH GWASIKOTI, S/o-MR.HARI NATH, for all future purposes. 0040878949-9

I, Veena Gupta W/o Praveen Gupta R/o 9D, Pocket-3, Kalpana Apartment, Mayur Vihar Phase-3, Delhi-110096, have changed my name from KARUNA GUPTA to VEENA GUPTA. Henceforth, I shall be known and identified by the name VEENA GUPTA for all purposes. 0071061073-1

I, ANIL S/O R.S Jain, RZ-18A, Gali No-5, Tuglakabad Extn., Kalkaji, Delhi-19, have changed my name to ANIL JAIN. 0071061144-1

I, Naushaba Begum, W/o-Mohd Nazim Siddiqui, R/o-1658/1, Katra Bhawani Parsad, Kucha Dakhni Rai, Daryaganj Delhi, declare that my correct name is Naushaba Begum. My name was as Naushaba in the 2002 voter-list (EPIC No.DL/05/058/012451). It is hereby notified that my correct name is Naushaba Begum, for all purposes. 0040878949-2

I, Nashim Begum W/o Rahish R/o-29/500/19A2C, Gali No.10, Vishwas Nagar, Shahdara, Delhi-110032, have changed my name to Nasim Bano for all purposes. 0040878952-4

I, MD IMRAN S/O MOHAMMAD YAMIN, 8-B, 2nd-Floor, F/Side, Toot Sarai, Malviya Nagar, Delhi-17 have changed my name to MOHAMMAD IMRAN. 0071061136-1

I, Boddu Kunal Rao Alias Abel Srinivas Cheriyani S/o Boddo Srinivas Rao R/o House NO- 2-2-184/A/3, 4th Floor, Bharat Nagar, Bagh Amberpet, Hyderabad, Telangana- 500013, have changed my name to Abel S Cheriyani 0071061053-1

I, Km Arpita Pandey C/O Lokesh Agnihotri, Flat No-N2-407, Royal Nest, Tower-N2, Techzone-4, Greater Noida West, Sector 16C, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201318 have changed my name from KM ARPITA PANDEY to ARPITA for all future Purposes. 0071061082-1

I, No-9111700W, Hav Bilal Ahmad Bhat, RO/Tehsil-Lalpura, District - Kupwara-193223. In my service record name and D o B of my son has been wrongly mentioned as Numan Bin Bilal, 01-08-2014 instead of Noman Bin Bilal, 01-03-2015. It needs corrections. Objections be filed to concerned authority within seven days. 0020520333-1

I, Narendra Kumar, S/o-Rishi Ram, R/O-913, LIG Flats Hstalsl Uttam Nagar Delhi 110059 Have changed my minor Son's name From Bhuvansh to Bhuvansh kaushik. 0040878940-2

I, Sabina Anand, W/o-Gagan Kapoor, R/O.208, Second Floor, Tower T-8, The Hermitage, Sec-103 Daultabad, Gurugram, (Haryana)-122006, have changed my minor son name from Agrim Munjal to Agrim Kapoor for all Purposes. 0040878952-6

I, Inder Kumar S/o Piitha Ram, R/o 16/842-E, Bapa Nagar, Padam Singh Road, Karol Bagh, Central Delhi-110005 have changed my name to Inder Kumar Kanwadia 0071060900-2

I, Om Prakash, S/o-Mr. Hari Nath Ram, R/o-House No.108, Madangiri Village, South Delhi, New Delhi-110062, have changed my name from Om Prakash, S/o-Mr. Hari Nath Ram to OM PRAKASH GWASIKOTI, S/o-MR.HARI NATH, for all future purposes. 0040878949-9

I, Veena Gupta W/o Praveen Gupta R/o 9D, Pocket-3, Kalpana Apartment, Mayur Vihar Phase-3, Delhi-110096, have changed my name from KARUNA GUPTA to VEENA GUPTA. Henceforth, I shall be known and identified by the name VEENA GUPTA for all purposes. 0071061073-1

I, ANIL S/O R.S Jain, RZ-18A, Gali No-5, Tuglakabad Extn., Kalkaji, Delhi-19, have changed my name to ANIL JAIN. 0071061144-1

I, Naushaba Begum, W/o-Mohd Nazim Siddiqui, R/o-1658/1, Katra Bhawani Parsad, Kucha Dakhni Rai, Daryaganj Delhi, declare that my correct name is Naushaba Begum. My name was as Naushaba in the 2002 voter-list (EPIC No.DL/05/058/012451). It is hereby notified that my correct name is Naushaba Begum, for all purposes. 0040878949-2

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I, Narendra Kumar, S/o-Rishi Ram, R/O-913, LIG Flats Hstalsl Uttam Nagar Delhi 110059 Have changed my minor Son's name From Bhuvansh to Bhuvansh kaushik. 0040878940-2

I, MUKTEEM AHMED S/o MUKEEM AHMED R/o House No. A-6, 4th Floor, Noor Nagar Village, Jamia Nagar, New Delhi-110025 have changed my name from MUSTQIM AHMAD to MUSTAQEEM AHMED for all future purposes. 0071061152-1

I, COLONEL ASIT RANJAN SAHOO, S/O-LATE COLONEL HRUSHIKESH SAHOO, Currently Posted at Army Group Insurance Fund, Integrated HQ of Mod (Army), AGI Bhawan, Rao Tula Ram Marg, Post Vasant Vihar, New Delhi-110057, declare that in the School record of my real daughter namely MISS VAANYA SAHOO, her date of birth wrongly mentioned as- 26.03.2016 instead of 26.03.2015, the real and correct date of birth of my said daughter is 26.03.2015, so it may be amended accordingly. 0040878940-8

I, RAKESH SHARMA, S/o- MAHABIR PRASAD SHARMA, R/o/H-101, H-BLOCK, CLASSIC RESIDENCY, RAJNAGAR EXTENSION, GHAZIABAD, UP, 201017, inform that my name RAKESH SHARMA and RAKESH PAREEK are of same person. 0040878949-4

I, Bhupendra Singh, S/O BHAGWAT PRASAD HOUSE NO-157 TILAK KHAND GIRI NAGAR KALKAJI DELHI 110019 MY NAME CHANGE BHUPENDRA KUMAR FOR ALL PURPOSE 0040878940-1

I, Lovely Kumari D/o Anil Kumar R/o Ward No-01, Jhinpur Para, Lakhnapur (nP), PO-Lakhnapur S.o., Dist-Surguja, Chhattisgarh-497116, have changed my name to Raushani kumari 0071061052-1

I, RAKHA W/o No.1071338L RANK LD SATYA PAL SINGH R/o F-265, GALI NO -5, GANGA VIHAR, GOKAL PUR DELHI-110094 have changed my name to REKHA vide affidavit date 16-9-2026 before delhi. 0071061080-1

Santosh Kumar, S/o Anar Singh, 891, Sector 12 Vasundhara Ghaziabad, henceforth is known as Santosh Kumar Pathariya 0130069366-1

I, hitherto to known as, KM. Shaetaal Kaushik, D/O-Vinod Kaushik, W/O-Ajay Mishra, R/O-RZ D-1/17, Vinod Puri, Vijay Enclave, New Delhi-110045, have changed my Name and shall hereafter be known as Shikha Mishra. 0040878949-6

I, Sanjana Nehara W/o Kapil Kumar R/O F1-2, LIC Flats, Sec-2, Vidyadhar Nagar, Jaipur have changed my name to Sanjana Nehra. 0071061077-1

I, V Rekha D/o Vasudeva Raju N R and W/o Konduru Dileep Kumar R/o No.GF 01, IRIS Mariner Apartment, 4th Cross Sai Enclave, Arekere, M S Ramaiah City Layout, J P Nagar, 7th Phase, Bengaluru, Karnataka - 560076, have changed my name to Konduru Lavanya 0071060894-1

I, Aakash Kumar, S/o Suresh Kumar, resident-of ED-70-C, Pitampura, Delhi-110088, have lost the Allotment-Letter and Booklet for Unit-No.1063, 6th-Floor, Tower-1, ATS-Allure, Yamuna Expressway, Greater Noida, UP-203201. The documents were lost ON-15/09/2026. If found please contact-Aakash Kumar at aakash.kumar87@gmail.com /9540812508 0040878853-1

I, SONAL AGGARWAL DAUGHTER OF MR.SHANKAR NATH, R/O HOUSE NO.24, POKKET D-11, SECTOR 8, ROHINI, DELHI-110085. I HAD SHIFTED MY HOUSE LAST YEAR, SO IT GOT MISPLACED ON MY PROPERTY DOCUOMNTS FOR BEARING NO 1/11127, (OLD NO. B-25) SITUATED AT SUBHASH PARK, DISTRICT SHAHDARA, NEW DELHI-110032. 0040878940-12

I, Aakash Kumar, S/o Suresh Kumar, resident-of ED-70-C, Pitampura, Delhi-110088, have lost the Allotment-Letter and Booklet for Unit-No.1063, 6th-Floor, Tower-1, ATS-Allure, Yamuna Expressway, Greater Noida, UP-203201. The documents were lost ON-15/09/2026. If found please contact-Aakash Kumar at aakash.kumar87@gmail.com /9540812508 0040878853-1

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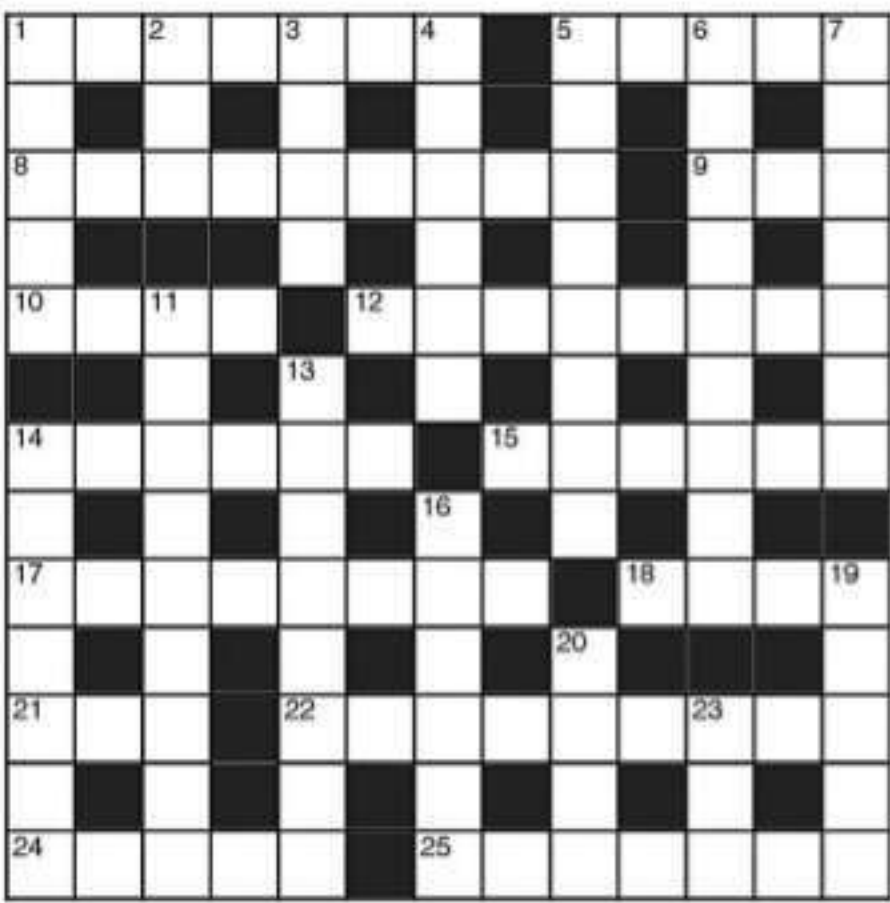
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CROSSWORD



ACROSS
1 Left office and went to bed (7)
5 Small part of a stone carving (5)
8 Is it suitable for eating only in the daytime? (5,4)
9 Send a morse message or intercept one (3)
10 Novice reporter goes to a Caribbean island (4)
12 Doctors should be seen in dry spells (8)
14 An unparticular person (6)
15 The story of Achilles' heel? (6)
17 Changes locks (8)
18 Employed to collect various dues (4)
21 Mother comes back in a frenzy (3)
22 Lay preacher? (9)
24 Use a divine gift to find water (5)
25 Ponders devious answer (7)

DOWN
1 Scoundrel I catch concealing a souvenir (5)
2 It may show the name of the game (3)
3 Rising star? You must be joking! (4)
4 Gloomy doctor having a bad year (6)
5 Getting cool and rude treatment, blushed (8)
6 So good nobody will play you? (9)
7 Disapproved of what a model did after work (7)
11 Does it have a view on where to swim? (3,6)
13 In turn I've become idle (8)
14 Put on Medusa's form (7)
16 One who foils trespassers? (6)
19 Went out with boys in old hat (5)
20 A doctor's name (4)
23 The Roman I found among the Goths (3)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6096 **ACROSS:** 1 Manifest, 5 Mugs, 9 Revue, 10 Asunder, 11 Flock of sheep, 13 Tramps, 14 Single, 17 Restlessness, 20 Counsel, 21 Alien, 22 Star, 23 Trekkers **DOWN:** 1 Mere, 2 Novella, 3 French polish, 4 Shadow, 6 Undue, 7 Scrapped, 8 Question mark, 12 Attracts, 15 Gas fire, 16 Ostler, 18 Sousa, 19 Ones

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

It is better to be ___ for what you are than to be ___ for what you are not - Andre Gide (5,...,5)

SETAE

AGLOT

DEICED

AILSHV

ANSWER: It is better to be **loved** for what you are than to be **hated** for what you are not - Andre Gide

OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL
4s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6445

			6		4			
3					5	8		
	1	3	7					
7	6		4		2			
8								2
		1	7		9	6		
		7	5					8
2	1							

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6444

9	3	6	2	1	5	7	8	4
7	5	4	8	3	9	6	1	2
2	1	8	6	7	4	5	9	3
1	7	5	4	6	3	9	2	8
3	6	9	7	2	8	4	5	1
4	8	2	5	9	1	3	6	7
8	2	3	9	4	6	1	7	5
6	4	7	1	5	2	8	3	9
5	9	1	3	8	7	2	4	6

INTEGRAL COACH FACTORY

TENDER NOTICE

The following e-tenders are published in IREPS website. Firms are requested to login to www.ireps.gov.in and quote against these tenders. Manual quotations will not be entertained for the Tenders.

SL. No.	Tender No.	Open Tender File Reference No.	Name of the Work	Quantity / Schedule Description	Date & Time of Tender Closing
1	202647 1212341 OT22-SWR LHB	MLC/OT/22/SWAR/LHB / 2026-28	Assembly and Welding Activities of Sidewalls and Roofs of Different Variants of LHB and VB Shells at ICF / Chennai	Sidewall Regular Mode - 516 Coach Sets Roof Assembly 224 Numbers	23.09.2026 at 15.00 Hrs

Hindi version of the above advertisement is available in the website: <https://icf.indianrailways.gov.in/>

CANTONMENT BOARD, MATHURA

INVITATION OF E-TENDERS (DUAL BID SYSTEM)

Electronic Bids are invited by Cantonment Board, Mathura for the under mentioned works:

Sl. No.	Name of Work	Estimated Cost (Rs.)	Earnest Money 2% in (Rs.)	Tender Form Fee
1	Repair and Renovation of Cantt. fund Buildings for the period of one year.	40.00 Lakh	80,000	1500/-

The interested contractors / firms shall upload all the documents related to above works on the [website https://defproc.gov.in/](https://defproc.gov.in/) w.e.f. starting date 18.09.2026 at 1600 hrs to ending date 03.10.2026 upto 1700 hrs. The terms & conditions for the above mentioned works may look up the ibid website.

Chief Executive Officer
Cantonment Board, Mathura
(Akash Garg, I.D.E.S.)

No. CBM/e-Tender/2026-27/540
Dated: 16 Sept, 2026

UTTARAKHAND POWER CORPORATION LIMITED

(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Undertaking), Corporate Identity No. U40109UR2001SGC025867/2358, Victoria Cross Vijeta Gabar Singh Urja Bhawan, Kanwali Road, Dehradun-248001, Telephone - (0135)-2763672-76, Fax- (0135)-2760289, Website: www.uktenders.gov.in

E-TENDER NOTICE (NIT)

Uttarakhand Power Corporation Ltd, Dehradun invites e- tender for following as detailed below:-

Sl. No.	Name of work	Tender Specification No.	Tender Qty.	Estimated cost (in ₹)	Average yearly Turn Over of Preceding Three Financial Year i.e. 2022-2023, 2023-2024 & 2024-2025 (in ₹)	Earnest Money (in ₹)	Cost of tender document including GST (in ₹)	Date & time of Prebid conference in online mode	Last Date & time of online request for Tender and submission of tender in online & Offline mode	Date of opening of bid Part-I in online and offline mode
1	LT XLPE Al. Cable 1x70Sq.mm.	CCP-II/28/ 2026-2027	25 Km	41,25,000.00	5,62,65,000.00	7,50,200.00	17,700.00	25.9.2026 at 12.00 Hrs.	7.10.2026 upto 17:00 hrs	8.10.2026 at 15:30 hrs
2	LT XLPE Al. Cable 1x120Sq.mm.		25 Km	59,00,000.00						
3	LT XLPE Al. Cable 1x240Sq.mm.		25 Km	95,00,000.00						
4	LT XLPE Al. Cable 1x 630Sq.mm.		15 Km	1,79,85,000.00						

For further details, please visit the website www.uktenders.gov.in
No.: 733/1/EE/(CM)/UPCL/A-2 Dt. 16.09.2026

SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
CORPORATE (C&P-I)

"SAVE ELECTRICITY IN THE INTEREST OF THE NATION. Use LED Bulb, Save Electricity (Toll Free No. 1912) "Pay Electricity Bill Online 24x7 from www.upcl.org". (For information on Electricity theft, informer may report to Toll free No 1800 180 4185/ Fax No. 0135-2760911)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Deepak @ Santosh, S/o: Kalu Ram, R/o: B-735 & D-735, Shahbad Dairy, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No.: 102/2011, U/s: 379/356/411/34/IPC, P.S. Begumpur, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said Deepak @ Santosh cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said Deepak @ Santosh has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Deepak @ Santosh of P.S. Begumpur, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 22.10.2026.

By Order
Ms. Anuradha Jindal
ACJM, North West Distt., Room No. 101, 1st Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DPI/13150/ON/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person namely Ashok Kumar Sirohi Director of M/s Saha Infratech Pvt. Ltd., R/o: E-13, Sec-30, Gautam Budha Nagar, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201303 also at Flat No. 4, Plot No.194-A, Ward No.2 Hill View Apartment, Mehrauli, South Delhi (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in FIR No. 2386/2020, U/s: 138 NI ACT, registered at P.S.: Karol Bagh, New Delhi and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused Ashok Kumar Sirohi cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Ashok Kumar Sirohi has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said Ashok Kumar Sirohi accused FIR No. 2386/2020, U/s: 138 NI ACT, registered at P.S.: Karol Bagh, New Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 17.10.2026.

By Order
Ms. Urvi Gupta
DP/13147/CD/2026 Judicial Magistrate First Class NI Act-01 (Court Matter) CBA-II, Room No. 201, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Anwar, S/o: Irfan, R/o: D/140, Madrese Wali Gali, Janta Colony, Welcome, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No.328/2021, U/s: 392/394/411/34 IPC, Police Station Kashmir Gate, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Anwar cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Anwar has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Anwar of Police Station Kashmir Gate, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 31.10.2026.

By Order
Sh. Vaibhav Garg
JMFC-11, Central, 1st Floor, Room No. 138 Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/13134/N/2026

ROYAL STARS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): This is a poor day to challenge anyone. You won't be pleased with the results. Nevertheless, it's in your best interest to work hard. You can also make improvements at home. Romance and finances are blessed. Tonight: Explore and learn.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): It's important to think big today. Enjoy socialising and working with greater projects. Communications will go well today. Don't push your luck at work. Avoid conventional choices. Today is the day to go big or go home. Tonight: Check your finances.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Focus on home, family and a parent. Work colleagues are supportive today. Discussions with kids and perhaps an older friend might fall flat. Go with what works today. Tonight: Be cooperative.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): This is a poor day to ask for permission or approval from authority figures, parents or the police. Instead, use your energy, drive, communication skills and winning charm to go after what you want on your own terms. Believe in yourself. Tonight: Work.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Don't give in to worry today. It gets you nowhere. Focus on making where you live look more attractive. Why not entertain. Trust your money-making ideas today. Tonight: Socialise.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Today you might wonder about your place in the world. You might feel isolated or lonely. Perhaps you have to say goodbye to a loved one. Your best choice is heavy mental work. Tonight: Relax.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Today is the classic time for the ending of things, especially close relationships. Discussions will be serious. Someone might be critical of the relationship. You might have to report to an authority figure. Tonight: Study and discussions.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Your best option today is to work hard at whatever is in front of you. Mental work will be the best choice. You will probably impress authority figures with your diligence and steady application. Tonight: Check your money.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Children might be an increased responsibility today. You also might be involved with younger people in some fashion. Discussions about creative projects, the education of children and sports will be serious. Tonight: You're strong.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): A serious discussion with someone in a position of authority might take place today. If you are displeased with what happens, this is not the day to express your views. When working today, take breaks to keep your spirits up. Tonight: Enjoy privacy.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Writing projects and issues related to medicine or the law might be onerous today. You might feel like you have bitten off more than you can chew. Don't be discouraged. Tackle what is in front of you in small bits. Tonight: A friendly discussion.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): You might feel discouraged about financial matters, especially if you're discussing inheritances, shared property, taxes or debt. Your ability to improve your job and health will make a difference to your future this year. Tonight: You look good to someone.

KERALA WATER AUTHORITY e-Tender Notice

Tender No : 02/2026-27/SE/PHC/ALP

KIIFB-WSS to Ala, Puliyoor, Bhudanoor, Pandanad, Mulakuzha, Venmony Panchayat s and Chengannur Municipality in Alappuzha District-Road Restoration works of Municipal roads in Package II-Pipeline work EMD : Rs. 500000 Tender fee: Rs. 16540/-2978(GST at 18%) Last Date for submitting Tender : 06-10-2026 02:00:pm Phone : 04772237954 Website : www.kwa.kerala.gov.in

www.etenders.kerala.gov.in

Superintending Engineer
PH circle Alappuzha

NORTHERN RAILWAY

OPEN-E-TENDER NOTICE

The Sr. Divisional Engineer-III, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites E-Tender for the following work.

	Name of work	Approx cost of work	Earnest Money to be deposited	Cost of tender document	Date & Time of submission of tender bid and opening of tender	Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	Allocation
1	Repair and Renovation works of ladies, gents toilet at the holding area first floor, toilet at the station building including plumbing sanitary, filling and other allied civil & maintenance works at New Delhi Railway station in the section of SSE/WNDLS under ADEN/NDLS.	Rs. 1,79,22,739.48 /- (Rupees One Crore Seventy Nine Lakh Twenty Two Thousand Seven Hundred Thirty Nine and Forty Eight Paise Only)	Rs. 3,58,500.00/- (Rupees Three Lakh Fifty Eight Thousand Five Hundred Only)	Rs. 0.00/-	09.10.2026 @ 15:00 Hrs.	www.ireps.gov.in	04-410-32

• The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement system (IREPS) site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for participating in the e-tender system. • For all terms and conditions please refer tender document. • No manual offers are acceptable. • Cost of tender document and Earnest money will be acceptable through net banking or payment gateway only. No. 128-W/280/e Tender Notice/NIT/44/2026-27/W-3 Dated :- 16.09.2026 3221/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

BENGALURU SOUTH CITY CORPORATION

Office of the Executive Engineer, Traffic Engineering and Mobility Cell, 2nd Floor, 9th Main Road, Jayanagara East, 2nd Block, Bengaluru - 560 011

No.:EE/BSSC/TE&M Cell/TEND/13/2026-27 Date:17.09.2026

INVITATION FOR SHORT TERM TENDER(IFT) (Through KPP Portal Only) (Two Cover System)

The Executive Engineer-Zone 1, Traffic Engineering and Mobility Cell invites tenders from eligible tenderers for work detailed in the table below.

Sl.No.	Name of the work
1.	Filling of Potholes using Jet Patcher in Zone-1, Bengaluru South City Corporation. Approx. Amount put to tender: Rs. 100.00 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 2,00,000/- Period of Services: 12 Months (Including Monsoon).
2.	Supplying Cold Tar Mix including transportation in Zone-1, Bengaluru South City Corporation. Approx. Amount put to tender: Rs. 72.00 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 1,44,000/- Period of Services: 60 Days.

1)Tender documents can be downloaded from KPP portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> from 18.09.2026 onwards. 2) Last Date for receipt of tender queries: 24.09.2026 upto 3.00 p.m. 3) Pre-bid meeting: 24.09.2026 at 4.30 p.m. 4) Last Date for receipt of tenders: 03.10.2026 upto 4.00 p.m. 5) Opening of Technical bids: 05.10.2026 after 4.30 p.m. Further details can be obtained from the office of the undersigned.

Sd/- Executive Engineer-Zone 1
Traffic Engineering and Mobility Cell, BSSC.

• BRIEFLY



The Chinese women's team was knocked out after rain. x

China out of Asiad before a ball is bowled

TWO DAYS before the official opening of the 2026 Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan, the Chinese women's cricket team faced an agonising exit without even taking the field. The opening quarter-final fixture of the women's T20I cricket event between China and Bangladesh was abandoned without a ball being bowled due to inclement weather around the Kōrogi Sports Park in Nisshin. Heavy weather had plagued Kōrogi Sports Park on the outskirts of Nagoya all week, culminating in a total cancellation of play on Thursday morning, proving costly for the Chinese side, making their third Asiad appearance since 2010. Nigar Sultana's Bangladesh, therefore, advanced to the semi-final stage over China despite an abandoned game. According to the Asian Games cricket Playing Conditions, rule 16.10.2 (b) states that the higher-ranked side will advance in the event of a wash-out. The rule also came into effect in the 2023 edition, with three of the four quarter-finals involving India, Pakistan and Bangladesh being washed out. ENS

Gonsalves-Beg pair bows out of Asiad Teqball

INDIA'S DECLAN Marshall Gonsalves and Mohamed Anas Imran Beg bowed out of the medal race in the men's doubles Teqball competition at the Asian Games after losing both their group matches here on Thursday. Placed in Group B, the 31-year-old Gonsalves and Beg, 26, both hailing from Mumbai, lost their matches 0-2. The Indians first lost 10-12-8-12 against Vietnam's Truong Giang Ba and Anh Khoa Le before going down 4-12-7-12 against South Korea's Junsuk Lee and Tae-been Lee. Gonsalves, who started the game five years ago, is the defending national champion in the men's doubles category for five consecutive years and also won the national championship in the men's singles in 2025. Teqball is a dynamic sport, a combination of football and table tennis. Teqball is one of the six sports alongside MMA, Padel, Surfing, BMX Freestyle and Virtual Taekwondo which are making their debut. PTI

NIGHTMARE IN NAGOYA

Slow transfers, slower check-ins, missing shuttle buses

Just a cruise ship 'ocean view' not enough



The idea of lodging athletes on a cruise ship with a stunning ocean view hasn't landed too well for Asian Games athletes as the start is littered with chaos. *The Korea Times' Hankookilbo* reported that athletes who moved into the cruise ship athletes' village at Kinjo Pier near Nagoya Port on Wednesday expressed frustration, saying, that though the accommodations are in much better condition than those at the container-based Garden Pier village, they are forced to spend all their time on water, and struggling to access competition venues. At the container village,

Mihir Vasavda

Mumbai, September 17

VINAY IYER, a Mumbai club cricketer who once arranged his life around a 5.15am bus to make practice on time, will be on the other side of the boundary rope on Friday, as coach of Japan's women's cricket team at the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games. Their opponents: India.

He knows the Mumbai routine well enough that the memory still comes easily. He would take the early bus from home to Thane railway station, catch a train into the city, and make it to the Police Gymkhana at Charni Road by 7.15 sharp. Practice, then college, then more cricket in the evening. Later, work entered the picture too: practice at Charni Road, office in Andheri, home in Thane. For a while, Iyer kept it up. Eventually, geography won.

Nearly two decades later, cricket has brought him to another commute, another country, and a situation he could scarcely have imagined as a young player crossing Mumbai's maidans.

"I get goosebumps even

now when I think about the match," Iyer, 41, tells *The Indian Express*. "I am trying not to show my nervousness to the players."

There's something almost surreal about that, for a man who grew up at Thane's Central Maidan under coach Shekhar Dhuri and at Dadoji Kondadev Stadium, and who still remembers watching Cheteshwar Pujara up close while fielding at point in a West Zone game at the Wankhede.

When the Asian Games draw was announced and Japan learned they would face India, there was excitement among his players. Iyer got caught up in it too. Then the reality of the job began to sink in.

"I started thinking, 'What's happening?'" says Iyer, who had to apply for leave from work to be at the Games. "I never thought in my life that I am going to coach, train people and tell them, 'You are going to face this bowler.' Or tell a bowler, 'You are going to bowl to Smriti Mandhana.'"

For someone from Thane, raised inside the demanding



Vinay Iyer is the coach of Japan's women's team. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

ecosystem of Mumbai cricket, it's a long way to have travelled.

Iyer played the Kanga League for Sundar Cricket Club and captained his college to an inter-collegiate title. Former India cricketer Ashok Mankad, one of his childhood coaches, pushed him toward Ranji opportunities. A possible route through the Navy was delayed, and there was pressure at home to earn. Mankad suggested Kerala instead, where Iyer might

have had a shot at state cricket.

His parents weren't convinced. "My father was like, 'You will go from here to there, even the ration card will change,'" Iyer laughs.

Eventually, Mankad pointed him toward Rosy Blue, a diamond trading company that played in the Times Shield. Offered a choice between a playing contract and a job, Iyer chose the job. "That day I started working, I'm still in the

same company," he says.

The decision didn't end his cricket journey. It sent it on a detour, to Japan.

Permanent role

Rosy Blue first sent Iyer to Japan for three months in 2009, then offered him a permanent role in 2013 after he survived the 2011 Tokyo earthquake, having initially said, "I'm not coming back." He came back anyway, and discovered Japan had cricket. "When I found out there is cricket in Japan, I thought, 'Okay, let's try and get into the national team,'" he says.

He joined a Tokyo club, Max CC, and began travelling two hours to Sano for matches, another cricket commute, this time in another country. In 2015, he topped the league's run charts and was named Player of the Year. Just as a national team spot seemed possible, the Japan Cricket Association changed its rules to bar foreigners.

Rather than walk away, Iyer formed the Kawasaki Knight Riders. Fielding a senior side required building youth teams first, and coaching his own

under-12, under-15 and under-19 players, he found his next career.

After Covid, Japan changed its eligibility rules again, and in 2021 he made his international debut. A shoulder injury soon after ended his playing career, and coaching took over: first Japan's men's under-16 side, then the under-19 team as an assistant.

On an under-19 tour to Dubai, Iyer ran into former India cricketer Wasim Jaffer. "I had played a couple of games with him at Police Gymkhana," he says, laughing. "I'm sure he doesn't remember me."

The assignment did more than reconnect him with familiar names from Indian cricket. It opened the door to his next job. Japan's women's coach, Ardene Ruhode, also worked with the Under-19 programme, and when Ruhode began preparing to leave, he recommended Iyer for the women's team. In 2025, the former Mumbai club cricketer got the job.

It also meant confronting how different the cricketing worlds of India and Japan really were. "Here, we play on mat wickets. We have camps

once a month. It's not like that since we are going to the Asian Games, we have a three-week camp. No. We are just practising once a month. But the girls are so excited that every week, they are taking leave and going to Sano," Iyer says.

He's worked with the groundsman to secure a patch of turf the players can train on. Iyer still holds his day job; the players record videos of their sessions and upload them to an app, letting him monitor and send feedback remotely.

Iyer believes the game could be "a life changer" for his players. For him too, it carries a strange circularity. Once, he was the young Mumbai cricketer rushing across the city before sunrise, squeezing a little more cricket into a life increasingly claimed by trains, buses, college and work.

Now he's in Japan, on the other side, preparing a team to take on the country that shaped him. Somewhere in that journey, from a 5.15am bus in Thane to telling Japanese bowlers about Smriti Mandhana, lies a twist even Mumbai cricket could not have scripted.

Before the Games, an obstacle race for the Indian contingent



A cabin on the Costa Serena cruise ship. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Nitin Sharma

Chandigarh, September 17

JAPAN'S REPUTATION for meticulous planning and efficiency suffered a beating with athletes landing in the country for the Asian Games complaining about a spectrum of obstacles in the lead-up to the continental games. From waiting endlessly in the assembly area for room allocation to inadequate food options and hassle for commuting to distance from accommodation and training facilities, some of India's top-notch athletes were left fretting in the country's largest manufacturing and shipping hub of Nagoya.

For instance, after a chaotic Wednesday, when the shooting staff faced unprecedented delays and issues over the accreditation card of chief pistol coach Samresh Jung, the team ran into transportation bumps. Not only had they to travel 90 minutes in buses to reach the shooting ranges, but also were kept waiting for the buses.

"The hotels are about 50-60 kms away from the range. The bus could accommodate only 50 persons. The first bus came late, and the second bus too was late," one of the members told *The Indian Express*. "It took us close to two hours to reach the range. It took less time on return. But such delays can be frustrating for shooters sometimes," he added.

At least, they were more fortunate than South Korea's football team, who were playing Qatar. Instead of the football ground, they were ferried to the baseball arena, which was not scheduled for any games. Consequently, the team arrived at the stadium 30 minutes later than they had planned.

A day after rowers were left stranded in the assembly area and had to pay for their food, a wushu practitioner, two Indian coaches and a masseur faced a delay of more than six hours before they could check into their room in the cruise ship, Costa Serena. "While the wushu players had to wait for some time before they were sent to the cruise ship, we, coaches and the masseur had to wait for more than six hours at the assembly area," said a coach.

"We did not have anything to eat except water and snacks from the airport. We got our

rooms in the cruise ship post 11pm (local time). We were so tired that we did not realise we were sleeping inside a cruise ship," the coach added.

Earlier in the day, Varun Sanyal, one of India's two mixed martial arts athletes, posted about inordinate delay for getting his room. "I can confirm this is true. I'm currently on 7 hours and counting," Sanyal posted on a video showing Indian players waiting for accommodation to be given," he wrote on X. In his video, athletes, not just from India, could be seen sleeping on the floor or leaning against the walls. After 10 hours of waiting he was assigned a room, but 30 minutes into the sleep, two other athletes woke him up because they were assigned the same room as well.

Compounding the mess, there had been instances of coaches, team officials, and athletes assigned the same room. In some cases, men and women were allocated the same room. One of India's rowers, reportedly, had to share a room with a Hong Kong counterpart. Philippines' athletes found some rooms in Airbnb after quick browsing,

Back-up arrangement

Japan's deputy chef de mission Hisashi Mizutori admitted the inadequacies and reassured that the problems will be sorted out. "We are currently working to coordinate and negotiate adjustments wherever possible. For cases where that proves too difficult, we are considering using the backup accommodations that Team Japan prepared in advance as alternatives," he told *Japan Times*.

The women's cricket team did not have to endure such ordeals. "I think the accommodation is nice over here. I mean, we are pretty okay. I don't think there are any complaints from our end. Just the check-in and everything was absolutely spotless and we were pretty happy about it," said coach Amol Majumdar.

The local organising committee (LOC) of Aichi-Nagoya 2026 has blamed the accommodation issues to some sports being added late to the Games program. The organisers were initially expecting about 15,000 athletes and officials for the Games.

China is the dominant force, but Indians aim to land Olympic spots as well as provide evidence of their growing stature

Shivani Naik

Mumbai, September 17

INDIA HAS won 778 medals at Asian Games till date from 19 editions - 183 of them being gold. China has 3,570 in all, with 1,674 gold; that too from 14 outings. Those numbers - and a small, unassuming knick-knack tucked inside the goodie-bag given to every Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games athlete - can put the next fortnight into perspective. It's a small fist-sized sauce-plate, the Japanese trick for portion control, never overwhelming the dish with the dip.

For India's 2026 Asiad batch, it's a metaphor — the Asiad medal, no matter how much hype it creates, is just the dip for the Olympic Games at Los Angeles in two years. Nagoya is the smallest start for what needs to be achieved at LA '28. It has 20 Olympic quotas on offer.

Both hockey teams could do with nailing down that Olympic qualification - for 20 years ago, they didn't secure Beijing participation. The men's team has won two Olympic bronzes since, but Asiad gold is something best sealed before dreaming too big.

A Nagoya gold in archery will perhaps be the most significant, with the sport offering six individual and two team quotas. The gettable one is in the Compound mixed team event, a discipline Indians have long dominated, but the stakes have

never been this high to prove the Koreans can be denied.

India are not exactly favourites in Recurve either. But Dhiraj Bommadevara is considered a generational talent. He will need tonnes of adaptability in cloudy, windy conditions though to beat Koreans such as Sim Woo-jin, though both gold and silver fetch quotas. There's no Deepika Kumari in the women's entries, and the likes of Ankita Bhakat will need to be at their best to grab a coveted final.

Another notable omission is that of Manika Batra in table tennis, though India got a medal courtesy Ayhika (another shocking absence) and Sutirtha Mukherjee, who will compete at Nagoya. There are no Olympic quotas available, but a men's doubles medal from Manav Thakkar and Manush Shah might start a happy streak.

Squash and tennis offer a men's singles and women's singles quota each to the winner. And while Anahat Singh has the Malaysian leader in Asia in her sights, it is in tennis with Sumit Nagal that India can dream. Dhakineswar Suresh has been on a roll these last 12 months, but he won't be fielded in singles curiously. The quota is quite alluring though. Surfing, dinghy sailors and triathlon are other LA-coded goods, with a lesser Indian likelihood though.

But there are other battles and match-ups that offer intriguing storylines. Like weightlifter Mirabai Chanu's pursuit

of the elusive Asiad podium, or a badminton singles gold — a good time for Lakshya Sen and Ayush Shetty to spring back to life. India also hasn't won a rowing gold since Dattu Baban Bhokanal, Sawarn Singh, Om Prakash and Sukhmeet Singh got home the Quadruple sculls top spot in 2018, but lightweight's Ujjwal Kumar has had a good year.

The Asian Games really gets exciting on match-ups though: CWG 60kg champion boxer Sachin Siwach taking on Uzbeki royalty Abdulmalik Khalolov. Or 51 kg breakout pugilist Sakshi Chaudhary going up against Chinese Olympic champ Wu Yu for gold. Or Jyothi Yarraji, who won a silver at Hangzhou, once again getting flanked by old Chinese rivals, Wu Yanni and Lin Yuwei, in the 100m hurdles.

The first medal up for grabs will pit 10m Air Rifle shooters Elavenil Valarivan-Tilottama

Sen-Sonam Uttam Maskar against the latest Chinese sensation, Wang Zifei.

All of India's attention has shifted to Pistol though, as seeking redemption in Japan is former world champion Rudranksh Patil. Interestingly, Patil won the world title while still a teen in 2022, but failed to qualify for the Paris Olympics. The boy who won bronze when Patil won gold, Chinese Sheng Lihao, spearheads their shooting bunch, while only 21 years old, but already a double Olympic champion.

Redemption due

India has endless patience for the talent of 97kg wrestler Deepak Punia, but Nagoya might be a good place to put it past Russian-born Bahrain heavyweight, Akhmed Tazhudinov. India hasn't won an Asiad wrestling gold since Vinesh Phogat and Bajrang Pu-

nia's 2018 triumphs, when Deepak picked silver.

Asiad medals tend to rain on India in track and field.

However, gold could be hard-earned.

High jumper Pooja bombed at the Commonwealth Games but redemption could come at Nagoya — she has Uzbek Bar-nokhon Sayfullayeva, a pair of Kazakhs and Chinese. Jiawen Lu snapping at her heels. Rumesb Pathirage looms large on the javelin field, but Yashvir Singh and Rohit Yadav have a chance to keep India interested if they can get into 87m+ territory.

While two kabaddi golds are demanded, the superstar cricket teams too can pay their dues, with a fuss-free march to gold. A slightly sentimental feeling tinges badminton. It might well be the last Asian Games for HS Prannoy, Kidambi Srikanth and PV Sindhu.



Chinese lay out yoga mats at airport waiting for transport

The Aichi Sky Expo, a venue next to Chubu Centrair International Airport, of the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games, became a mass of stranded passengers as arriving delegations waited hours for transfers to their official accommodation, reported *Xinhua*. The on-site system failed to find information for a large number of athletes, leaving them unable to board the pre-arranged shuttle buses. Those who were left stranded put out yoga mats and slept on them.

Noryang. They argued and negotiated for years later, then settled for peace. At Nagoya 2026, the Koreans weren't amused to be greeted by the Hideyoshi figure.

Private transport not viable option either

When Kazakhstan's shooting team waited more than two hours for transport, more chaos

ensued. "Many parts of the workflow are not connected. Teams can arrange private transport if they want, but they have to cover the costs themselves," a volunteer was quoted as saying by *Xinhua*. Warned of the chaos, China's badminton team tried to take public airport buses but could not get enough tickets for everyone. Some athletes left separately while the rest stayed behind. The remaining badminton players were helped by staff from the Chinese Consulate General in Nagoya, who arranged chartered vehicles through local overseas Chinese contacts, as per *Xinhua*. The full team finally left after four hours.

Thailand athletes sleep on cruise lobby floor

A Facebook post from *Thailand Enquirer* showed several athletes from Thailand's sepak tekraw team curled up on the floor as they were forced to sleep in the

Costa Serena Cruise ship lobby after their accommodation records were found missing. Arriving on Wednesday, officials informed them their names were missing till late in the night, according to *Thailand Enquirer*. Deputy delegation chief Chalitrat Chandru-



beksa was quoted by *Enquirer* stating that the Japanese organisers had failed to submit their team's documents. The athletes were then allocated rooms promised to other Thai athletes.

SHIVANI NAIK

Nihal turns certain defeat into victory at Chess Olympiad

Amit Kamath
Mumbai, September 17

NIHAL SARIN managed to grab victory from the jaws of almost-certain defeat in a game that ended up handing the Indian team a victory over Indonesia in round 2 of the Chess Olympiad in Samarkand. Nihal's game was the only decisive result across four boards in the defending champions' clash with Indonesia, who with an average team rating of 2436 are only the 52nd strongest team among the 206 participating nations. India, meanwhile, are the second strongest team with an average rating of 2735.

The Indian women's team, meanwhile, claimed a near-perfect victory over Finland in the second round, with Divya Deshmukh, Vantika Agrawal and Savitha Shri winning their games while Vaishali ending up with a draw. Divya was the only player in trouble in the round, with her form from the recent Global Chess League still to be shrugged off. But FIDE master Johanna Paasikangas was overpowered in the middle game by Divya before she claimed a win.

Nihal was in a losing position when his opponent Arif Abdul Hafiz handed him a get-out-of-jail-free card, one that he gladly accepted before turning around the fate of the match and the India-Indonesia tie. Rated 2428, Hafiz is 290 Elo points behind the 2718-rated Nihal.

"The Nihal board could have gone either way. For example, if Nihal was playing the same position against someone who was a 2600 or a 2700-rated player, would this game still have ended this way? I'm not sure. Nihal was in objective trouble in that game. He kept his chances going and when he got the opportunity he found the best moves and won. That could have been anyone's game," said Tania Sachdev, on the Chess.com commentary.

AFGHANISTAN V INDIA

30-ball blitz makes Abhishek India's fastest T20I centurion

Opener predicted his own failures a year ago. On Thursday, he settled the debt with third-fastest century in the shortest format

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, September 17

A YEAR ago, Abhishek Sharma stood at the summit of the game, the Player of the Tournament award from the 2025 Asia Cup in one hand, the keys to a new car in the other, 315 runs and three half-centuries behind him. And even then, mid-celebration, he seemed to already know what was coming. "If you play like this, there will be failures," he said.

He wasn't wrong. He just didn't know how the story would end.

The failures arrived with a timing that felt almost designed. A 484-run IPL 2025 season had convinced everyone he would walk into international cricket without breaking stride, and for a while he did exactly that, a century in only his second match for India, then 1,115 runs across the rest of the year, 268 clear of the next best Indian batter on the list. The arc only ever bent upward. Then it bent back.

At the T20 World Cup, 141 runs left him 37th on the run charts, behind men for whom batting is a side hustle rather than a calling. A trophy can hide a lot, but against Zimbabwe in July, the mask came off completely: scores of 1, 8 and 2, arriving at the exact moment a quieter war was being fought



Abhishek Sharma struck nine fours and 11 sixes in his 108-run innings. ABHINAV SAHA

over his place, between the World Cup's Player of the Tournament, Sanju Samson, and IPL 2026's leading run-scorer, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi. Abhishek was on borrowed time, and everyone could see it.

Sixes galore

On Thursday, under the lights at the Arun Jaitley Stadium, he paid it all back, one six at a time.

Sunday had offered a glimpse of the comeback, a 53-ball 82. Thursday was the whole picture. In the final of the three-match series against Afghanistan, Abhishek reached a century in 30 deliveries, the fastest by any Indian in the format.

It didn't start like ruin. The first over, off Fazalhaq Farooqi, produced an exquisitely timed, delicately placed lofted cover drive, and little else, the left-

armer even got away with a couple of respectful dot balls. Whatever restraint that suggested was gone by the second over. A pull dismissed with disdain over square leg. A charge down the pitch that ended in a loft over the covers. Azmatullah Omarzai carried the weight of both. Farooqi, back for his second over, fared no better, two more sixes and, as if for balance, two fours besides.

Ibrahim Zadran could have looked in any direction on his field and found no one willing to bowl. The sport doesn't care about seniority in these moments, and Mohammad Nabi discovered that at 41, not because of his age but because he happened to be next in line.

The fifty came in an over that leaked 29 runs, 16 of them off Abhishek's bat alone, 16 deliveries in total to get there, the

joint-fourth fastest fifty by an Indian in the format, and the sixth time in his career he had done it inside 20 balls.

He was only getting started. Mujeeb-ur-Rahman went the same way as everyone before him, Abdullah Ahmadzai after that, 51 runs off fourteen balls carrying him from fifty to a hundred in thirty deliveries total, the fastest T20I century by a player from any Test-playing nation, third fastest overall behind only Estonia's Sahil Chauhan and Turkey's Muhammad Fahad.

The end, when it came in the tenth over, arrived almost incidentally, an attempt to smash a Rashid Khan googly into the stands instead finding Rahmanullah Gurbaz's gloves. By then he had 108 off 34 balls, 102 of those runs in boundaries alone, as though the very idea

• **Fastest T20I centuries by Indians**

ABHISHEK SHARMA
30 deliveries
(vs Sri Lanka, 2026, New Delhi)

ROHIT SHARMA
35 deliveries
(vs Sri Lanka, 2017, Indore)

ABHISHEK SHARMA
37 deliveries
(vs England, 2025, Mumbai)

SANJU SAMSON
40 deliveries
(vs Bangladesh, 2024, Hyderabad)

TILAK VARMA
41 deliveries
(vs South Africa, 2024, Johannesburg)

***Abhishek scored the third fastest hundred in T20 internationals**

of running between the wickets had never occurred to him.

The record he took had belonged to Rohit Sharma since 2017, a 35-ball century against Sri Lanka in Indore.

Virat Kohli, watching from wherever former captains watch these things, now shares the summit for most T20I centuries with ten apiece, alongside whoever else the format has produced. Ahead of both of them sit only Chris Gayle and Babar Azam, and after Thursday, they might want to check over their shoulders too.

He said there would be failures. There were. He never said what he would do to the record books on the other side of them.

BRIEF SCORES: IND 221/7 in 20 overs (Abhishek 108; Omarzai 2/27) beat AFG 94 all out in 14.1 overs (Ibrahim 25; Reddy 3/25) by 127 runs

India's Davis Cup hopes collide with a court built to stop them in Seoul

Bhuvan Gupta
New Delhi, September 17

SOUTH KOREA didn't just slow the court down. They studied the two men who'd be standing on it.

"They have resurfaced the court with a lot of thought and intelligence where they have actually tried to counter both our players," India captain Rohit Rajpal told PTI after a training session in Seoul. "Sumit likes the balls to bounce because he rolls a lot. But the balls are not bouncing. They have slowed it down because DK also does not like slow courts. He has a huge serve. So they countered it again with this thing."

There is something almost personal in that, a hard court engineered not against a strategy but against two specific bodies, two specific habits. Dhakshineswar Suresh and Sumit Nagal will spend this tie fighting a surface built with them in mind.

The stakes explain the trouble South Korea has gone to. A win puts India into the Davis Cup Final 8, a stage no Asian nation has reached since the format was revamped. It has taken three ties to get here. India blanked Togo 4-0 at Delhi's DLTA Complex in February last year. They then went to Biel and beat ninth-seeded Switzerland 3-1, India's first win over a European nation on European soil since 1993, a year in which Leander Paes and Ramesh Krishnan were still doing the winning. Then came the Netherlands in Bengaluru this February, and Dhakshineswar again, three rubbers played, three rubbers won, a 3-2 upset that has brought India to this final step.

He arrives without the partner he'd have wanted. Yuki Bhambri, who reached the US Open doubles semifinals last



D Suresh is India's best hope in the tie against South Korea. PTI

year and had complemented Dhakshineswar well in the win over the Dutch, is out with a high injury picked up before his own first-round match at Flushing Meadows. In his place, Niki Poonacha joins N Sriram Balaji, up against Uisung Park and Jisung Nam on the tie's second day.

The Seoul Olympic Park Tennis Center has seen a country do something no one else had done before. Thirty-eight years ago, in the same stadium, tennis returned to the Olympics after 64 years away, and Steffi Graf beat Gabriela Sabatini there to complete the only calendar-year Golden Slam the sport has known. India is chasing something smaller in scale but no less unprecedented for a nation that hasn't managed it: an Asian team through to the Final 8. Both singles matches carry their own strange symmetry.

Dhakshineswar opens on Friday against Soonwoo Kwon, ranked 157, a two-time ATP titlist.

Nagal follows against Hyeon Chung, ranked 549 now but once as high as 19, a man who beat Novak Djokovic and Alexander Zverev.

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